



ZLang HDL Community Language Reference

Compiler version 0.1.0a8

ZLang HDL Community

Release reference

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Reference source SHA-256: 8c754195052dfde1a1e9a54a85d37f816590e4f8cd2f9ea57d99a8fe78e4d615

Quick-reference source SHA-256: adcc35580de824099243a80a1ccb385e24d5e8c4a563af07baa8ef85c73

The compiler-owned typed IR defines language semantics. Examples and estimated costs do not replace compiler validation, simulation, synthesis, or formal evidence appropriate to a design.

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This is the complete user-facing reference for the ZLang HDL Community compiler. The backend-independent typed IR defines language semantics, and direct SystemVerilog is the supported production RTL path. Unsupported combinations fail closed rather than publishing guessed hardware.

This reference covers installation, language semantics, compilation, editor integration, implementation planning, generated RTL, and verification. The companion [quick reference](#) is optimized for daily authoring. The PDF edition appends that quick reference to this document.

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0.2 Installation, WSL2, and external tools

ZLang HDL supports Linux x86-64 with CPython $\geq 3.12, < 3.13$ for the current alpha release. You do not need to find a distribution package for that exact runtime: the recommended uv workflow can download and manage it independently of the system Python. Parsing, semantic checking and direct-SystemVerilog generation need only the Python package. Verilator, Yosys, SymbiYosys and a solver are external programs used only when their corresponding lint, synthesis or formal flow is requested.

The exact versions used by release acceptance are recorded in [release/status.json](#). Other versions may work, but they are not evidence for the published release.

0.2.1 Recommended installation with uv

Install [uv](#) using its official platform instructions. Confirm that the executable is visible in the same terminal that will run ZLang:

```
uv --version
```

For ordinary use, install the wheel downloaded from the matching GitHub release as an isolated command-line tool. `uv` provisions the requested interpreter if it is not already present:

```
uv tool install --python '>=3.12,<3.13' /path/to/zlang_hdl-VERSION-py3-none-any.whl
zlang --version
zlang-lock --version
zlang-verify --version
```

If `uv` reports that its tool directory is not on `PATH`, run `uv tool update-shell`, then start a new shell. `uv tool dir --bin` prints the command directory for manual `PATH` configuration. To replace an installation made from a downloaded wheel, repeat `uv tool install --force ...` with the new wheel.

For development from a Git checkout, keep the environment local to the repository:

```
git clone https://github.com/postoronyi/zlang_hdl.git
cd zlang_hdl
uv venv --python '>=3.12,<3.13'
uv pip install -e '.[test]'
```

The remainder of this guide uses `.venv/bin/zlang` so commands work in an editable checkout. With a `uv tool` installation, omit the `.venv/bin/` prefix.

0.2.2 Conventional venv and pip alternative

If a compatible Python is already available, use whatever executable name the host provides; the example deliberately avoids assuming a version-suffixed command:

```
python3 -c 'import sys; assert (3, 12) <= sys.version_info < (3, 13), sys.version'
python3 -m venv .venv
.venv/bin/python -m pip install --upgrade pip
.venv/bin/python -m pip install /path/to/zlang_hdl-VERSION-py3-none-any.whl
```

For an editable development checkout, replace the final line with:

```
.venv/bin/python -m pip install -e '.[test]'
```

This fallback needs a compatible interpreter and `venv` support from the host. Do not replace or upgrade the operating system's own Python merely to install ZLang; use `uv` or an isolated virtual environment.

0.2.3 Windows through WSL2

The current release is tested as a Linux application, not as a native Windows Python package. On Windows 10/11, install WSL2 with an Ubuntu distribution, open the Ubuntu shell, and perform the Linux installation entirely inside it. For example:

```
sudo apt-get update
sudo apt-get install -y curl git build-essential
```

Then install `uv` using its official Linux instructions and follow the `uv` steps above. Keep active projects under the WSL Linux filesystem, for example `~/src/zlang_hdl`, rather than `/mnt/c/...`; this generally gives much better compiler, Git, `pytest` and `EDA-tool` filesystem

performance. Start VS Code through its WSL extension so the editor, zlang-lsp, Python environment and EDA executables all see the same Linux paths.

Inside a development checkout, these forms are equivalent:

```
.venv/bin/zlang examples/add.zhl --check
uv run --no-sync zlang examples/add.zhl --check
```

`uv run --no-sync` uses the already-created project environment without changing dependencies. The direct executable form is preferable in scripts because it makes the selected environment explicit.

0.2.4 Check and run ZLang

Check the installed commands:

```
.venv/bin/zlang --version
.venv/bin/zlang-lock --version
.venv/bin/zlang-verify --version
```

`zlang-lsp` is a JSON-RPC stdio server and is normally started by the bundled VS Code extension; it is not an interactive shell command. Point the extension at the environment's executable when automatic discovery is not appropriate:

```
{
  "zlang.lsp.path": "/absolute/path/to/.venv/bin/zlang-lsp"
}
```

Check a design and emit production direct SystemVerilog without installing any external EDA program:

```
.venv/bin/zlang examples/add.zhl --check
mkdir -p build
.venv/bin/zlang examples/add.zhl --systemverilog build/Add.sv
```

0.2.5 Choose which external tools you need

Task	Required external programs
Parse, type-check, emit SystemVerilog, use LSP	None
Strict RTL lint and selected RTL simulation	verilator
Generic synthesis	yosys
Formal BMC, proof and cover	yosys, sby, yosys-smtbmc, and z3
Selected event-driven simulation tests	iverilog and vvp

`yosys-smtbmc` is the Yosys SMT model-checking driver. It is the executable sometimes informally shortened to “BMC”; there is no ZLang dependency named `bmct`. ZLang's recorded formal route invokes the external `z3` executable through this driver. Installing only the Python `z3-solver` module is therefore not a substitute for putting `z3` on `PATH`.

0.2.6 Recommended: OSS CAD Suite

The simplest reproducible route is the official YosysHQ OSS CAD Suite. Its release archive provides Yosys, SymbiYosys, solvers and related open-source EDA tools together. Download the archive for the host platform from the [OSS CAD Suite releases](#), extract it, then either source its environment file for each shell:

```
source /absolute/path/to/oss-cad-suite/environment
```

or add its `bin` directory to `PATH`:

```
export PATH="/absolute/path/to/oss-cad-suite/bin:$PATH"
```

Use an absolute installation path. Do not copy individual binaries out of the suite because Yosys and SymbiYosys also use adjacent data and support files. See the upstream OSS CAD Suite installation instructions for supported archives and platform details.

Install Verilator separately when it is not supplied by the selected suite. A distribution package is convenient:

```
sudo apt-get update
sudo apt-get install verilator
```

Distribution versions vary. Follow the upstream [Verilator installation guide](#) when the release-tested version or a source build is required.

0.2.7 Alternative: install components separately

Component installation is useful for distribution packaging or when a pinned tool is maintained independently:

- install Yosys using the upstream [Yosys build/install instructions](#);
- install SymbiYosys using the upstream [SymbiYosys documentation](#);
- install the z3 command from the official [Z3 releases](#) or a suitable distribution package;
- install Verilator using its official guide [linked above](#);
- install Icarus Verilog from the host distribution when the selected test or simulation flow requires iverilog/vvp.

Keep all selected tool bin directories on the same PATH used to start ZLang, the terminal, CI job or VS Code. Mixed host/container installations are a common reason for a tool being visible interactively but unavailable to the compiler.

0.2.8 Verify the installation

```
verilator --version
yosys -V
sby --version
command -v yosys-smtbmc
z3 --version
iverilog -V
```

The following are **verified versions**: they are the versions used to produce this release's acceptance evidence. They are not universal minimums, maximums, or a claim that adjacent upstream versions are incompatible.

Component	Verified version	Purpose
Host	Linux x86-64	Release and regression host
CPython	3.12.3 (package range $\geq 3.12, < 3.13$)	Compiler, CLI and LSP runtime
Verilator	5.052	Strict RTL lint and behavioral simulation
Yosys	0.69	Generic synthesis and SMT preparation
SymbiYosys (sby)	0.69	Formal job orchestration
yosys-smtbmc	from verified Yosys installation	SMT model-checking driver
Z3	4.8.12	Verified external SMT solver
Icarus Verilog / vvp	14.0	Selected event-driven simulations

The machine-readable authority is [release/status.json](#). Consult it instead of copying this table into automation because it is updated with each release candidate. Other versions may work; validate them with the smoke tests relevant to the flow you intend to use. A detected executable is not, by itself, evidence that a formal or synthesis result is valid.

Run a real formal smoke test:

```
.venv/bin/zlang examples/verification/bounded_counter.zhl \
--verify --verify-require proven \
--formal-depth 16 --formal-timeout 45 \
--verification-bundle build/verify/counter \
--verification-work-dir build/verify-work/counter \
--verification-report build/verify/counter-result.txt
```

Expected exit status is zero. The capacity assertion should be proven, the `reaches_capacity` cover should be witnessed, and `exceeds_capacity` should be bounded_unreached. A bounded cover miss is not a proof of unreachability. See the runnable formal examples for a deliberate counterexample, scoped assumptions, immutable bundle replay and ready/valid checking.

0.2.9 Verification architecture and troubleshooting

Formal execution is opt-in. `--check`, normal compilation and SystemVerilog emission do not invoke a solver. `bounded_pass` is bounded evidence and is never reported as proven; unavailable tools or bindings remain explicit unknown/skipped according to the requested policy.

If a tool is not found, run the version commands above in the same environment that starts ZLang. If a proof is unknown, inspect the retained report and solver logs under `--verification-work-dir`; increasing depth or timeout does not turn an unsupported binding or reset model into an executable property.

0.3 Getting started

The representative executable language tour is [examples/all_syntax.zhl](#). It intentionally does not enumerate every legal composition or backend boundary. The [syntax support matrix](#) and compiler-owned capability registry distinguish supported, bounded, and deferred forms.

Physical ZLang HDL source files use the canonical `.zhl` suffix and MIME type `text/x-zlang-hdl`. Logical imports remain extension-independent. The former `.zl` spelling is intentionally rejected so these sources cannot be confused with the unrelated language that already owns that extension.

0.3.1 Install for development

This alpha release requires CPython `>=3.12,<3.13`. The recommended `uv` workflow does not require a suitable Python interpreter to be installed first; `uv` can download and manage the verified runtime. From the repository root:

```
uv venv --python '>=3.12,<3.13'
uv pip install -e '.[test]'
```

If a compatible interpreter is already available, the complete installation guide also documents a conventional `venv/pip` path without relying on a version-specific executable name. Windows users should run the Linux flow inside WSL2 rather than installing the compiler into native Windows Python.

The compiler and LSP do not require an EDA installation. Verilator, Yosys, SymbiYosys, `yosys-smtbmc`, Z3 and Icarus are optional external programs for the corresponding lint, synthesis, formal and simulation flows. See [Installing ZLang HDL and the external EDA toolchain](#) for the recommended OSS CAD Suite route, separate component installation, release-tested versions and a real formal smoke test.

Check a source file without creating backend artifacts:

```
.venv/bin/zlang examples/all_syntax.zhl --check
```

Without `--top`, `--check` validates every declared module. With `--top NAME`, it validates only that elaboration root. This is a semantic-only demand: it does not run implementation planning, formal execution, report rendering, or the SystemVerilog backend.

0.3.2 A first module

```
module Add {  
    in  a : u8  
    in  b : u8  
    out y : u9  
  
    y = a + b  
}
```

Hardware assignments are concurrent. Source order does not turn = into software-style sequencing. = drives a combinational value; <- schedules a register's next value at its clock edge.

Generate direct SystemVerilog and lint it:

```
.venv/bin/zlang examples/extended_add.zhl \  
--systemverilog build/ExtendedAdd.sv  
verilator --lint-only --top-module ExtendedAdd build/ExtendedAdd.sv
```

An explicit artifact path keeps stdout empty. Use --verbose for success messages on stderr. A bare invocation emits the production direct SystemVerilog artifact to stdout; use --check for semantic validation without emission.

0.3.3 Check named verification goals

Clocked modules can carry same-cycle safety and bounded-reachability goals:

```
assert count_within @ clk { count <= DEPTH }  
cover reaches_full @ clk { count == DEPTH }
```

Run the applicable existing safety verification safety families plus source goals:

```
.venv/bin/zlang design.zhl --top Top --verify \  
--formal-jobs 4 \  
--verification-report build/verification.txt \  
--verification-work-dir build/verification-work
```

Or publish a hash-validated bundle and replay it without recompiling source:

```
.venv/bin/zlang design.zhl --top Top \  
--verification-bundle build/verify  
.venv/bin/zlang-verify build/verify --mode bmc --depth 20 \  
--work-dir build/verify-work
```

bounded_pass means only that no counterexample was found through the stated depth. A cover reports witnessed or bounded_unreached; a cover miss is not a safety failure. A prove request runs BMC first and starts proof only when every safety job is bounded_pass. Covers run once and are not rerun; an unrelated cover does not block proof, while an unwitnessed feasibility cover makes its dependent safety result vacuous/unknown. Solver configurations, logs, and VCDs are retained in the external work directory; the immutable bundle is not modified. - -formal-jobs parallelizes independent bundled safety/cover jobs and independent selected-candidate sites. Stages inside one candidate site remain ordered; plans, evidence, and report order remain deterministic. Candidate semantic-reference equivalence jobs use deterministic subdirectories of that same external root; an exact in-session formal-aware selection reuse reports its retained root when one exists. Persistent proof-cache hits do not fabricate old workspace paths.

Each verification goal is routed against its own declared clock/reset pair. Goals in two supported synchronous domains can execute independently; an unsupported domain skips only goals in that domain. This does not add a cross-domain temporal property or change the general backend domain boundary.

The formal triggers are deliberately distinct:

- a non-off --formal-policy without --verify runs only the existing formal-aware selection selection-time semantic-reference equivalence gate;
- --verify with policy off runs safety verification/source safety and covers;
- --verification-bundle publishes the base safety/cover bundle and linking plan but does not prepare or execute selected-candidate semantic-reference equivalence;
- --verify with a non-off policy additionally executes the compatible selected-candidate direct-SV semantic-reference equivalence route.

0.3.4 Source files

A file may contain imports, type aliases, structs, pure functions, operator overloads, rewrite declarations, target/resource declarations, and one or more modules:

```
import std.math.complex

type Byte = u8

struct Pair<type T> {
    left  : T
    right : T
}

fn widen(x : Byte) -> u9 { extend<9>(x) }

module Example {
    in  x : Byte
    out y : u9 = widen(x)
}
```

Select a top explicitly when a file contains several modules:

```
.venv/bin/zlang design.zhl --top Example --check
```

Names are case-sensitive. There are no semicolons. Line comments use //. Non-nested block comments use /* ... */; both forms are lexical whitespace. Decimal, hexadecimal (0x), and binary (0b/0B) integer literals may contain valid underscore separators.

0.3.5 Reading common notation

Form	Meaning
name = expression	Drive a combinational value or resource control.
state <- expression	Schedule next-state at the active edge.
source -> destination	Connect typed endpoints or bind a command.
key => expression	Select a switch/choice arm.
thing @ clk	Associate a declaration with a clock domain.
field @ 7:4	Place a CSR field.
object.field	Select an aggregate, protocol, or resource member.
values[index]	Read a range-proven vector element; the selector may be runtime.
raw[index] for bits<N>	Read one LSB-zero packed bit; the selector must resolve at compile time.

ZLang requires exact canonical types at assignment boundaries. It never silently truncates, extends, performs a numeric signed/unsigned conversion, or rescales fixed-point values. Equal-width raw boundaries involving bits<N> or flat vec<N,bit> are the documented representation-only exception; use bitcast<T> explicitly when the boundary is not already typed.

0.3.6 Where to continue

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- [Expressions, functions, and generics](#)
- [Sequential logic, rules, and storage](#)
- [Hierarchy, protocols, and composition](#)
- [Optimization and formal verification](#)
- [Backends, CLI, and tooling](#)
- [Standard library](#)
- [Reproducible projects and dependencies](#)
- [Named module interfaces](#)
- [Validated real designs](#)
- [Complete language guide index](#)

0.4 Types, numerics, and packed representation

ZLang types describe hardware representation exactly. Width, signedness, fixed-point scale, vector length, struct identity, and fixed-point overflow policy participate in typing and canonical identity.

0.4.1 Characters, fixed strings, and tuples

`char` is a source alias for canonical `u8`; it is intentionally not a separate nominal type. `string<N>` is a source alias for the corresponding fixed hardware collection and normalizes to canonical `vec<N, u8>`:

```
letter : char = 'A'
tag : string<4> = "OFDM"
joined = concat("802.", "11a")
```

Literals contain printable ASCII directly and may use `\0`, `\n`, `\r`, `\t`, `\\`, `\'`, `\"`, or an exact `\xNN` byte. Strings have no hidden terminator or length field and cannot be empty. They inherit vector indexing, equality, length, `generate/map`, homogeneous concatenation, pure functions, generic specialization, and typed compile-time constant parameters. Registers, FIFOs, synchronous memories, and ROMs store them with the same semantics as `vec<N, u8>`. When packed, the first character is the least-significant byte (`pack("AB") == 0x4241`). Unicode, interpolation, formatting, padding, and dynamic-length strings are not implicit operations.

Tuples are structural ordered aggregates. Tuple types use `(T,U)` and tuple values use the same positional spelling:

```
pair : (u8, bit) = (data, last)
payload = pair[0]
(next_data, next_last) = pair
```

Tuple arity is 2 through 8. Projection is a zero-based integer literal and flat destructuring introduces exhaustive immutable bindings. Nested tuple values are legal, but nested/wildcard patterns, runtime tuple selection, tuple update, arithmetic, and ordering are not. Exact `==/!=` is structural. Component zero occupies the most-significant packed region; `pack/bitcast` require every component to satisfy the ordinary non-enum packing rules.

`char` is indistinguishable from `u8` during overload resolution, and `string<N>` is indistinguishable from `vec<N, u8>`. Tuple identity, by contrast, is the recursive ordered sequence of component types.

0.4.2 Nominal enums

Enums give control state a nominal hardware type without exposing a numeric encoding in source:

```
enum State { Idle Header Payload Done }
```

```
reg state : State = State.Idle
active = state == State.Payload
```

Members use qualified names. Their declaration-order ordinals are encoded in $\max(1, \text{ceil_log2}(\text{member_count}))$ bits, so a one-member enum still occupies one bit. The encoding is a stable storage/backend ABI, but enum values are not integers: arithmetic, ordering, resizing, and cross-enum comparison are errors. Equality and inequality require the same nominal enum declaration.

When an external encoding is part of the hardware contract, the representation can instead be declared explicitly:

```
enum WifiRate : bits<3> {
  Continue = 0
  Bpsk6 = 1
  Qpsk12 = 2
  Qam16_24 = 4
}
```

Every member then requires one unique code fitting the exact `bits<W>` backing type. Declaration order still controls exhaustive source selection, while the declared sparse code is the physical representation. Mixing explicit and implicit members is an error. The ordinal form above remains unchanged.

Raw boundaries use total, typed operations rather than enum casts:

```
raw      : bits<3> = enum_encode(rate)
valid    : bit = enum_valid<WifiRate>(raw)
decoded  : WifiRate =
  enum_decode<WifiRate>(raw, WifiRate.Continue)
```

`enum_encode` is lossless. `enum_valid<T>` recognizes exactly the declared codes. `enum_decode<T>` returns its required same-enum fallback for every hole in the encoding, so invalid raw bits never become an invalid nominal value. These operations perform no resize and accept no signed/integer substitute.

Enums may appear in locals, outputs, registers/rules, structs, and vectors. A top-level enum input is intentionally rejected in this first slice because an external invalid bit pattern would violate the nominal value invariant. General `unpack<Enum>` is likewise deferred. Exhaustive selection is described under [operators and selection](#).

0.4.3 Nominal tagged unions

A tagged union represents one of several named payload shapes without exposing raw tag arithmetic:

```
union Message {
  Idle
  Data { value : u8 }
  Error { code : bits<4> }
}

message : Message = Message.Data { value = input }
result : u8 = match message {
  Message.Idle => 0
  Message.Data { value } => value
  Message.Error { code } => extend<8>(code)
}
```

The nominal declaration identity is part of the type. The source-order tag is stored in the most-significant bits; fields occupy the maximum-width payload in source order and shorter payloads receive zero low-order padding. A fieldless constructor is written `Message.Idle`. Every pure match is exhaustive, names each variant once, and binds exactly the declared fields. See [the complete bounded surface](#).

0.4.4 Scalar families

Spelling	Meaning
<code>bit</code>	A one-bit control value, distinct from integers and raw bits.
<code>uN, uint<N></code>	An N-bit unsigned integer.
<code>sN, sint<N></code>	An N-bit two's-complement signed integer.
<code>bits<N></code>	An N-bit raw vector without integer arithmetic.
<code>fixed<W,F></code>	Signed fixed point, W total bits and F fractional bits, wrapping target narrowing.
<code>ufixed<W,F></code>	Unsigned fixed point with wrapping target narrowing.
<code>fixed_sat<W,F></code>	Signed fixed point with saturating target narrowing.
<code>ufixed_sat<W,F></code>	Unsigned fixed point with saturating target narrowing.

Widths are positive compile-time integers. Fixed-point types additionally require $0 \leq F < W$. The families are distinct: no implicit signed/unsigned, integer/raw-bit, or integer/fixed conversion is performed.

Aliases disappear during typing:

```
type Address = uint<32>
type Payload = bits<64>
```

Alias cycles, duplicate declarations, and redefinition of built-ins are errors.

0.4.5 Integer width rules

An unsuffixed integer literal has the smallest exact hardware type implied by its value. Non-negative literals are unsigned; syntactic negative literals are signed two's-complement values:

Literal	Inferred type
0, 1	u1
2, 3	u2
255	u8
-1	s1
-2	s2
-3, -4	s3
-123	s8

Decimal, hexadecimal, and binary spellings with the same value infer the same type; leading zeros do not request storage width. A direct literal at an explicitly typed assignment, field, argument, or return boundary instead uses that target type when the value fits exactly. An out-of-range literal is an error. Context never recursively resizes a compound expression, so `concat(0,1)` and `0 + 1` retain the types derived by their own operators.

Unary `-` applied to a non-literal remains ordinary typed arithmetic. It does not reinterpret an unsigned signal as a signed one.

Expression	Result
<code>uN + uM</code>	<code>u(max(N,M)+1)</code>
<code>sN + sM</code>	<code>s(max(N,M)+1)</code>
<code>uN - uM</code>	<code>u(max(N,M))</code> , modular underflow

Expression	Result
$sN - sM$	$s(\max(N,M)+1)$
same-family $N * M$	Width $N+M$
$\&, , ^$	Matching family, widest operand width
shifts	The left operand's exact type and width
comparisons	bit

Addition and multiplication preserve carry bits. A left shift discards bits beyond its fixed result width. Signed right shift is arithmetic; unsigned and raw-bit right shift is logical.

Use explicit resizing:

```
wide = extend<17>(value)
low  = truncate<8>(wide)
```

`extend<N>` preserves signedness behavior and `truncate<N>` keeps low bits. Neither changes the type family.

At an explicitly typed output, local, register write, storage write, child binding, struct field, or declared function-return boundary, the width may be obtained from that boundary while the conversion remains explicit:

```
low : u8 = truncate(wide)
wide_again : u17 = extend(low)
```

The contextual and explicit-width forms normalize to the same typed resize. An inferred local, a nested arithmetic operand, or a mismatched type family has no such context and must keep `truncate<N>` or `extend<N>`.

0.4.6 Fixed point

Concrete spellings expose integer and fractional widths directly:

Spelling	Canonical type	Narrowing policy
SF8.8	<code>fixed<16,8></code>	wrap
SF_Sat8.8	<code>fixed_sat<16,8></code>	saturate
UF8.8	<code>ufixed<16,8></code>	wrap
UF_Sat8.8	<code>ufixed_sat<16,8></code>	saturate

For signed values the integer part includes the sign bit. SF8.8 therefore represents -128.0 through 127.99609375 in steps of 2^{-8} .

Arithmetic is widened before any storage conversion. Fixed addition and subtraction require equal fractional widths; multiplication returns total width $W1+W2$ and fractional width $F1+F2$. Target overflow policy applies only at an explicit or contextual storage conversion, not after every intermediate node.

Direct fixed-point literals must be exactly representable and in range, even for a saturating target. Loss is explicit:

```
y = quantize<SF_Sat8.8>(value) {
    round nearest_even
    overflow saturate
}
```

Supported rounding modes are `toward_zero`, `floor`, `away_zero`, and `nearest_even`. Conversion order is exact rescale, rounding, then overflow. `fixed_raw(0x0C22)` creates a target-context raw pattern; `fixed_to_raw` exposes the stored integer.

An exact fixed-point dot (a, b) retains the full accumulator. If the destination reduces fractional precision, give one post-accumulation rounding mode:

```
out y : SF_Sat8.8
y = dot(coefficients, samples, floor)
```

0.4.7 Vectors and structs

`vec<N,T>` has a compile-time length:

```
in samples : vec<4,u8>
```

An explicitly typed boundary can use a non-empty vector literal or contextual replication:

```
pair      : vec<2,u8> = [left, right]
zeros     : vec<4,u8> = repeat(0)
zeros_2   : vec<4,u8> = repeat<4>(0)
```

Every element must have the exact contextual element type. `repeat(value)` requires the destination vector to provide its length; `repeat<N>(value)` makes the length explicit. Both forms retain ordinary vector sequence order and lower to the existing typed generation representation.

Constant indexes are checked during elaboration. Runtime reads are accepted only when conservative range analysis proves every encoded value in range; ZLang does not silently mask or clamp. A rule may update one range-proven element of a one-dimensional reg `vec<N,T>` atomically. Nested paths, multiple dynamic writes to the same register action group, and runtime-selected instances remain unsupported; see [Sequential logic, rules, and storage](#).

Structs are nominal products:

```
struct Packet {
    data : u64
    last : bit
}

packet = Packet { data = payload last }
```

Constructors are complete and may use same-name field punning. An immutable update rebuilds the same nominal struct and preserves fields not named in the update:

```
completed = packet with { last = 1 }
```

Unknown or duplicate fields and values of the wrong exact field type are rejected. This is a pure value expression, not mutation. Recursive layouts are still rejected. Generic structs are covered in [Expressions, functions, and generics](#).

Structural `==` and `!=` are available for exact matching struct and vector types. Comparison is recursive over every field/element and returns bit; it does not perform conversion, resizing, or nominal coercion.

An immutable nominal struct can also be deconstructed exhaustively:

```
Packet { data, last } = packet
```

Every declared field must appear exactly once, under its declared name, and the new immutable bindings may not shadow another symbol. Deconstructing lowers to ordinary typed field values; it does not add tuple patterns, partial patterns, renaming, mutation, or runtime matching.

0.4.8 Slicing, concatenation, and representation

An inclusive, compile-time bit slice returns raw bits:

```
in word : u16
out byte : bits<8>
byte = word[15:8]
```

Both MSB and LSB are compile-time integer expressions. The result is bits<MSB-LSB+1>. Reversed, negative, runtime, or out-of-range bounds are errors; slicing never resizes, reinterprets, or clamps its operand.

A bits<N> value also supports concise single-bit selection:

```
in raw : bits<24>
out lsb : bit = raw[0]
out msb : bit = raw[23]
```

Packed indices use conventional bit numbering: index zero is the least-significant bit, exactly as [0:0]. The selector must currently resolve at compile time, including inside generate; a runtime selector is rejected instead of being silently converted into a mux. Vector element zero likewise occupies the least-significant packed element region.

concat(a,b,...) accepts at least two operands. When every operand is a vector with the exact same element type it returns one longer vector, preserving source and element order:

```
in left  : vec<2,u8>
in right : vec<3,u8>
out all  : vec<5,u8>
all = concat(left, right) // left[0], left[1], right[0], right[1], right[2]
```

Otherwise no operand may be a vector and all operands must be recursively bit-packable. The result is raw bits<N> and the first operand occupies the most-significant bits:

```
joined = concat(high, low) // high is the MSB portion
```

Each scalar operand is typed independently, before the result width is known. For example, concat(0,1) is bits<2> and concat(3,0) is bits<3>. Neither an assignment target nor a function caller may widen an operand or the completed concatenation implicitly.

Exact packed fill constants are available without manufacturing a numeric literal of the desired width:

```
clear_mask : bits<24> = zeros<24>
set_mask   : bits<24> = ones<24>
```

The width is a positive compile-time integer expression. Both forms produce exact bits<N> values and lower to ordinary constants; they are not vector replication. The separate zero<x>/ones<x> spellings inside an equiv declaration remain typed pattern constants rather than hardware expressions.

Vector/scalar mixtures and different vector element types are errors. Convert a vector explicitly with bitcast<bits<W>> when raw bit assembly is intended.

reshape(value) obtains a vector target shape from an explicitly typed context; reshape<T>(value) supplies it directly. Reshape recursively enumerates leaves outer-to-inner, then rebuilds the requested shape without packing them:

```
in matrix : vec<2,vec<4,u8>>
out flat  : vec<8,u8>
flat = reshape(matrix)
matrix_again = reshape<vec<2,vec<4,u8>>>(flat)
```

Source and target must be vectors with the same leaf count and exact same leaf type. Reshape has no endianness and performs no numerical conversion.

bitcast<T>(value) exposes or reconstructs the exact stored representation when source and target have equal packed width and both are recursively bit-packable and non-enum. It never resizes, sign-extends, truncates, rescales, rounds, or saturates:

```
raw      : bits<8> = bitcast<bits<8>>(signed_value)
signed : s8       = bitcast<s8>(raw)
```

`pack(value)` and `unpack<T>(raw)` remain supported low-level compatibility spellings and normalize to the same typed Bitcast operation. Signed integers and signed fixed-point values use their stored two's-complement pattern.

Aggregate layout is deterministic and backend-independent:

- struct field zero (declaration order) is at the MSB;
- vector element zero is at the LSB;
- tuple component `item0` is at the LSB;
- nested vectors and tuples apply the LSB-first rule recursively;
- nested structs retain declaration-order/MSB-first field layout.

The initialized `rom<T,N>` image format uses this same layout for each word. Images contain one exact-width binary word per line with address zero first; they do not inherit host byte order. Consequently simulator values and direct-SV `$readmemb` agree on nested aggregate and fixed-point ROM contents. See [Initialized synchronous ROMs](#).

Scalar numeric/raw types and recursively bit-packable structs, vectors, and structural tuples are accepted. Nominal enums, including an aggregate containing an enum, are intentionally rejected by `bitcast`, `pack`, and `unpack`. Enum ordinal storage remains available through ordinary typed values and `reshape`, but raw construction could create an invalid ordinal and therefore requires a future reviewed validity policy.

At explicitly typed assignment/storage boundaries, ZLang may insert an equal-width raw bitcast only when either source or target is `bits<N>` or `flat vec<N,bit>`. This makes raw wiring concise while preserving the rule that direct signed-to-unsigned, integer-to-fixed, resizing, and rescaling conversions are never implicit. Raw conversion does not participate in function arguments, operator overloads, generic inference, switch branch unification, or protocol compatibility.

Scalar `reduce(&, value)`, `reduce(|, value)`, and `reduce(^, value)` reduce the stored bits of `bit`, `bits<N>`, `uN`, or `sN` and return `bit`. `parity(value)` is the concise XOR form and also accepts `vec<N,bit>`. Existing vector reduction still reduces elements and returns the element type; fixed-point and struct scalars are not representation-bit reduction operands.

0.4.9 Current boundaries

Runtime packed-bit selection, runtime/reversed/out-of-range slicing, zero or unresolved packed widths, one-operand or heterogeneous-vector concatenation, runtime reshape, unequal-width bitcast, enum bitcast, and external top enum inputs remain deliberately rejected. These boundaries are diagnosed rather than inferred by a backend. See the [syntax support matrix](#).

0.5 Expressions, functions, and generics

ZLang expressions are pure typed hardware values unless they explicitly contain a timing construct. Assignment requires an exact canonical target type.

0.5.1 Operators and selection

From highest to lowest precedence:

1. calls, parentheses, aggregate selection, conversions, functional forms;
2. unary `-` and logical `!`;
3. `*`, and compile-time `/`;
4. `+`, binary `-`;
5. `<<`, `>>`;
6. `&`, then `^`, then `|`;

7. `==`, `!=`, `<`, `<=`, `>`, `>=`;
8. `&&`, then `||` in compile-time/equivalence guards;
9. right-associative condition `? true_value : false_value`.

Unary - is implemented for numeric scalar/fixed types and may be overloaded for a nominal struct. It is not a general implicit-cast mechanism. Runtime logical `!` accepts exactly bit and returns bit; it is equivalent to an exact comparison with zero. `/`, `&&`, and `||` are available only where the compile-time/equivalence sublanguage accepts them; they do not infer runtime divider or general truthiness for multi-bit hardware values.

Two-way runtime selection can use `?:` or `mux`:

```
y = select ? a : b
y = mux(select, a, b)
```

The condition is bit and both arms have one exact type. Numeric switch requires unique fitting keys and an else arm:

```
y = switch opcode {
  0 => a
  1 => b
  else => 0
}
```

A switch over a nominal enum uses qualified members and must cover every member. It needs no catch-all arm, which keeps a newly added state from silently taking an old default path:

```
next = switch state {
  State.Idle => State.Header
  State.Header => State.Payload
  State.Payload => State.Done
  State.Done => State.Idle
}
```

Numeric keys in an enum switch, members from another enum, duplicate members, and incomplete coverage are errors. Numeric switches retain their existing mandatory else behavior.

Nominal tagged unions use the parallel exhaustive match expression. Each arm names its union and variant and binds the exact source-declared payload names; there is no default arm or hidden priority:

```
y = match message {
  Message.Idle => 0
  Message.Data { value } => value
}
```

Typing lowers this surface to an ordinary exact-width switch over the union tag plus typed field projections before canonical optimization and backend emission.

Exact matching structs, vectors, and structural tuples also support `==` and `!=`. These comparisons recursively combine the ordinary exact leaf comparisons and return bit; mismatched nominal structs, vector lengths, tuple component order/arity, or element types are errors.

0.5.2 Aggregate value ergonomics

Vector literals and replication use their explicit destination type:

```
pair : vec<2,u8> = [left, right]
zeros : vec<4,u8> = repeat(0)
```

`repeat<N>(value)` may state the compile-time length explicitly. The contextual and explicit forms lower to the same existing vector-generation semantics. Struct update is likewise a pure expression over an existing nominal value:

```
next = current with { valid = 1 payload = replacement }
```

It preserves omitted fields and lowers to a complete typed struct construction; it does not create mutable records or a backend-specific update operation. Exhaustive Struct { field, ... } = value destructuring similarly lowers to ordinary immutable field bindings. It requires every field exactly once and does not provide partial patterns, renaming, or runtime pattern matching. Flat tuple destructuring (first, second) = pair likewise evaluates one RHS and introduces fresh immutable projections. Nested, wildcard, and rest patterns remain outside this bounded surface.

0.5.3 Pure functions

Functions are top-level, pure, and combinational. The smallest body is one result expression:

```
fn tap(sample : u8, coefficient : u8) -> u16 {  
    sample * coefficient  
}
```

They may call other non-recursive pure functions. They cannot capture module ports or contain state, clocks, delays, protocols, or pipelines. Return types may be explicit or inferred for both ordinary and generic functions:

```
fn make_tag(high : bits<2>) {  
    concat(high, zeros<2>, ones<2>)  
}
```

An inferred body is checked without a caller-provided expected type, and its exact final-expression type becomes the function signature. Forward references are resolved independent of declaration order. Direct or indirect inferred return cycles are rejected; ZLang does not attempt a recursive type fixed point. For ordinary functions, explicit and inferred spellings with the same exact signature lower to the same callable identity. Generic specialization identity continues to include the generic declaration form and its exact specialization arguments.

A body may introduce sequential immutable bindings without let, const, or return; the final expression is the result:

```
struct Pair<type T> { left : T right : T }  
  
fn duplicate_sum<type T>(a : T, b : T) {  
    exact = a + b  
    Pair { left = exact right = exact }  
}
```

Each binding has its exact inferred type, may reference parameters and earlier bindings, and cannot shadow or be reassigned. Forward references and module captures are rejected. This syntax is normalized into the same concrete typed expression/call IR as the nested expression spelling.

Source units are declaration-order independent: functions, structs, enums, and modules may be declared after their users, and a shipped library unit may contain declarations without a hardware top. Parameterized modules can state compile-time obligations at specialization:

```
module Queue<type T,D=4>  
where D >= 2 && is_power_of_two(D) {  
    // ...  
}
```

The constraint is checked against exact type/value arguments and creates no runtime hardware.

0.5.3.1 Typed constants and statically selected functions

Module and generic-function specializations may carry required named compile-time constants and pure function references:

```
fn widen(x : u8) -> u9 { extend<9>(x) }

fn transform_with<
  type A,
  type B,
  operation : fn(A) -> B
>(x : A) {
  operation(x)
}

module ImageBank<type T,N,IW,image : vec<N,T>> {
  clock clk
  reset rst
  in address : uint<IW>
  out data : T

  rom table : rom<T,N> { read_latency 1 init image }
  table.read_address = address
  data = table.read_data
}
```

These argument kinds are always named: `image=image` and `operation=fn widen`. A generic target may be selected explicitly, for example `operation=fn widen_as<A=u8,B=u9>`. Constants must have the exact declared, recursively bit-packable non-enum type and must evaluate completely during elaboration. A function reference must be pure and match the exact parameter and return types; it is not a runtime function pointer and cannot be stored, returned, compared, or carried through hardware ports.

Type and integer shape parameters resolve before constant/function parameters. The compiler retains a typed binding record containing the canonical constant value or exact callable identity, dependency closure, evaluator schema, and content digest. Source spelling is absent from semantic, artifact, and cache identity. Defaults for constant/function parameters are intentionally not part of this first bounded slice.

0.5.4 Compile-time functions and selection

Compile-time evaluation is bounded and deterministic. Structural intrinsics are compiler-owned, not `stdlib` overloads:

- `length(vector)`;
- `floor_log2(n)`, `ceil_log2(n)`, `index_width(n)`, `is_power_of_two(n)`;
- `pi()`, `sin(x)`, `cos(x)`, `log2(x)`, and `log(base,x)`.

Real intrinsics use a versioned decimal evaluator rather than host binary floating point. A non-integral real enters hardware only through explicit fixed-point quantization.

`index_width(n)` is the storage width for an index into `n` elements: `max(1, ceil_log2(n))`. Its argument must be a positive compile-time integer expression. Integer parameter defaults are resolved in declaration order and may reference only earlier parameters:

```
module Table<N=8,IW=index_width(N)> { ... }
```

A forward reference such as `module Bad<IW=index_width(N),N=8>` is rejected.

Specialization-time `if` accepts value parameters and canonical type parameters:

```
fn type_flag<type T>(x : T) {
  if T == u8 { 1 } else { 0 }
}
```

```

module Stage<D=1> {
  out y : u8
  if D == 1 { y = 1 } else { y = 2 }
}

```

Only the selected branch is semantically checked. Runtime signals are rejected in compile-time conditions with a suggestion to use `?:`, `mux`, `switch`, or a guarded action.

0.5.5 Functional datapath

Ranges are half-open and compile-time bounded:

```

products = generate(i in 0..8) a[i] * b[i]
doubled  = map(i in 0..8) { a[i] + a[i] }
y        = reduce(+, products)
z        = sum(i in 0..8) a[i] * b[i]
d        = dot(a, b)

```

`generate` and `map` produce `vec<N,T>`. `reduce` supports `+`, `*`, `&`, `|`, and `^`; `sum` is addition reduction. Reduction order is a deterministic source-order balanced tree, so finite-width intermediate types are stable across backends. `dot` uses full-width products followed by that same reduction.

For a nominal struct element, only `sum/reduce(+, ...)` is defined. Every internal node resolves the ordinary exact operator `+` overload for the two types produced by its children; the overload result is the exact type presented to the next node. Small and otherwise ineligible reductions retain that complete typed tree directly. Eligible large pure bounded regions instead retain a `FunctionalRegion` plus an `ExactReductionPlan`; the plan records the same balanced topology, exact intermediate result types, and resolved overload/callee identity without cloning every call body. These are two storage forms for one language contract, not two reduction semantics.

There is no component-wise field rule, implicit conversion, identity insertion, or special case for `Complex`. exact reduction planning and the e-graph do not reassociate the frozen tree, and explicit quantization remains exactly where the source or overload body placed it.

Range bounds may use resolved module value parameters. Runtime ranges, empty value-producing ranges, and unbounded generation are rejected.

Compile-time iterator arithmetic is mathematical integer arithmetic. It does not require hardware extend/truncate noise:

```

reversed = generate(i in 0..48) bits[47 - i]

```

For a vector, `values[first..past_last]` is a half-open compile-time range and lowers to the same ordered static element references as the corresponding vector literal. It is not a runtime slice and does not change packed bit-slice syntax `raw[MSB:LSB]`.

A functional iterator is a compile-time integer and may feed a generic value specialization directly or through a bounded constant expression:

```

fn coefficient<K>() -> u8 { K }

values = generate(k in 0..4) coefficient<K=k>()
next   = map(k in 0..4) { coefficient<K=k+1>() }
total  = sum(k in 0..4) coefficient<K=k>()

```

The evaluated value, not the binder spelling, participates in specialization identity. Runtime values are not specialization constants, and an iterator binder cannot shadow a module parameter.

0.5.5.1 Scalable bounded functional elaboration

Large compile-time generate/map regions with a binder-invariant result type may use the compact functional representation described above. The compiler still type-checks the region with the ordinary exact rules and counts its logical elements against the same bounded generation budget (currently at most 4096); it does not defer type checking to a backend or create run-time loops. Callable specializations remain ordinary monomorphic definitions, and each use retains its own source origin.

The accepted whole-vector IFFT64 reference exercises an outer 64-lane generate, 64 exact products per lane, nominal complex reduction, and one final quantization. $N=64$ is validated through semantic analysis, canonical round-trip, and the simulator; $N=8/N=16$ exercise direct SystemVerilog and Verilator. This evidence does not claim full 4096-multiplier $N=64$ RTL or a production streaming architecture. See the 802.11a validation report for the measured boundary and the later streaming implementation.

A fully compile-time generated vector may initialize an immutable ROM without external source generation:

```
fn coefficients<N>() {
    generate(i in 0..N) truncate<8>(i * i)
}

rom table : rom<u8,N> {
    read_latency 1
    init coefficients<N=N>()
}
```

The complete transitive function/intrinsic dependency identity participates in the ROM and companion hashes. Compile-time functions still have no filesystem, network, process, clock, state, random, or environment access; only the compiler publishes a validated image. The initializer must resolve to exactly the declared vector shape and element type.

0.5.6 Typed bit and collection composition

Bit slicing and composition are expressions rather than backend spellings:

```
high   : bits<4> = word[7:4]
flag   : bit = word[0]
joined : bits<8> = concat(high, word[3:0])
same    : u8 = bitcast<u8>(joined)
flat    : vec<8,u8> = reshape(matrix)
```

Slices use inclusive compile-time [MSB:LSB] bounds. A single packed-bit selection `raw[index]` returns bit, uses conventional LSB-zero numbering, and currently requires a compile-time-proven index. Vector sequence indexing uses the same low-first convention: `vec` element zero occupies the least-significant packed element region. Scalar `concat` places its first operand at the MSB; homogeneous-vector `concat` preserves collection order and returns a vector. `reshape` changes only nested vector shape. `bitcast<T>` uses the canonical layout described in [Types and numerics](#): struct declaration field zero is at the MSB, while vector element zero and tuple `item0` are at the LSB. It requires exact packed width and performs no resize or scale change. A source or target containing a nominal enum is rejected; enum representation is not a public bitcast contract. `pack` and `unpack<T>` remain low-level compatibility spellings.

For representation-bit checks, `reduce(^, scalar)` and `parity(scalar)` operate on the stored bits of bit, raw bits, and signed/unsigned integers. Reducing a general vector retains the existing element-wise reduction semantics.

0.5.7 Generic structs, functions, and operators

Generic parameters have explicit kinds:

```

struct Pair<type T> { left:T right:T }

fn duplicate<type T>(x:T) { x + x }

module Use {
  in x : u8
  out y : u9
  y = duplicate(x)
}

```

Calls support exact call-site inference or explicit specialization. Generic struct constructors infer their specialization from fields where unambiguous. Every accepted call is monomorphic; there is no runtime dispatch.

A direct integer literal may use a concrete formal argument type after explicit generic arguments or non-literal arguments have fixed that type:

```

same<T=u16>(1)
combine(1, existing_u16)
combine(existing_u16, 1)

```

If a type is inferable only from literals, each literal first receives its own minimum-width exact type and normal exact unification applies. Argument order does not select a wider type. Compound expressions never receive this literal-only contextual treatment.

Libraries may overload binary `+`, `-`, `*` and unary `-` for nominal structs. Built-in scalar/fixed operations cannot be replaced. Resolution uses exact type unification, prefers an exact concrete overload over a generic one, performs no implicit conversion, and enforces nominal-owner coherence. Specialized bodies are retained once as deterministic monomorphic callable definitions. Each use site is a typed `Call` carrying the exact callee identity, signature, result type, and its own source origin. Analyses that require concrete arithmetic use the shared bounded call-expansion service; nominal reductions remain opaque to exact reduction planning and the frozen e-graph rewrite set. Direct SystemVerilog emits one function automatic per specialization rather than cloning the body at every call site.

`std.math.complex` is ordinary ZLang source defining `Complex<T>`, arithmetic operators, `Butterfly<S,D>`, and explicit component quantization. For example:

```

Complex<fixed<18,16>> * Complex<fixed<16,14>>
-> Complex<fixed<35,30>>

```

The scale-30 result cannot be added to a scale-16 value until explicitly quantized. Its `complex_sum(values)` helper is a discoverability alias that returns the same typed `Reduce` as `sum(values)`; it adds no compiler behavior. Generics and nominal reductions do not imply rescaling, rounding, saturation, or casts.

Traits, runtime polymorphism, generic methods, function-name overloading, higher-order functions, recursion extensions, and implicit conversions remain outside the current slice.

0.6 Sequential state, rules, pipelines, and storage

ZLang keeps combinational values, next-state actions, timing, storage, and physical clock ownership explicit in typed IR. Synchronous active-high reset is the default. Each independently declared clock has one reset contract and may own ordinary state in the same module.

0.6.1 Clock and reset

Single-domain modules declare one pair:

```

clock clk
reset rst

```

Because newlines are ordinary whitespace, the compact adjacent spelling is equivalent and introduces no combined declaration or inferred domain:

```
clock clk reset rst
```

Clock and reset are declared together. Multiple domains require explicit reset, port, and state ownership wherever inference would be ambiguous:

```
clock source_clock
reset source_reset @source_clock

clock destination_clock
reset destination_reset @destination_clock

reg source_count : u32 @source_clock = 0
reg destination_count : u32 @destination_clock = 0

rule TickSource @source_clock when 1 {
    source_count <- truncate<32>(source_count + 1)
}

rule TickDestination @destination_clock when 1 {
    destination_count <- truncate<32>(destination_count + 2)
}
```

An unannotated stateful declaration remains concise in a single-clock module. In a multi-clock module its domain may be inferred from one unique destination or dynamic operand domain; otherwise analysis reports `ZL-DOMAIN-AMBIGUOUS`. Constants are domain-neutral. Combining dynamic values from different domains, including through an unannotated local, reports `ZL-DOMAIN-CROSSING`.

Rules and priorities are scheduled within a domain. Rules in unrelated domains do not acquire cross-clock mutual exclusion or atomicity. FSM-generated state and rules inherit the FSM annotation. Exact pipeline(N) @clk { ... }, FIFO, memory, ROM, and CSR state similarly retain one resolved owner; inserted pipeline and balancing registers never act as CDC.

Implicit clock-domain crossing is always rejected. See [Hierarchy and protocols](#).

The recommended asynchronous spelling asserts immediately and releases only after two active clock edges:

```
clock clk
async reset arst_n @clk { polarity active_low }
```

Normal state transition resumes on the third edge after external deassertion. The low-level `reset ... { mode asynchronous ... }` spelling retains raw native deassertion for compatibility. Exact polarity, falling-edge behavior, hierarchical propagation, and unsupported formal/target routes are documented in the [physical clock/reset contract](#).

0.6.2 Registers and next state

```
reg count : u8 = 0
count <- truncate<8>(count + 1)
```

The explicit multi-clock spelling places the annotation before the initializer:

```
reg count : u8 @datapath_clk = 0
```

Expressions read committed beginning-of-cycle state. All accepted `<-` updates become visible together at the active edge. A register without an accepted update holds. Reset restores the declared constant. Multiple unordered writers are rejected.

Control registers may use nominal enums. Reset and next-state values must be members of the exact same declaration, and an exhaustive enum switch is the preferred finite-state-machine spelling:

```
enum Phase { Idle Active Done }
reg phase : Phase = Phase.Idle
phase <- switch phase {
  Phase.Idle => start ? Phase.Active : Phase.Idle
  Phase.Active => finish ? Phase.Done : Phase.Active
  Phase.Done => Phase.Idle
}
```

The semantic simulator and direct SystemVerilog share the declaration-order ordinal encoding. The source-authored APB bridge in [stdlib/bus/apb.zhl](#) uses an enum for its internal phase without exposing it through the external bus ABI.

For control-oriented state, fsm is concise syntax for the same enum register and guarded atomic rules:

```
enum TxPhase { Idle Header Payload Done }

fsm phase = TxPhase.Idle {
  Idle {
    when start -> Header { remaining <- length }
  }
  Header { when header_sent -> Payload {} }
  Payload {
    priority {
      when abort -> Idle {}
      when last -> Done {}
    }
  }
  Done { -> Idle {} }
}
```

The qualified initial member in `fsm phase = TxPhase.Idle` infers the exact nominal enum type. The explicit compatibility spelling `fsm phase : TxPhase = Idle` remains accepted; neither form infers from guards, actions, or transition targets.

Every member appears exactly once. A state body is hold, one transition, or an explicit priority block; source order never creates hidden priority. The state update and transition actions form one ordinary atomic rule, reset restores the declared initial member, and direct writes to the generated state register are rejected. fsm is lowered before canonical/backend IR and does not add a second scheduler or runtime procedural if.

The production Wi-Fi IeeeIFFTInputStrip is a second source-authored witness: its Data/Flush FSM atomically starts and retires a 64-transfer zero-frame flush, holds under backpressure, and returns to Data after the last accepted sample. Mid-flush reset restores the declared initial state and discards the incomplete protocol epoch.

0.6.2.1 Runtime-indexed vector register updates

A one-dimensional vector register supports one range-proven runtime element write in an action group:

```
reg samples : vec<64,u8> = generate(i in 0..64) 0

when capture {
  samples[index] <- value
}
```

This is exactly `samples <- VectorUpdate(samples,index,value)` over the beginning-of-cycle snapshot. The unsigned index must be statically proven in range. A second dynamic or static

write to the same vector register conflicts; nested paths, slices, runtime-selected instances, and automatic memory inference remain outside this bounded form.

A rule guard may establish the required bound through a simple unsigned comparison and conjunction:

```
when (index < 64) & capture {  
    samples[index] <- value  
}
```

That fact is scoped to this rule only. The bounded refinement understands these simple comparisons/conjunctions; `index <= 64`, disjunctions, and uses outside the guarded rule do not prove the required `0..63` range.

0.6.3 Delays and fixed pipelines

```
delayed = delay<2>(value)  
piped = pipeline(3) { expression }
```

`delay<N>` adds exactly `N` zero-reset scalar stages. `pipeline(N)` is an exact visible-latency contract: for a supported pure scalar expression DAG, planning may place real computation boundaries within those `N` cycles and inserts the required reconvergent-path balancing. It never changes the requested latency or II, and `pipeline(1)` remains exactly one cycle. Unsupported nodes fail closed; the emitter does not fall back to an unreported whole-expression output delay. Outside a scheduled pipeline region, non-timeless operands at an operator must still be latency-aligned explicitly.

Compiler-selected latency/resource alternatives use `implement { expression intent { ... } }`. Scalar `pipeline(auto)` is retired; protocol transform `pipeline(auto, ...)` is a separate ready/valid construct.

0.6.4 Exact module timing contracts

A scalar datapath module may publish one exact contract shared by all of its wire outputs:

```
module TimedChild {  
    clock clk  
    reset rst  
    in x : u8  
    out y : u8  
  
    timing {  
        latency 4  
        ii 1  
    }  
  
    y = pipeline(4) { x }  
}
```

The contract describes observable behavior; it does not itself insert registers or authorize retiming. Constants are timeless, ordinary input-dependent logic is known at latency zero, and explicit `delay<N>/pipeline(N)` adds exactly `N`. A supported pipeline region may use its compiler-owned scheduled graph to place and balance those internal cuts. Timeless values may join a known path; joins outside that graph still require equal known latency.

Registers, rules, FIFO/memory/ROM observations, protocols, and uncontracted child outputs are unknown for this first public contract. A positive latency requires exactly one clock/reset domain. Only `ii 1` is accepted. A contracted child adds its declared latency to the common known latency of its bound scalar inputs; an unaligned parent join is rejected instead of silently balanced.

This is distinct from implement constraints, target estimates, and measured evidence. A planner or profile must preserve an exact module contract as immutable public behavior.

0.6.5 Guarded atomic actions

The concise action form is:

```
when increment {  
    count <- truncate<8>(count + 1)  
}
```

Named compatibility spelling remains supported:

```
rule increment_count when increment {  
    count <- truncate<8>(count + 1)  
}
```

Action blocks may select effects recursively with runtime `when`, `else when`, and `else`:

```
fault_update: when fault {  
    when valid_state {  
        overflow_state <- 1  
    } else {  
        valid_state <- 1  
        overflow_state <- 0  
        sticky_state <- fault_code  
    }  
} else when clear_valid {  
    valid_state <- 0  
    overflow_state <- 0  
} else when clear_overflow {  
    overflow_state <- 0  
}
```

An `else` binds to the nearest unmatched `when`, and an `else when` chain selects its first true predicate. A false `when` without an `else` contributes no effects; later statements in the enclosing action block are still considered, so multiple sibling conditionals can contribute to the same transaction.

Read this as two operations that never feed back into each other: predicates first choose the effects, then the scheduler either commits the complete chosen transaction or commits nothing. Storage readiness and rule conflicts belong only to the second operation; they can suppress a transaction but can never make an `else` branch run.

Every guard and operand reads the same pre-edge snapshot. The complete tree retains one outer Rule, one rule-fire identity, and one ActionGroup; selected effects and unconditional surrounding effects commit together or not at all. If no effect is active, the rule does not fire. Source order creates neither state visibility nor implicit priority, and `reset` suppresses the complete group.

Branch choice depends only on the predicates. If the selected branch contains an illegal FIFO or memory action, the whole action group is suppressed; it does not fall back to an `else` branch because another branch's storage action would be ready. The scheduler checks conflicts and storage legality using only active effects. Scalar output writes are scheduling resources too: a rule that loses a priority conflict on an output cannot commit its otherwise unrelated state effects.

Each runtime action condition must have exact type bit. Opposite structured branches may write the same resource, but writes on potentially overlapping paths are rejected; the compiler does not attempt arbitrary Boolean theorem proving. An explicitly empty branch is a valid `no-op`, while an entire action tree with no possible effect is rejected.

Runtime action selection is distinct from both other selection forms:

- compile-time if chooses declarations or values during elaboration and is not an action statement;
- condition ? a : b, mux, and switch select pure combinational values;
- runtime when selects effects that participate in one cycle-level atomic transaction.

Rules read beginning-of-cycle state. If the guard is true, all resource actions are legal, and scheduling permits the rule, its actions commit atomically. Reset suppresses all rules. Conflicting writers require explicit priority:

```
priority {
  clear: when clear_request { count <- 0 }
  increment: when increment_request {
    count <- truncate<8>(count + 1)
  }
}
```

Priority suppresses a lower enabled rule only when it conflicts with a fired higher rule. It is not procedural if/else: nonconflicting enabled rules may fire together.

A simple ordered chain may instead be written as:

```
priority first > second > third
```

This syntax expands to the existing adjacent edges `first > second` and `second > third`. It does not invent extra edges or infer priority from source order; retain the block/pair form for any other priority graph.

0.6.6 FIFOs

```
fifo queue : fifo<u8,4>
queue.data = rx.payload
queue.push = rx.transfer
queue.pop = tx.transfer
```

Read-only observations include `.front`, `.count`, `.full`, `.empty`, `.ready`, `.valid`, `.overflow`, and `.underflow`. A legal simultaneous pop/push while full preserves occupancy and ordering. An empty pop cannot consume a same-cycle push.

FIFO depth may be a positive compile-time value expression. Backends receive the resolved integer, not a hardware parameter.

Rules can instead own FIFO operations atomically:

```
rule replace when rotate {
  queue.pop()
  queue.push(queue.front)
  accepted <- 1
}
```

Do not mix rule-owned actions with globally driven `.push/.pop` controls. An illegal resource action suppresses the whole rule.

0.6.7 Writable memories

One-read/one-write memories may optionally expose a byte write mask. The existing one-cycle, reset-cleared form remains the default:

```
in write_mask : bits<4>
memory table : mem<u32,256> {
  read_latency 1
  collision write_first
}
table.read_address = read_address
```

```

table.write_enable = write_enable
table.write_address = write_address
table.write_data = write_data
table.write_mask = write_mask

```

The mask type is exactly `bits<ceil(element_width / 8)>`. `write_mask[0]` controls the least-significant byte. For a width that is not a multiple of eight, the final mask bit controls only the remaining live most-significant bits; padding bits are never stored. Disabled lanes retain their old bits. For a same-address `write_first` access, the registered read result is the post-mask merged word, not the unmasked input. Omitting `write_mask` preserves the existing full-word write behavior. Consequently, unmasked and masked memory elements may have any positive recursively bit-packable, non-enum width.

Rule-owned memories accept the same operation as an optional third operand:

```
rule store when enable { table.write(address, data, byte_mask) }
```

Within a masked rule-owned memory, the compatible two-operand form `table.write(address, data)` means an all-lanes write. The mask does not add a read enable, another port, a new clock domain, or target-specific BRAM mapping.

0.6.7.1 Named same-clock ports

Leaving the body without port declarations preserves the legacy controls and their generated behavior. A memory may instead declare up to eight named logical ports:

```

memory table : mem<u32,1024> @clk {
    read_write_port a
    read_write_port b
    init RESET_WORD
    read_latency 1
    collision old
    write_priority a > b
}

table.a.read_enable = a_read
table.a.write_enable = a_write
table.a.address = a_address
table.a.write_data = a_data
a_data_out = table.a.read_data

```

`read_port`, `write_port`, and `read_write_port` state the exact access shape. All named ports of an ordinary `mem` have one resolved clock domain. When more than one port can write, `write_priority` must list every writer exactly once. Priority affects only writes to the same address; simultaneous writes to different addresses both commit. `collision old`, `new`, and `no_change` select the same-clock registered-read result. The older spellings `read_first` and `write_first` remain accepted aliases for `old` and `new`.

Named-port masks retain the arbitrary-bitwidth lane rule above. Mixed port widths and asymmetric depths are rejected. Rule-local memory actions remain a property of the legacy implicit 1R1W form and cannot be mixed with named ports.

An optional `init VALUE` supplies one exact compile-time element value for every cell. It may be a typed module value parameter. With contents `clear`, generic/register-array hardware writes that value to every cell on reset. With contents `preserve`, it is only the deterministic power-up value; FPGA block RAM maps it to bitstream initialization and does not pretend that a runtime reset rewrites the array. Omitting `init` retains the exact zero value used by the existing reset/initialization policies. Full per-address images remain the role of immutable rom in this slice.

The bounded implementation planner first uses an exact target resource. A 1W+nR shape otherwise becomes coherent replicated 1R1W storage; other same-clock multiwrite shapes may

use a deterministic register array, read muxes, and priority gates when the logical storage is at most 4096 bits. Larger unsupported shapes fail with a diagnostic recommending explicit banking, arbitration, or standard-library composition. No automatic banking is performed because arbitrary same-bank collisions need a protocol contract.

0.6.7.2 Explicit dual-clock memory

`async_mem<T,N>` is a separate, deliberately narrow semantic resource:

```
memory table : async_mem<u32,1024> {
  write_port wr @write_clk
  read_port rd @read_clk
  init INITIAL_WORD
  read_latency 1
  collision old
  reset { contents preserve read_data clear }
}

table.wr.enable = write_enable
table.wr.address = write_address
table.wr.data = write_data
table.wr.mask = write_mask
table.rd.address = read_address
read_data = table.rd.data
```

It has exactly one write-only port and one read-only port in different explicit domains. Cells change only on the writer edge; `rd.data` changes only on the reader edge and has destination-domain provenance. The contents reset policy belongs to the write domain and the read-result policy to the read domain. Direct use of foreign-domain controls is rejected; a pipeline register is not a CDC primitive.

`async_mem` requires `read_latency` in `1..16`. The generic implementation captures the cell on the reader edge and, for latency greater than one, shifts the captured value through reader-domain output registers. This adds visible latency without changing the contents or crossing domains. `read_latency 0` is invalid for `async_mem`; it would be an unregistered cross-clock read, not a block-RAM read port.

For coincident logical edges the simulator uses a pre-edge snapshot: `old` returns the prior cell, while `new` forwards the coincident write. This is a precise digital model, not an analog metastability or silicon timing guarantee. Portable generic direct-SystemVerilog publishes `old`; stricter or other collision claims require an exact target capability. Asynchronous 2RW, mixed-width ports, ECC, and dual-clock ROM remain deferred.

```
memory table : mem<u8,16> {
  read_latency 1
  collision read_first
}

table.read_address = read_address
table.write_enable = write_enable
table.write_address = write_address
table.write_data = write_data
read_data = table.read_data
```

Alternatively, one memory can be owned by atomic rules:

```
rule fetch when read_enable {
  table.read(address)
  accepted <- 1
}

rule store when write_enable {
```

```

    table.write(address, write_data)
}

```

read registers `table.read_data` one cycle later and it holds when no read fires. `write` commits at the selected edge. One selected read and one selected write may fire together; same-address behavior follows the declared collision mode. Their operands and all other rule effects observe the same pre-edge snapshot. Reset suppresses actions. With the default profile it clears both cells and `read_data`.

Global controls and rule actions cannot be mixed. The bounded scheduled form supports one memory per module, alongside registers and scheduled FIFOs; two reads or two writes conflict and require existing explicit rule priority.

The executable memory forms have scalar elements and power-of-two depth of at least two. A globally controlled ordinary `mem` accepts `read_latency` in $0..16$: zero is a combinational read; each positive value is an exact number of domain-local read edges from address capture to the visible result. Rule-owned memories remain exactly one-cycle because their read action is selected at an edge. Zero-cycle ordinary `mem` is a generic combinational storage behavior, not a native synchronous BRAM claim. Native target binding requires an explicitly matching clocked-read capability. Until a target mapping proves its internal output-register configuration and any additional fabric stages, a requested latency greater than the advertised native latency uses generic storage under a preferred policy or fails under a required policy.

Cell and visible read-result reset behavior may be selected independently:

```

memory table : mem<u32,256> {
    read_latency 0
    collision read_first
    reset {
        contents preserve
        read_data preserve
    }
}

```

If the reset block is present, both directives are required. If it is absent, the exact default is `contents clear` and `read_data clear`. Reset always suppresses writes and scheduled actions. At latency zero, `read_data clear` masks the combinational result while reset is asserted; `read_data preserve` leaves the addressed preserved cell visible. At latency one, the corresponding policy clears or holds the result register. `read_first` observes the old cell before a coincident write edge; `write_first` observes the fully byte-mask-merged write word.

The simulator and generic direct-SystemVerilog initialize executable preserved memory state to its declared uniform `init` word, or zero when omitted, but runtime reset does not recreate that initialization under `contents preserve`. The Xilinx same-clock true-dual mapping therefore requires preserved contents; Vivado maps its source initializer to BRAM initialization. Target selection stays fail-closed when a resource does not advertise initialization support. Full/partial writable-memory images, automatic banking, unbounded multiport memory, and asynchronous 2RW are not part of this hardware surface. Bounded named-port selection is described above. Simulation-only tests may instead publish a selected-IR-bound state catalog and Verilator VPI companion with `--simulation-state-bundle`; that tooling neither adds hardware ports nor changes memory reset semantics. The [writable-memory contract](#) and public [simulation-state access](#) sections define the two distinct boundaries.

0.6.7.3 Replicated read ports, wrappers, and banking

Named ports now provide a bounded native logical model; source composition is still preferable when banking or arbitration policy is architecturally significant. The validated [ZtpuBankedMemory](#) uses four banks and two read replicas per bank: both replicas receive the same decoded, byte-masked synchronous write, while each read address selects its own replica and bank. This produces eight distinct physical 1R1W memories, one shared leaf specialization, two combinational read results, and one logical write port.

The concrete witness contains 256 32-bit words, split into four banks of 64 words. Its runtime reset suppresses writes and preserves both cells and combinational read data; executable simulation begins from deterministic zero contents. The semantic simulator and direct SystemVerilog agree on full and per-byte writes, independent reads, same-address read_first behavior, reset, and replica coherence. This is source composition, not a new memory semantic or backend name-based rewrite. The ordinary stdlib modules StorageDualPortMemory, Storage2R1WMemory, and StorageAsyncMemory1W1R expose common shapes while lowering through the same memory IR. StorageAsyncFifo similarly wraps the existing ready/valid async_fifo(D) crossing; a normal fifo<T,N> never becomes asynchronous.

The FIFO crossing now decomposes into an internal typed async_mem with independent write/read clocks, read_latency 1, and a one-slot prefetch controller. It is not a second public memory declaration in the module. The selected AMD 7-Series Xilinx7AsyncFifoRAMB18 or Xilinx7AsyncFifoRAMB36 architecture binds only this internal FIFO memory to a matching independent-clock 1W1R RAM with D0_REG=0; unsupported width/depth/configuration fails under required policy and remains generic RTL under preferred. This route does not imply that arbitrary public async_mem has a native cross-clock collision guarantee.

Target-memory closure remains separate. In particular, the existing promoted OpenRAM/target macro contract does not yet match this zero-latency, preserve-on-reset profile, so the witness makes no BRAM/SRAM inference, QoR, or physical-macro claim. A byte-addressed external wrapper and target-specific latency/collision adaptation belong to later ZTPU integration work.

0.6.8 Initialized synchronous ROMs

An immutable lookup table is declared separately from writable memory:

```
rom twiddles : rom<Complex<Twiddle>, N / 2> {
    read_latency 1
    init fft_twiddles<T=Twiddle,N=N>()
}

twiddles.read_address = phase
selected_twiddle = twiddles.read_data
```

The initializer must specialize at compile time to exactly vec<depth,element_type>. Elements may be bit-packable scalar/fixed values, vectors, or concrete structs; protocol/state values and nominal enums are rejected. Depth is positive and may be one or non-power-of-two. The address is an unsigned uint<max(1,ceil_log2(depth))> value whose proven range remains inside the declared depth.

The read is a **one-cycle synchronous read**. During reset the registered read result is zero. Reset never changes the immutable contents; after reset, the first non-reset result corresponds to the preceding accepted non-reset address. There is no hidden second output register.

The production backend consumes one compiler-owned companion image. It contains one exact-width binary word per line, address zero first. Struct declaration field zero occupies the most-significant bits; vector element zero and tuple item zero occupy the least-significant component bits recursively. Fixed-point values retain their raw signed or unsigned bit pattern. Direct SystemVerilog \$readmemb consumes that image. The CLI publishes companions beside the selected output, and artifact metadata retains the initialization dependency, evaluator, content, and file hashes. Missing or colliding companion files fail closed.

Writable or partial initialization, reloadable/asynchronous/multiport ROM, enum elements, and automatic BRAM/storage exploration remain deferred.

0.6.9 Stateful hierarchy

Single-domain scalar child modules may contain registers and rules. A compile-time indexed instance array may contain bounded scalar sequential or primitive ready/valid children with

one matching clock/reset domain; each physical instance has independent state and reset. Aggregate scalar outputs and mixed scalar/ready-valid ports retain their exact typed leaves. Storage-only child arrays may own one FIFO, synchronous memory, or initialized ROM. The scheduled-FIFO profile may also combine FIFO actions with ordinary register writes/rules because both use the same ResolvedTransition; legacy globally controlled storage plus user state remains rejected.

One outer array may contain a bounded same-domain scalar or direct-ready-valid hierarchy, including an inner scalar compile-time array. First-level in-order request/response requester/responder arrays are supported with scalar wire peers and explicit indexed connections. Nested storage/CSR/aggregate protocols, nested or out-of-order request/response, other non-RV protocols, CDC, runtime-selected instances, and cross-module atomic scheduling remain fail-closed. See [Hierarchy and protocols](#) and [storage-owning instance arrays](#).

0.7 Physical clocks and resets

ZLang's backend-independent ClockDomain records the complete physical contract of one clock and its reset. Legacy declarations remain exact aliases for the original behavior:

```
clock clk
reset rst @clk
```

normalizes to rising-edge clocking, synchronous active-high reset, native release, and unspecified power-up state.

0.7.1 Recommended asynchronous reset

The concise asynchronous form is safe for ordinary state. In a multi-clock module each annotated domain owns an independent conditioner:

```
clock clk
async reset arst @clk
```

It means asynchronous assertion followed by deassertion synchronized through two registers. Reset remains active on the first two active clock edges after the external pin is deasserted; normal state transition resumes on the third edge. Reassertion at any point immediately restarts that release sequence.

The external pin may be active-low:

```
clock clk
async reset arst_n @clk {
    polarity active_low
}
```

A falling-edge clock uses falling edges for the two release cycles as well. Polarity affects the external pin and generated RTL; the simulator still accepts a logical True for asserted reset.

The lower-level compatibility spelling remains available for a raw native asynchronous assertion/deassertion contract:

```
clock clk { edge falling }
reset rst_n @clk {
    mode asynchronous
    polarity active_low
    power_up unspecified
}
```

This full block does not insert synchronized release. When either low-level physical block is present, every clause in that block is required. Raw active-low protocol helps gate transfers with the deasserted high level; they do not reinterpret the physical pin as active-high.

0.7.2 Backend lowering

Direct SystemVerilog emits a deterministic two-register synchronizer marked with `ASYNC_REG` for the concise form. The top-level domain owns it and routes one conditioned reset through register/rule, FIFO, memory, CSR, protocol, and child state. A hierarchy does not create one synchronizer per sibling. A clocked but completely state-free module publishes the same physical contract without emitting an unused conditioner, because no reset epoch is consumed.

The semantic simulator models each input item as one active edge. It therefore models immediate assertion at the sampled boundary and the exact two-edge release hold. Assertion between active edges is additionally checked in RTL simulation.

BackendArtifact physical-domain manifest version 10 records the contract identity, external RTL clock/reset paths, edge, assertion mode, polarity, release policy/cycles, power-up policy, and source origin. Component and physical-instance records reference that identity. Default legacy artifacts retain their previous schema and generated text.

0.7.3 Formal applicability

Executable formal work now consumes this exact contract instead of assuming a rising, synchronous, active-high domain. With `power_up` unspecified, the supported matrix is:

Formal-only accepted `rule.fire` projections use this same effective reset and polarity, not a raw active-high input assumption. The projection is resolved in the final formal component scope; descendants consume the conditioned native reset. The 2026-09-06 correction covers assertion/reassertion, the complete two-edge release hold, and restart on the third edge in 24 real-RTL profiles.

Active clock edge	Reset assertion	External polarity	Release
rising or falling	synchronous	active-high or active-low	native
rising or falling	asynchronous	active-high or active-low	native
rising or falling	asynchronous	active-high or active-low	synchronized, exactly two active edges

Multiple supported synchronous domains may still produce independent goal-local jobs. Asynchronous execution is deliberately single-domain; this does not define a cross-domain reset relation. Same-cycle pure candidate equivalence remains reset-independent, while fixed-latency comparison uses the declared active edge and release window.

The identity chain is explicit and checked end to end:

- ClockDomain contributes clock/reset names, edge, assertion mode, polarity, release mode/cycles, and power-up policy to the versioned `zlang-physical-domain-contract-v1` digest;
- BackendArtifact v10 publishes the same digest as its physical-domain identity together with the external RTL port locators;
- FormalGoalPlan schema 2 stores the exact typed contract and, when an artifact exists, that physical-domain identity as part of `plan_identity`;
- verification bundle v4 / verification-IR snapshot v3 carries those fields in each executable or skipped `VerificationJob`;
- run-report v7 repeats them in every job result, and strict restoration rejects plan/job/result disagreement or a corrupted contract digest.

Prepared-artifact, bundle, harness, result-cache, and evidence recipes therefore separate otherwise identical goals that use different edges, assertion modes, polarities, or release policies. A non-executable goal still retains its exact typed contract. If no compatible artifact exists, its physical-domain identity is absent rather than guessed.

Formal traces distinguish the two reset views. `physical_reset` is the raw external pin with its declared polarity. `trace:reset` and result `reset_state` are the normalized active-high *effective* reset used by property guards, previous-cycle history, feasibility covers, fill masks, and

comparison windows. For synchronized release, effective reset remains asserted for both release edges even though the external pin is already deasserted. Failure-cycle and originating-sample attribution therefore describe the real reset epoch, not merely the raw pin level.

0.7.4 Boundaries

One clock domain has exactly one reset. Declaring both `reset` and `async reset` for that domain is an error. Direct-SV supports multiple independently conditioned asynchronous domains; current formal execution still skips an asynchronous goal in a multi-domain module because no cross-domain reset-epoch relation is claimed. Implicit reset crossings, reset combinators, configurable synchronizer depth, glitch filters, power-on reset, and macro-selected RTL semantics are not supported.

`power_up reset` remains typed but fails closed because no common portable synthesizable initialization mechanism is frozen. DSP48 physical reset pins, elastic or variable-latency `pipeline(auto)` equivalence, CDC/reset-refinement proofs, and target BRAM reset pins remain fail closed. So do multi-domain asynchronous formal execution, general hierarchical semantic-reference equivalence, and every route with missing or incompatible domain manifests, bindings, assumptions, or observations. formal-aware selection available records unavailable evidence without changing eligibility; required policies fail unless the existing exact semantic-reference equivalence route executes at the requested level. No new formal property, observation, or equivalence family is introduced.

0.7.5 Original-slice validation record

The accepted implementation exercises ordinary registers/rules, FIFO and ready/valid, memory, CSR, request/response, and nested hierarchy through the simulator, direct SystemVerilog, and strict Verilator. Tests cover assertion between edges, two release edges, third-edge restart, reassertion, both polarities, falling-edge release, exact hierarchy rejection, manifest round-trip, and the original fail-closed formal/target boundary. The original combined focused gate reports **217 passed**. Two unchanged-snapshot full regressions report **2871 passed, 1 documented opt-in skip** in 729.66 s and 974.48 s. These figures are the acceptance record for the reset slice, not the live repository baseline; see Current language status for the current regression and corpus snapshot.

The superseding formal-applicability focused gates report **53 passed** for exact plan/job/result identity and bundle round-trip, **65 passed** for adjacent orchestration/replay, and **26 passed** for physical-manifest/async-reset coverage. These gates overlap and are therefore not summed. Full-regression acceptance is intentionally recorded only when the repository-wide run is complete.

0.8 Hierarchy, protocols, and explicit CDC

ZLang represents modules, endpoints, ownership, clock domains, connections, and physical instances explicitly before backend lowering. Connections are never inferred by guessing generated RTL names.

0.8.1 Modules and instances

Modules may have compile-time type and value parameters:

```
module Engine<type T, DEPTH=4> {
  in  value : T
  out copy  : T = value
}
```

Instantiate and bind scalar inputs explicitly or by same-name shorthand:

```
inst engine : Engine<T=u8,DEPTH=4> { value }
result = engine.copy
```

Specialization identity is distinct from physical instance identity. A single-domain parent may supply an unambiguous child clock/reset implicitly; multi-domain hierarchy requires explicit compatible domains. Child protocol endpoints use connect, not scalar binding syntax.

A reusable component fingerprint covers its typed hardware and the deterministic transitive closure of callables that hardware actually invokes. Functions that are merely visible through a parent/import context do not participate. Thus the same parameterless child reached through different parents is emitted once, while different value/type specializations or a different reachable helper body remain distinct and fail closed on an identity conflict.

When every intermediate child conforms to one exact named interface with one protocol input and one protocol output, an option-free path can be written as:

```
input -> decode -> execute -> output
```

This lowers to the ordinary pairwise typed edges `input -> decode.rx`, `decode.tx -> execute.rx`, and `execute.tx -> output`. Intermediate names are physical instances, not guessed ports. Arrays, unnamed or ambiguous signatures, edge options, adapters, buffering, and crossings remain explicit.

One-dimensional compile-time instance arrays are structurally unrolled:

```
inst lane[N] : Lane<W>
generate(i in 0..N) {
    lane[i].x = values[i]
}
outputs = generate(i in 0..N) lane[i].y
```

A runtime selector may project one exact bit-packable wire output. This is a read-only mux over the already elaborated children, never a dynamic physical instance:

```
selected = lane[select].output
```

Every `lane[i]` still exists, receives its compile-time bindings, and advances its own state independently. The selector neither routes child inputs nor gates a child clock, reset, rule, or storage action. The explicit equivalent is `outputs = generate(i in 0..N) lane[i].output` followed by `selected = outputs[select]`; both spellings retain the same physical child identities.

The bounded supported form covers:

- combinational scalar children, including exact aggregate scalar outputs;
- single-domain scalar children with registers/rules;
- primitive ready/valid children, including scalar wire ports beside the endpoint and the existing one-FIFO profile;
- legacy storage-only children owning one FIFO, synchronous memory, or initialized ROM;
- the scheduled-FIFO profile in which FIFO actions and ordinary register writes share one existing `ResolvedTransition`; and
- an outer one-dimensional array whose element contains a bounded same-domain scalar or direct-ready-valid hierarchy. Inner compile-time scalar arrays are retained as distinct physical paths rather than flattened by generated name.

The first-level request/response profile is also bounded and explicit. Each array child has exactly one ordering `in_order` endpoint plus scalar wire ports, and each connection names compile-time indexed requester and responder elements:

```
generate(i in 0..N) {
    requester[i].issue = issue[i]
    responder[i].accept = accept[i]
    connect requester[i].mem -> responder[i].mem
}
```

Every physical element retains its own outstanding ledger and reset epoch. Out-of-order matching, an additional protocol on the same child, nested or transitive request/response arrays, and unindexed endpoint references fail closed. This profile

is covered by compiler/backend tests and the executable capability-registry witness tests/fixtures/hierarchy/request_response_instance_array.zhl.

Legacy globally controlled storage still cannot be combined with user registers/rules. Credit and other non-RV protocols, CSR or storage below a nested array element, CDC arrays, runtime-selected inputs or protocol endpoints, cross-module atomic scheduling, and incomplete bindings are rejected. See [storage-owning instance arrays](#) for the exact state and backend evidence.

Concise declarations normalize to the same hierarchy IR when unambiguous:

```
frontend : AXI4LiteToRegBus<32,32>
axi : AXI4Lite<32,32>.slave @clk
axi -> frontend.axi
```

Explicit inst remains the escape hatch for namespace ambiguity.

0.8.1.1 Typed external modules

A bounded scalar-wire component may declare backend-independent behavior with an ordinary pure ZLang model:

```
extern module VendorAdd : AddIfc { model add_model }
```

The concise source form is `extern module VendorAdd : AddIfc { model add_model }.`

The applied interface and model produce one exact semantic signature. Physical SystemVerilog is supplied separately through a hash-validated `ExternalPhysicalMapping`; inline HDL never defines ZLang semantics. The first release supports non-parameterized, clockless scalar inputs and one scalar output in direct SystemVerilog. State, protocols, arrays, and generic external components fail closed.

0.8.2 Clock and reset boundary

Legacy clock `clk` plus synchronous active-high reset `rst` works through the production direct-SystemVerilog backend. A single-domain parent may supply that exact domain to a child only when the mapping is unambiguous; this is domain inheritance, not implicit CDC. One non-default falling-edge, asynchronous, or active-low physical contract is typed and emitted by direct SystemVerilog. Concise `async reset` adds one root-owned two-edge release conditioner and passes the conditioned reset through the closed child ABI; the raw asynchronous compatibility form remains distinct. Instance arrays require one compatible inherited domain unless they are purely combinational. Multi-domain `async reset`, power-on reset, and implicit reset crossing remain fail-closed.

0.8.3 Public top ABI

The selected top always exposes integration-friendly typed leaves. Struct fields and structural tuple components, including those inside protocol payloads, become individually named ports; tuple paths use `item0`, `item1`, and so on. A vector leaf remains one multidimensional packed SystemVerilog array; for example `vec<8,u8>` becomes `logic [7:0][7:0] samples`. It is neither an anonymous 64-bit public bus nor eight separately named ports. Nested `vec<Struct>` values become one array per struct field, and `vec<Tuple>` values become one array per tuple component.

Direct-SystemVerilog RTL uses this public `TopPhysicalABI`. The conversion follows the canonical packing order with element zero in the least-significant region: for a descending packed vector dimension, source element zero maps to physical index 0. There is no source annotation, compiler option, or backend-specific preprocessor branch selecting another public ABI.

0.8.4 Ready/valid

```
in  rx : rv<u8>
out tx : rv<u8>
```

```
tx.payload = rx.payload
tx.valid   = rx.valid
rx.ready   = tx.ready
```

For an input endpoint, payload/valid enter the module and ready leaves it. Output ownership is reversed. `.transfer` is a read-only protocol property meaning `valid & ready`. A source stalled with `valid=1` and `ready=0` must hold payload and valid stable.

Direct composition names source then sink:

```
connect rx -> tx
connect buffered_rx -> buffered_tx { buffer 2 }
```

A ready/valid buffer is real FIFO state; it does not appear implicitly.

0.8.5 Credit and request/response

`credit<T,N>` provides pulse-return flow control. `.transfer` is the physical send after credit gating, `.credits` is the current bounded count, and `.return` returns one credit. Counters begin at `N`.

Adapters are explicit:

```
connect rx -> tx { adapter rv_to_credit }
connect crx -> rtx { buffer 2 adapter credit_to_rv }
```

Request/response endpoints declare ordering and outstanding capacity:

```
interface mem : request_response<Request,Response> {
    max_outstanding 2
    ordering in_order
}
```

The requester owns request payload/valid and response ready; the responder owns request ready and response payload/valid. Request and response channels expose their own read-only `.transfer` events. Directional buffers are independent:

```
connect requester.mem -> responder.mem {
    request_buffer 4
    response_buffer 2
}
```

Buffered but unaccepted requests are distinct from accepted outstanding requests. The ledger increments on responder-side request transfer and decrements on requester-side response transfer. Reset begins a new protocol epoch. `ordering out_of_order` requires a matching scalar ID field; hierarchical out-of-order composition remains outside the current bounded subset.

0.8.6 Aggregate protocols and the standard library

The compiler-shipped `std` namespace maps to ordinary `.zhl` files below `stdlib/`. The compiler knows generic aggregate schemas, roles, ownership, hierarchy, and domains; it does not hard-code AXI/APB transactions.

Available source-authored profiles include RegBus, AXI4-Lite, APB, AXI-Stream, Wishbone B4 Classic, bridges, and the CSR target:

```

import std.bus.reg
import std.bus.axi_lite

module AxiCsrTop {
    clock clk
    reset rst
    interface axi : AXI4Lite<32,32>.slave @clk
    inst frontend : AXI4LiteToRegBus<32,32>
    inst csr : RegBusCSRTarget<32,32>
    connect axi -> frontend.axi
    connect frontend.regbus -> csr.regbus
}

```

Aggregate pass-through connects each member according to typed ownership, including reverse ready:

```
input -> output
```

Protocol member properties such as `.transfer`, FIFO observations, and request/response channel events are part of typed semantics. They are not arbitrary user-defined fields and cannot be assigned when read-only.

0.8.7 Packets, virtual channels, and arbitration

`packet<T>` extends `ready/valid` with `.last`. Arbiters explicitly select source order, `fixed_priority` or `round_robin`, and beat or packet grant lifetime. `vc_credit<T,V,C>` maintains independent credit counts per virtual channel.

0.8.8 CSR blocks

CSR source describes address layout, access policy, reset, and hardware binding once. Supported policies are `rw`, `ro`, `wo`, `wlc`, `pulse`, and `reserved`. Hardware status uses `<-`, commands use `->`, and sticky events make simultaneous hardware/software priority explicit. RTL, JSON, and Markdown are derived from the same typed model.

In a multi-clock module the bank declares its owner after its base address:

```
csr control @0x4000_0000 @apb_clk { /* registers */ }
```

All blocks sharing the canonical access ABI must use that one domain. A runtime CSR value consumed by another domain still requires explicit CDC.

0.8.9 Clock-domain crossings

Implicit CDC is an error. Existing explicit forms are:

Crossing	Supported endpoint
<code>sync_level</code>	Slowly changing bit level
<code>pulse_toggle</code>	Rate-limited bit pulse
<code>handshake</code>	One scalar ready/valid payload
<code>async_fifo(N)</code>	Ready/valid stream through a power-of-two dual-clock FIFO

```
connect source -> destination { crossing async_fifo(4) }
```

The crossing is a semantic boundary. Its output has destination-domain provenance and may feed destination-domain combinational logic, rules, FSMs, or state normally. The compiler never rewrites, balances, or resource-packs logic through the boundary, and never chooses a crossing automatically.

```
connect enable_a -> enable_b { crossing sync_level }
rule Observe @clk_b when enable_b { seen <- 1 }
```

An aggregate with exactly one forward ready/valid member may use the same `async_fifo` crossing; its complete payload is atomic. Both domains must participate in a coordinated reset episode.

The physical direct-SV FIFO uses one compiler-owned 1W1R `async_mem` with a one-cycle registered read, two-stage Gray-pointer synchronizers, and one prefetched output beat. A stalled beat holds both payload and valid; the read/consumed pointer advances only on transfer, so that beat still occupies capacity. Continuous accepted beats can transfer at `II=1` without an extra output bubble. The synchronizers model digital CDC behavior, not analog metastability or an MTBF guarantee.

The ordinary `std.storage.core.StorageAsyncFifo<T,D>` wrapper exposes this same crossing as a reusable module with explicit writer and reader clock/reset ports. It lowers through the existing CDC IR; its module name is not special to the compiler. A normal `fifo<T,N>` never changes into an asynchronous FIFO because its endpoints happen to use different domains.

No automatic protocol adaptation or implicit CDC is performed. Full AXI4 bursts/IDs and bus-specific CDC bridges remain deferred.

0.9 Named module interfaces

Named module interfaces give a public name to an exact, behavior-free module signature. They let a library state the ABI that several concrete modules must implement without selecting, replacing, or instantiating any implementation.

```
interface FirIfc {
    clock clk
    reset rst
    in  x : fixed<18,16>
    out y : fixed<18,16>

    timing {
        latency 4
        ii 1
    }
}

module DirectFir : FirIfc {
    // The complete public surface is inherited from FirIfc.
    y = pipeline(4) { x }
}
```

The declaration after interface contains only public signature items:

- type and value parameters;
- clock and reset declarations;
- scalar, wire, ready/valid, credit, packet, and VC-credit in/out ports;
- source-authored aggregate protocol endpoints and their roles;
- at most one exact `timing { latency N ii 1 }` contract.

It cannot contain assignments, registers, rules, storage, child instances, or other implementation behavior.

0.9.1 Exact conformance

`module M : Ifc` means that `M` promises to have exactly the applied signature of `Ifc`. Conformance is checked during typed semantic analysis. It is not structural duck typing and does not introduce an implicit conversion.

The following all belong to the contract:

- parameter names, kinds, declaration order, and defaults;
- applied type and value parameter values after specialization;
- port names, declaration order, directions, canonical types, and protocol capacities;
- clock/reset pairs and every port or endpoint domain;
- aggregate protocol specialization, role, member ownership, payload types, and member domains;
- presence and exact value of the module timing contract.

If a conforming module declares no public surface, the complete applied interface surface is inherited: parameters, ports, clock/reset domains, aggregate endpoints, and timing. This is exact signature inheritance, not structural inference. The legacy fully redeclared form remains accepted. A partial redeclaration is never merged with the interface and fails exact conformance.

Missing or additional members in a fully redeclared surface are errors. So are renamed ports, changed directions, width changes, role changes, a different domain, and a timing contract present on only one side.

Named parameters and concrete type parameters are supported:

```
interface TransformIfc<type T, N=4> {
    in  x : vec<N,T>
    out y : vec<N,T>
}

module Transform<type T, N=4> : TransformIfc<T=T, N=N> {
    y = x
}
```

The module parameter declaration itself must match the interface parameter declaration exactly. A concrete specialization records canonical applied values in `ModuleSignature`; concise source spelling does not change that identity.

0.9.2 Aggregate protocol signatures

An existing source-authored aggregate protocol can be part of a named module interface. Its role and clock domain are explicit:

```
protocol TinyBus<AW=8> {
    role initiator
    role target
    channel command : rv<bits<AW>> initiator -> target
    member alarm : bit target -> initiator
}

interface TinyTarget<AW=8> {
    clock clk
    reset rst
    interface bus : TinyBus<AW=AW>.target @clk
}

module Target<AW=8> : TinyTarget<AW=AW> {
    clock clk
    reset rst
    interface bus : TinyBus<AW=AW>.target @clk
    // Concrete behavior remains in the module.
}
```

Conformance uses the already typed aggregate schema and ownership model. It does not guess compatibility from endpoint or generated RTL names.

0.9.3 Selection and backend identity

A named interface never chooses a concrete implementation. Source still instantiates a concrete module, and normal top selection still names a concrete module. There is no automatic substitution, inheritance, refinement search, or runtime dispatch.

The applied `ModuleSignature` is backend-independent semantic/build metadata. It survives canonical round trips, while the implementation body continues through the production direct-SystemVerilog path. Merely adding an equivalent interface declaration does not authorize a backend to change RTL or timing.

0.9.4 First-slice boundaries

The current bounded surface intentionally does not support:

- `request_response` members in named module interfaces, because their requester/responder role is currently inferred from module behavior rather than declared as an exact signature role;
- interface extension or refinement beyond exact complete-surface inheritance;
- multiple-interface conformance;
- automatic implementation selection or substitution;
- relaxed variance, implicit resizing, protocol adaptation, or CDC insertion.

Use the existing concrete module and protocol forms when one of these boundaries applies. Unsupported or non-conforming signatures fail with a structured interface diagnostic; they never silently weaken the ABI.

0.10 Tagged unions

ZLang tagged unions are a bounded, backend-independent way to carry one of several named scalar payload shapes. They are values, not procedural control flow and not protocol envelopes.

```
union Message {
  Idle
  Data { value : u8 }
  Error { code : bits<4> }
}

message : Message = Message.Data { value = input }

result : u8 = match message {
  Message.Idle => 0
  Message.Data { value } => value
  Message.Error { code } => extend<8>(code)
}
```

0.10.1 Type and layout

The type is nominal: two equal-looking declarations are not interchangeable. Variant order defines ordinal tag codes. The tag width is $\max(1, \text{ceil_log2}(\text{variant_count}))$ and occupies the most-significant bits. The payload is as wide as the largest variant. Fields occupy it from most to least significant in declaration order; a shorter payload has zero low-order padding.

The first supported slice admits only flat bit, `bits<N>`, `uN/uint<N>`, `sN/sint<N>`, `fixed`, and `ufixed` fields. A fieldless value uses the concise constructor `Message.Idle`; `Message.Idle {}` remains an equivalent explicit spelling.

0.10.2 Construction and matching

Constructor fields are named, exact, and complete. Missing, extra, repeated, or wrongly typed fields are compile-time errors. A match must contain every variant exactly once. A payload arm binds every field in declaration order; binders cannot rename, omit, repeat, or shadow an existing value.

Matching is pure and zero-latency. Semantic lowering retains a typed `UnionConstruct`, `UnionTag`, and `UnionField`, then expresses selection with the ordinary typed `Switch`. The simulator carries an immutable nominal runtime value. Direct SystemVerilog carries the exact frozen packed bits. Registers and internal scalar child ports may use union values.

0.10.3 Deliberate boundaries

An external top-level union input is rejected because arbitrary raw bits could encode an unused tag. There is no raw decode, `bitcast<Union>`, `unpack<Union>`, generic/recursive union, nested aggregate payload, union operator overload, wildcard/nested pattern, guard, partial match, or protocol inference in this slice. No e-graph rewrite or new formal observation is added.

The runnable source is [examples/tagged_union.zhl](#). The exact representation and current exclusions are documented above and in the [syntax support matrix](#).

0.11 Parameterized aggregate protocols

The generic composition slice expands a parameterized protocol endpoint during semantic elaboration. For example:

```
protocol TinyBus<AW=8> {
  role initiator
  role target
  channel req : rv<uint<AW>> initiator -> target
  channel rsp : rv<uint<AW>> target -> initiator
  member irq : bit target -> initiator
}
```

A module uses this declaration with interface `bus : TinyBus<AW=8>.initiator`. The compiler retains the aggregate identity and specialization, then expands each member into the existing typed leaf endpoint IR. Ready/valid members preserve physical backward-ready propagation; plain members are ordinary scalar wires.

Top-level aggregate endpoints additionally have a backend-independent `TopAggregateABI` projection. It recursively flattens ready/valid payload structs, derives physical direction from source/sink ownership, and keeps aggregate/member identities separate from generated names. Direct SystemVerilog consumes that projection without protocol-specific source-name guessing.

`connect left.bus -> right.bus` checks protocol identity, specialization, member names, payload types, roles, and clock domains before producing leaf hierarchical connections. Aggregate buffering, adapters, and CDC are deliberately rejected; they must be expressed on a leaf connection in a later library design.

The direct-SystemVerilog backend consumes the same closed child component ABI as other hierarchical protocol children. A child receives every scalar dependency and protocol backward signal explicitly and returns forward values plus scalar outputs. No aggregate or RTL name is reconstructed by textual substitution. BackendArtifact manifests publish both aggregate identities and their leaf signal bindings, so formal/source attribution remains stable.

Generic value parameters support exact positive width arithmetic (+, -, *, and exact /). Type parameters are bound at an aggregate use site. The initial slice is structural: it intentionally does not implement AXI/APB transaction state machines, adapters, packages, CDC, or automatic protocol conversion.

Validation: the in-repository TinyBus producer/consumer hierarchy (two ready/valid channels plus a reverse scalar member) elaborates into three leaf connections and passes Verilator 5.044 lint on generated direct-SystemVerilog RTL.

The standard-bus source migration validates a stateful child with multiple independent ready/valid channels through direct SystemVerilog and Verilator. The formerly missing top-level aggregate exposure is also implemented: an unconnected aggregate bus on the selected top is projected through the shared TopPhysicalABI into typed public leaves. This is generic schema/ownership lowering, not an AXI semantic exception. Arrays, partial aggregate exposure, and unsupported protocol kinds remain fail-closed as listed in the live [syntax matrix](#).

0.12 Standard buses

The production bus profiles are ordinary ZLang sources. The compiler contains no AHB, AXI, APB, AXI-Stream, Wishbone, or RegBus transaction dispatcher.

Import	Source-owned declarations	Initial profile
<code>std.bus.reg</code>	RegBus, CSR bank/target	In-order request/response CSR b
<code>std.bus.axi_lite</code>	AXI4Lite, AXI4LiteToRegBus	32/32-compatible, independent A
<code>std.bus.axi_burst</code>	AXI4BurstSubset, read/write views and helpers	No-ID, single-outstanding, full-wi
<code>std.bus.apb</code>	APB, APBToRegBus	APB setup/access sequencing
<code>std.bus.ahb_lite</code>	AHBLite, AHBLiteToRegBus	Single-manager, full-width AHB-L
<code>std.bus.axi_stream</code>	AXIStream, AXIStreamPipe	Data/keep/strb/last ready/valid st
<code>std.bus.wishbone</code>	Wishbone, WishboneToRegBus	B4 Classic single-beat, ack/err/st

Error completion is part of the source profile rather than a backend policy. AXI4-Lite maps a failed RegBus write or read to SLVERR (2'b10) and holds the complete B/R payload while the corresponding ready signal is low. APB forwards the held RegBus error through PSLVERR on the access completion. Wishbone uses mutually exclusive normal ACK and abnormal ERR termination; either one retires the single outstanding request.

AHB-Lite preserves the protocol's pipelined address/data relationship. The bridge captures an accepted address/control phase, consumes write data in the following data phase, and holds HREADYOUT low while its one RegBus request is pending. Local size/alignment errors and RegBus failures both use the standard two-cycle ERROR response: low-ready/high-response followed by high-ready/high-response. The first profile accepts aligned, full-bus-width transfers for power-of-two byte-addressable data widths from 8 through 1024; subword transfer strobes are deliberately deferred.

The bridge's public domain is active-low hresetn with asynchronous assertion and the language's two-edge synchronized release. The external reset pin keeps its AHB polarity, HREADY-OUT is high during reset, and connected sequential RegBus logic must share that exact physical reset contract.

std is a logical namespace mapped to the physical stdlib/ source tree. The resolver discovers .zhl modules by convention, resolves a deterministic dependency closure, rejects cycles and unsafe paths, and records every logical identity/content hash in semantic, canonical, and backend artifacts.

Full AXI4 with IDs, multiple outstanding transactions, general burst kinds and sidebands, AXI-Stream ID/dest/user, Wishbone burst/retry, automatic adapters and CDC are deliberately not provided by these profiles. The narrower ZTPU burst profile described below is supported without claiming that broader surface.

Runnable integrated examples are [AXI4-Lite CSR](#), [APB CSR](#), [AHB-Lite CSR](#), [Wishbone CSR](#), and the [streaming packet engine](#). The bounded burst helpers are exposed by the [ZTPU AXI burst witness](#). Python models in `zlang/standard_bus.py` remain independent test oracles only.

The AHB-Lite contract follows the [Arm AMBA 3 AHB-Lite protocol](#) rather than the older ZTPU model's simplified same-cycle "AHB-like" behavior. In particular, write address/control and

HWDATA are not sampled in the same phase, and ERROR is not shortened to one cycle. The source profile and executable tests freeze that bounded contract; broader AHB features remain explicit exclusions below.

0.12.1 Bounded ZTPU AXI burst subset

`std.bus.axi_burst` is ordinary source-authoritative ZLang HDL. It defines a combined `AXI4BurstSubset<AW,DW>` with independent AR/R and AW/W/B ready/valid channels, together with read-only and write-only protocol views for ZTPU's separate physical master ports. Address payloads carry byte address, eight-bit beats-minus-one len, and three-bit beat size; read and write data carry last, and R/B carry the exact two-bit response value.

The reusable `AXI4BurstReader<AW,DW,LW>` and `AXI4BurstWriter<AW,DW,LW>` accept aligned 1-256-beat requests and permit one outstanding transaction each. AR and AW payloads are snapshotted and remain stable until accepted. Read consumer backpressure drives `RREADY` directly. The writer accepts AW before exposing W, while AW, W, and B remain independent handshakes; its ready/valid producer retains W data while stalled. Counted framing owns completion: the reader reports early or missing `RLAST` but drains the requested beat count, while the writer generates `WLAST` on its locally counted final beat. Any nonzero `RRESP` or `BRESP` sets a sticky boolean error for that transaction epoch.

The concrete `AW=64,DW=32` reader/writer witness passes semantic and canonical round trips, deterministic artifact checks, bounded simulator traces, and direct-SystemVerilog/Verilog. Validation includes 1- and 256-beat requests, invalid 0 and 257 lengths, misalignment, independent channel stalls, stable owned payloads, `RLAST/RRESP/BRESP` failures, reset in active phases, and ignored starts while busy. No compiler, simulator, or backend dispatches on AXI names.

This profile deliberately omits IDs, `WSTRB`, burst-kind, lock, cache, protection, QoS, region and user fields, multiple outstanding transactions, UB-DMA burst chunking, command-descriptor decoding, fences, CDC, or implicit adaptation. Its accepted semantic boundary is recorded in the private ZTPU AXI burst design freeze; the public contract is the bounded profile stated above.

0.12.2 Historical migration record

The remainder of this section records the order in which the source-authoritative bus boundary was reached. Statements such as “out of scope” below describe the named historical slice, not the current support table above. Current project imports and backend coverage are documented in [Projects and dependencies](#) and [Direct SystemVerilog](#).

The implementation now projects explicitly declared top-level aggregate interfaces through that generic ABI. AXI and APB use ordinary source modules; their public names are generic paths (`axi_aw_valid`, `apb_psel`, and so on), not compiler-owned bus pin tables. Top-to-child exposure is an explicit same-role delegation (`connect axi -> frontend.axi`), while child-to-child connections retain complementary protocol roles.

The generic prerequisite for this migration is the semantic model for parameterized structs/protocols, role-qualified aggregate endpoints, member ownership, connection expansion, hierarchy, backend ABI, manifests, and formal integration. No implementation is included in this review.

At that point the compiler shipped a narrow source resolver for `std.bus.reg`, `std.bus.axi_lite`, and `std.bus.apb`. The source files now live at `stdlib/bus/reg.zhl`, `stdlib/bus/axi_lite.zhl`, and `stdlib/bus/apb.zhl`. Source-level filesystem/revision syntax remained unsupported. Imported source modules received a stable logical identity and SHA-256 content hash; later work added the separate pinned path/Git project resolver.

The compiler understands generic structural protocol schemas (roles, typed ready/valid members, ownership, and optional domains). AXI-Lite and APB channel structure, buffering, phase machines, and contracts belong to normal library components. `RegBus<32,32>` is the backend-independent CSR boundary.

The first profiles use one clock/reset and one outstanding operation. Axi4LiteToRegBus independently buffers AW and W and joins them only after both transfers; AR returns one held R response. ApbToRegBus implements explicit setup/access behavior and holds controls stable while waiting for PREADY. Safety families reuse safety verification property generation.

For that slice, full AXI4, bursts, IDs, AXI-Stream, Wishbone, CDC, adapters, and DMA bus conversion were excluded. SimpleDMA remained on generic request/response.

Yosys formal front-end preparation also succeeds for each generated RTL module. The library formal attachment is ready for a source-level child hierarchy; runtime trace simulation remains covered by the backend-independent step models until the CSR target is connected through ZLang elaboration.

The Python models in `zlang/standard_bus.py` remain independent verification oracles and are intentionally retained.

The generic parameterized aggregate endpoint slice is now available for future stdlib refinement. It elaborates role-qualified members and exact parameter widths from ordinary `.zhl` source; it does not add bus transaction behavior.

The source `RegBusCSRTarget` now includes a small real CSR fixture used by both frontends: an RW location at offset 0, a sticky W1C location at offset 4, and a one-cycle pulse location at offset 8. The target is ordinary ZLang state and rules, so generic hierarchy emits the state rather than calling a bus-specific model. The frozen CSR model remains the semantic oracle for reset, sticky precedence, W1C clearing, and pulse duration. The source hierarchy and generated RTL are covered by existing transaction/reset checks, while failure-first SBY mutation classification is covered by the formal integration suite. The later generic recursive formal instrumentation now validates the published RW/W1C/pulse CSR state through generated AXI4-Lite and APB formal tops; all nine semantic leaves are connected without bus-name dispatch. Its generic, bus-independent architecture is documented in `compositional-formal-binding.md` and the current compositional formal-binding guide. Properties requiring an unpublished hidden observation still skip explicitly. Liveness, broader recursive observation families, and full AXI remain excluded.

0.13 Standard library

`std` is the compiler-shipped logical namespace. It maps to tracked ordinary ZLang HDL sources under `stdlib/`; it is intentionally shorter than the physical directory name and is not a Python or user-package import.

Import	Purpose
<code>std.math.fixed</code>	Pure exact-width/inferred fixed-point abs, clamp, min/max, MAC and
<code>std.math.complex</code>	Generic <code>Complex<T>/Butterfly<S,D></code> , nominal operators, explicit co
<code>std.math.complex_fixed_18_16</code>	Compatibility Q2.16 complex multiply profile
<code>std.stream.core</code>	Generic <code>FrameBeat<T,M></code> , ready/valid register slice, skid buffer, and
<code>std.stream.serialization</code>	Bounded power-of-two vector serializer and raw bit collector
<code>std.stream.complex_fixed</code>	Compatibility Q5.32-to-Q2.16 complex stream quantizer
<code>std.dsp.fft</code>	Exact FFT butterfly, bit reversal, and compile-time twiddle helpers
<code>std.storage / std.storage.core</code>	Bounded delay/FIFO plus raw-bit reorder and ordered ping-pong s
<code>std.coding / std.coding.core</code>	Parity, bit reversal, checked polynomial-tap LFSR step, and exact c
<code>std.bus.reg</code>	RegBus and the source-authoritative CSR target
<code>std.bus.axi_lite</code>	AXI4-Lite protocol and RegBus frontend
<code>std.bus.axi_burst</code>	Bounded no-ID AXI burst profile, read/write views, and single-outs
<code>std.bus.apb</code>	APB protocol and RegBus frontend
<code>std.bus.ahb_lite</code>	Standards-correct bounded AHB-Lite protocol and RegBus fronten
<code>std.bus.axi_stream</code>	AXI4-Stream beat/profile and backpressure-preserving pipe
<code>std.bus.wishbone</code>	Wishbone B4 Classic and RegBus frontend
<code>std.target.generic</code>	Resource-free generic target identity
<code>std.target.asic.generic</code>	Generic ASIC cell/resource capability profile
<code>std.target.intel.cyclone_v</code>	Bounded Cyclone-V target/resource inventory

Import	Purpose
<code>std.target.xilinx.series7</code>	Bounded source-described Series-7 DSP48E1 profile
<code>std.target.xilinx.xc7z030</code>	XC7Z030 part and bounded resource inventory
<code>std.arch.xilinx7_fir</code>	Manual four-resource symmetric-FIR cascade template
<code>std.arch.xilinx7_memory</code>	Bounded Series-7 storage/resource mapping descriptions
<code>std.arch.xilinx7_signed_product</code>	Signed product-reduction architecture descriptions
<code>std.target.toy_asic</code> , <code>std.arch.toy</code>	Vendor-neutral target/architecture IR fixtures

Imports are resolved transitively, cycles are rejected, and logical path plus SHA-256 content hash participate in canonical/backend artifact identity. External path/Git packages use the separate pinned `zlang.toml/zlang.lock` project resolver. Filesystem-relative source imports and implicit network lookup are not part of the compiler-shipped `std` resolver, and ordinary compilation never fetches dependencies.

`std.bus.axi_burst` is the source-owned ZTPU interoperability profile, not a compiler-recognized bus. It publishes the combined five-channel `AXI4BurstSubset<AW,DW>` plus read-only and write-only views matching ZTPU's separate physical masters. `AXI4BurstReader` and `AXI4BurstWriter` implement one full-width incrementing transaction at a time, with 1-256-beat counting, independent channel backpressure, checked `RLAST`, counted `WLAST`, and deterministic boolean error latching for nonzero `RRESP/BRESP`. The validated `AW=64,DW=32` witness passes semantic/canonical restoration, deterministic backend emission, simulator traces, and direct-SystemVerilog/Verilator. IDs, write strobes, burst-kind and other full-AXI sidebands, multiple outstanding transactions, UB-DMA chunking, and fences remain outside this bounded profile.

`std.bus.ahb_lite` follows the AHB-Lite address/data pipeline and two-cycle ERROR response rather than the historical ZTPU model's same-cycle AHB-like shortcut. `AHBLiteToRegBus<AW,DW>` accepts one aligned full-width beat at a time for byte-addressable power-of-two `DW` from 8 through 1024, supplies an all-byte `RegBus` write mask, and holds the AHB data phase through `RegBus` request/response stalls. Subword transfers, arbitration, `SPLIT/RETRY` and compiler/backend AHB dispatch are not part of this profile. Its `hresetn` domain uses active-low asynchronous assertion and two-edge synchronized release; the example carries that exact contract through the CSR hierarchy.

`std.math.complex` is ordinary source-authoritative ZLang. It has no bus or stream dependency and uses only generic structs/functions and nominal operator declarations; semantic analysis and the direct-SystemVerilog backend have no Complex special case. Mixed fixed-point multiplication retains its full exact width and scale, and the caller places every quantization boundary explicitly. In particular, the core contains no implicit fixed<18,16> butterfly. The historical Q2.16 component and stream profiles live in separate compatibility imports `std.math.complex_fixed_18_16` and `std.stream.complex_fixed`; importing numerical Complex arithmetic does not select either profile or import a bus.

0.13.1 Fixed-point math

`std.math.fixed` provides pure generic `fixed_abs`, `fixed_min`, `fixed_max`, `fixed_clamp`, and exact `fixed_mac` functions plus explicit rounding/overflow helpers such as `fixed_quantize_nearest_even_sat`. `fixed_abs` widens according to ordinary unary-negation rules, so the most-negative input has an exact positive result; `fixed_mac` preserves the full product and addition widths. The library also retains the source-authored `FixedAbs`, `FixedClamp`, `FixedMinMax`, `FixedMAC`, `FixedSaturatingAdd`, and `UFixedSaturatingAdd` components. They operate on canonical fixed-point types; concise `SF8.8`, `SF_Sat8.8`, `UF8.8`, and `UF_Sat8.8` forms are language aliases rather than library implementations. Encoding and conversion rules are specified in `fixed-point-types.md`.

0.13.2 Complex values, streams, storage, and coding

`std.math.complex` provides the ordinary parameterized value type `Complex<T>` with `re` and `im` fields. `butterfly_quantized<T>` requires the output numeric profile explicitly; there is no

profile-selecting short spelling in the core. Complex remains ordinary source, not a compiler or backend primitive.

`std.bus.axi_stream` keeps `AXIStream<DW>` as the byte-lane bus profile and also provides `AXIStreamOf<T>` for a semantic payload type:

```
input  : AXIStreamOf<Complex<fixed<18,16>>>.sink @clk
output : AXIStreamOf<Complex<fixed<18,16>>>.source @clk
```

`AXIStream<32>` has `data/keep/strb/last`; `AXIStreamOf<T>` transports exactly one typed `T` per transfer. A future physical wrapper may serialize `T` to a chosen `TDATA` layout without changing its semantic payload identity.

Generic stream composition uses `std.stream.core`, independently of AXI:

```
import std.stream.core

struct Meta { tag : u2 }
type Beat = FrameBeat<u8,Meta>

module Queue {
  clock clk
  reset rst
  in input : rv<Beat>
  out output : rv<Beat>

  inst storage : RvFifo<T=Beat,D=4>
  connect input -> storage.input
  connect storage.output -> output
}
```

`RvRegisterSlice<T>`, `RvSkidBuffer<T>`, and `RvFifo<T,D>` reuse the exact language FIFO semantics, including simultaneous push/pop and payload stability under stall. `std.stream.serialization` currently supports a power-of-two `RvVectorSerializer<T,N,IW>` and a raw `RvBitCollector<N,IW>`, where `IW = floor_log2(N)`. Their declarations enforce `N >= 2`, power-of-two `N`, and exact `IW` through compile-time where constraints.

`std.dsp.fft` keeps arithmetic intent explicit. Its butterfly does not quantize, twiddle generation uses compile-time `sin/cos` and quantizes only to its caller-selected type, and bit reversal is a deterministic sequence-order operation. Value parameters inferred through a `bits<N>` argument are not implemented yet, so bit-width helpers use explicit calls such as `fft_bit_reverse<N=8>(value)`.

`std.storage.core` supplies `StorageDelay1<T>`, `StorageDelay2<T>`, the generic `StorageQueue<T,D,CW>` (`CW = ceil_log2(D + 1)`), and bounded raw-bit `StorageReorderBits<W,N>/StoragePingPongBits<W,N>` banks. The latter use power-of-two depth, exact runtime indices, and explicit bitcast at typed/raw boundaries. Ping-pong publication is ordered: a second commit is blocked until the visible read bank retires, while simultaneous retire/commit is legal. The same file provides ordinary `StorageDualPortMemory<T,N,AW>`, `Storage2R1WMemory<T,N,AW>`, and `StorageAsyncMemory1W1R<T,N,AW>` wrappers over the shared typed memory IR. `StorageAsyncFifo<T,D>` wraps the existing explicit ready/valid `async_fifo(D)` crossing. These module names are not compiler intrinsics and do not authorize implicit CDC. It also provides immutable, source-authored generic ROM wrappers:

```
inst direct : StorageRom<T=u8,N=8,IW=3,image=image>
inst generated : StorageGeneratedRom<
  T=u8,N=8,IW=3,producer=fn make_image<T=u8,N=8>
>
```

Both wrappers elaborate to the existing typed Rom IR with concrete immutable contents and the deterministic companion image used by direct SystemVerilog. `StorageRom` accepts a fully evaluated exact `vec<N,T>` constant; `StorageGeneratedRom` invokes a statically selected pure zero-argument producer during elaboration. Constants and producers are specialization pa-

rameters, not runtime ports or backend callbacks. Fixed, struct, vector, and nested-vector word types retain their exact canonical layout.

The core language currently requires a literal in `delay<N>`, so a generic-depth delay wrapper would be dishonest; longer delays remain explicit source until parameterized delay depth is supported. `std.coding.core` supplies representation-level parity, bit reversal and one-step LFSR operations plus exact dot/convolution and `table_gather` helpers. `table_gather<T,N,IW>` is accepted only when the complete proven `uint<IW>` range fits the source vector. It preserves order but deliberately does not claim bijection: duplicate and omitted elements remain legal. The `CodingLfsrStep<N>` module enforces `N >= 2`; the compatibility pure function cannot carry a `where` clause because function constraints are not yet syntax.

The current language deliberately prevents several tempting but invalid “generic” wrappers. A target-independent `reg vec<N,T>` cannot be initialized without either an explicit caller-provided value or a future default<T> contract, so the shipped reusable reorder/ping-pong banks use an explicit `bits<W>` representation boundary. A generic runtime gather now retains the conservative element-type range through a table-loaded index, but it does not prove that a table is a mathematical permutation. The negative semantic tests retain the bounded gather witness; no backend guesses an initializer or claims a permutation proof. Concrete projects may still use typed ROMs and permutations with known source-generated tables, as the Wi-Fi and FFT sources do.

The separated `std.stream.complex_fixed` compatibility kernel exposes raw `rv<Complex<...>>` ports. The former aggregate `AXISStream` profile cannot be forwarded transparently yet: hierarchical connections between `AXISStreamOf<Complex<...>>` specializations and member-level child ready/valid ports are rejected by the current aggregate binding model. The kernel is fully backend-validated, but restoring that aggregate ABI requires a generic aggregate-member binding compiler slice rather than bus-specific `stdlib` code.

Every shipped `.zhl` file is discovered recursively by the `std.*` resolver. Clean-wheel tests compare the complete recursive source tree with wheel contents; adding a library file without packaging it therefore fails the build rather than creating a checkout-only import.

0.13.3 Target and architecture descriptions

Target libraries use the same safe, hashed `std.*` resolver as bus and math sources. They describe resource capabilities and physical binding locators; they do not add functional primitives. See [target-platform-architecture-description.md](#) for the supported declarations, manual selection flow, and current bounded Series-7 implementation.

0.14 Projects and dependencies

ZLang source imports are logical names. Physical paths, Git URLs, and revisions belong to project metadata, never to `.zhl` source:

```
import acme.dsp.filters
import std.math.complex
```

An import may introduce a source-local qualifier without changing the logical module or dependency identity:

```
import std.math.complex as cx

in sample : cx.Complex<u8>
out total : cx.Complex<u9>
total = cx.complex_sum([sample, sample])
```

The qualifier applies to types, functions, and struct constructors declared by that exact logical module (`cx.Complex { re = ... im = ... }` is valid). It is erased before semantic typing, so the qualified and historical unqualified spellings have the same canonical identity. An aliased import does not expose those declaration names unqualified and does not re-export declarations

from a transitive dependency. Aliases are not runtime values or filesystem names; wildcards, member renaming, and re-export remain unsupported.

The compiler-shipped std namespace keeps its existing resolver. Other package names are resolved only when the source belongs to a locked project.

0.14.1 Project manifest

A project is rooted by a versioned `zlang.toml`:

```
schema = 1

[project]
name = "demo"
version = "0.1.0"
source-root = "src"

[dependencies]
acme = { path = "../acme-dsp" }
bus_models = {
  git = "https://example.invalid/hardware/bus-models.git",
  rev = "0123456789abcdef0123456789abcdef01234567"
}
```

Package and module identities contain logical names and content digests, not absolute check-out or cache paths. A file `filters.zhl` directly below package `acme`'s source root is imported as `acme.filters`; nested directories append dotted components.

Path locators are relative to the manifest containing them. Git revisions must be full lowercase 40- or 64-digit hexadecimal object IDs. Branch names, tags, and abbreviated revisions are deliberately rejected because they are mutable.

0.14.2 Lock update

Dependency resolution and fetching are explicit:

```
zlang-lock update --project zlang.toml
```

The command validates the complete transitive graph before publishing a deterministic `zlang.lock`. It records each package manifest, exact source-module index, imports, content digests, and dependency edges. Git content is populated in the project cache during this command. Path dependencies remain at their manifest-relative location and are checked byte-for-byte against the lock.

Resolution rejects:

- dependency cycles and conflicting package/module declarations;
- source-root traversal or symlink escape;
- a package whose declared identity does not match its dependency key;
- missing, added, removed, or modified locked `.zhl` modules;
- modified dependency-resolution fields in dependency manifests (profile-only edits are intentionally outside the resolution identity);
- missing Git cache content or a revision mismatch.

The lock is written only after the entire graph validates. Failed updates leave the previously accepted lock usable.

Bounded scalar extern module implementations may also be declared under `[external-mappings.NAME]` and selected by a profile's `external-mappings = ["NAME"]`. The lock records every HDL source path and SHA-256. Paths are project-relative, must remain inside the project, and may not be symlinks. This is a physical direct-SystemVerilog input: it does not replace the pure ZLang model or enter semantic IR.

0.14.3 Offline compilation

Ordinary compilation never fetches dependencies and never updates project metadata:

```
zlang src/top.zhl --project zlang.toml --check
zlang src/top.zhl --project zlang.toml --systemverilog build/top.sv
```

--project may name a manifest or its directory. Without it, zlang searches the source file's parent directories for zlang.toml. If no project is found, single-file and compiler-shipped std.* compilation retain their existing behavior; arbitrary external imports remain an explicit error.

Compilation checks the current manifest, lock, every path dependency, and every cached Git dependency before semantic analysis. It is read-only: unavailable or dirty content is a lock mismatch, not an invitation to fetch or rewrite files. Build outputs and compiler-owned output/cache directories must remain outside the resolved root, manifest, lock, dependency, and stdlib inputs. The CLI checks the complete physical input set before publication; those host paths are safety guards only and never become semantic or build identity.

0.14.4 Identity and artifacts

The exact locked dependency closure is carried through semantic and canonical IR and BackendArtifact JSON. It contributes to selected/build identities, formal proof-cache keys, and synthesis-cache keys. Changing dependency content therefore invalidates results even when emitted RTL text happens to remain identical.

artifact_hash keeps its narrower meaning: the hash of emitted backend text. The separate build identity combines that text with the logical root module and locked semantic closure. This distinction permits byte-identical RTL to be recognized while preventing evidence from one dependency closure being reused for another.

0.14.5 Deliberate boundaries

This first project slice has no registry or semantic-version solver, editable global packages, implicit network access, Git submodules/LFS/subdirectories, wildcard imports, member renaming, or re-export. Implementation profiles are a separate compiler-policy layer and do not change dependency resolution identity. Path dependencies declared by a Git package are also deferred in this bounded slice; use another pinned Git dependency instead of reaching outside a fetched checkout.

A future optional resolver or package registry may populate the same lock model. It must not become an implicit compilation-time network dependency: ordinary compilation remains offline, and the resolved module contents and their recorded digests remain the authoritative dependency identity regardless of where the content was obtained.

0.15 Optimization and formal verification

0.15.1 Canonical and selected IR

Compilation retains a high-level typed representation and a selected architecture representation. Metadata includes canonical type, width, signedness, latency, initiation interval, domain, purity/effects, source origin, and separate estimated/measured cost evidence.

The pure e-graph layer uses the pinned egglog==13.2.0 engine for a bounded, type-safe scalar rewrite subset. It covers exact integer/fixed arithmetic, bitwise/shift, compare/mux, resize and wiring nodes. Fixed conversion is an opaque quantization boundary. Reassociation of ordinary carry-growing adds, movement across rounding/rescale, state, timing, protocols, storage, rules, and CDC are excluded. Source equiv declarations register only accepted exact same-cycle value rules; they are not assertions or temporal equivalence. The current internal responsibility split and fail-closed capability/barrier registry are documented in [E-graph and physical optimization architecture](#).

0.15.2 One implementation-policy path

The staged flow is explicit; egglog is a typed value-alternative producer, not the pipeline or architecture search engine:

```
typed value IR
-> optional egglog pure-value alternatives
-> typed computation DAG
-> bounded generic/resource covering
-> target-aware exact-N fixed-latency scheduling
-> deterministic cost selection deterministic cost extraction
-> optional formal-aware selection authoritative semantic-reference equivalence
↪ semantic-reference proof gate
```

timing alignment supplies validated latency/II relations for eligible candidates. That metadata validation is not, by itself, a formal proof.

The arithmetic exploration tutorial demonstrates an exact eight-product expression, topology-only selection versus an internally registered pipeline, real latency-aware equivalence/mutations, and independent FPGA timing measurement. Solver success and estimated frequency must not be reported as routed 100 MHz timing closure.

The canonical source form is `implement`; all compiler-selected forms normalize through the same typed implementation-policy/extraction infrastructure:

```
y = implement {
  dot(a, b)
  intent {
    latency <= 4
    ii == 1
    dsp <= 8
    minimize lut
  }
}
```

`implement` selects applicable exact value, reduction/DSP, and (when a legal clock/reset context exists) fixed-latency pipeline candidates. It does not enable unsafe reassociation, CDC, protocol adaptation, variable-II sharing, or general retiming implicitly. Those remain compatibility/profile-controlled features with their existing legality checks.

The remaining source forms are:

- `choice(...)` for explicit equivalent arms and bounded cost selection;
- `protocol transform pipeline(auto, ...)` for the existing globally-stalled ready/valid transform.

The scalar spellings `architecture(auto)`, `pipeline(auto)`, and `explore` are retired and fail with migration diagnostics. Use:

```
y = implement {
  dot(a, b)
  intent {
    latency <= 4
    ii == 1
    dsp <= 8
    minimize lut
  }
}
```

Hard constraints are never silently relaxed. Estimated cost and measured synthesis evidence stay distinct. Automatic protocol adaptation, CDC insertion, general retiming, variable latency, and II-changing sharing are not inferred.

0.15.2.1 Explicit choices

```
y = choice(auto, minimize=lut, dsp<=1, latency<=1, ii<=1) {  
    mul_add => pipeline(1) { a * b + c }  
    dsp_mac => pipeline(1) { a * b + c }  
}
```

`dsp_mac` is mapping intent, not evidence that a physical DSP was used.

0.15.2.2 Exact and selected timing

```
y = implement {  
    a * b + c * d + e * f + g * h  
    intent { latency <= 3 ii == 1 dsp <= 4 fmax >= 100 }  
}
```

`implement` considers pipeline candidates only in a legal clock/reset region when the intent explicitly permits positive latency. `pipeline(3) { expr }` remains exact three-cycle hardware semantics and is never lowered to an implementation preference.

For supported pure scalar DAGs the physical record is one `ScheduledValueGraph`: operations, exact stage assignment, generic or resource bindings, resource-local/fabric cuts, balancing delays, latency, II and cost provenance. Egglog never places these cuts. On Xilinx 7-Series the target planner can cover standalone multiply, MAC/add-sub, preadd-multiply and ordered signed-product cascades with DSP48E1; uncovered operations remain fabric. Unknown target timing cannot satisfy an `Fmax` constraint, and structural cost is never reported as a measurement.

Only frozen expression shapes are accepted. Candidate timing is checked and the result is a concrete fixed-latency expression. Target-aware fixed-FIR planning is similarly bounded and keeps final fixed-point quantization outside partial products/reduction nodes.

The first protocol-aware form is an explicit ready/valid transform:

```
input -> output {  
    transform pipeline(auto, latency<=3, ii==1, fmax>=100) {  
        input.payload.a * input.payload.b  
        + input.payload.c * input.payload.d  
        + input.payload.e * input.payload.f  
        + input.payload.g * input.payload.h  
    }  
}
```

This bounded form accepts one ready/valid input and output in one synchronous domain and a pure existing pipeline scheduling product-reduction kernel. The selected plan owns one global-clock-enable stall policy: all data registers and its valid chain advance together only when the output is empty or ready. Its contract is therefore `minimum_unstalled_latency=L`, `ii_no_stall=1`, capacity `L`, and explicitly variable wall-clock latency under backpressure. It is not an timing alignment fixed-latency relation. User registers, rules, storage, protocol-control captures, adapters, crossings, and independently elastic stages are rejected in this first slice.

Target and resource descriptions under `std.target.*` and `std.arch.*` are compiler-shipped source. Functional modules do not name vendor registers or primitives. Manual required, preferred, and generic architecture modes determine failure/fallback behavior; selecting a target alone does not start automatic search.

0.15.3 First-class verification goals and contracts

Verification declarations are a verification-only overlay over the typed module. Standalone safety and bounded-reachability goals are named:

```

assert count_within @ clk {
    count <= DEPTH
}

cover reaches_done @ clk {
    state == State.Done
}

```

Related requirements and goals can share a contract scope:

```

contract fifo_behavior @ clk {
    require legal_input {
        input_length <= 1500
    }

    assert count_within {
        count <= DEPTH
    }

    ensure output_shape {
        !output.valid | output.payload.ok
    }

    cover full {
        queue.full
    }
}

```

assert and ensure are same-cycle safety obligations. cover is bounded reachability and never constrains the design. require is an environment-owned precondition local to its contract; all requirements in one scope are conjoined and gate that scope's goals. An ensure must observe at least one implementation-owned public output and cannot depend on hidden state. Goal/clause names are mandatory and unique. @ clk may be omitted only when exactly one clock/reset domain exists; reset is inferred from that domain and suppresses sampling.

The existing forms remain source-compatible:

```

assume bounded @clk disable iff rst {
    (a < 8) & (b < 8)
}

guarantee sum_matches @clk disable iff rst {
    y == a + b
}

```

Legacy assume normalizes into a module-global requirement and guarantee into a module-global assertion. Every body has ordinary ZLang type bit. Cross-domain references and unsupported temporal forms are rejected. This slice does not add arbitrary SVA/SMT, liveness, eventual delivery, fairness, or temporal implication syntax.

An assume may reference environment-owned leaves only. In particular, a ready/valid or request/response .transfer combines an environment input with an implementation output and is therefore not a legal assumption predicate. guarantee remains free to observe both sides. Executable declarations lower to typed structured predicates; report strings and RTL names are never parsed to recover their meaning.

The simulation VerificationMonitor samples after combinational settle and before edge commit. Failed active assert/ensure goals are source-attributed DUT failures. Violated require/assume clauses are recorded as environment violations and gate their dependent goals. Cover records only its first witness cycle; a missing simulation witness is not a failure.

--contracts-sva emits supported bindable safety goals through the same structured predicate meaning as safety verification. Missing observations remain explicitly non-executable rather than falling back to a second expression walker.

Each non-empty assumption set has a feasibility cover. A compile-time false requirement is rejected; a dynamically unwitnessed requirement makes dependent safety success unknown with a vacuity diagnostic rather than a pass.

Executable formal routes consume the exact typed physical-domain contract. With power_up unspecified, safety verification/source safety and cover, existing bindable recursive safety verification observations, fixed-latency II=1 semantic-reference equivalence, and the corresponding formal-aware selection policies support rising/falling edges, synchronous or raw asynchronous assertion, both polarities, and the existing two-active-edge synchronized release. Asynchronous formal execution remains single-domain; multiple synchronous domains may still produce independent goal-local jobs. Same-cycle pure candidate equivalence remains reset-independent.

The checker normalizes external polarity to one active-high effective reset. For synchronized release, checker history, property guards, feasibility covers, fill masks, and comparison windows stay reset-masked for both release edges after the raw pin deasserts. Formal traces publish both physical_reset (the raw external pin) and trace:reset (the effective reset); result reset_state is the effective view. Unsupported contracts are never coerced to the legacy reset model.

0.15.3.1 Execution and immutable bundles

Start with the runnable verification tutorial for a proved state invariant, an intentionally rare overflow counterexample, scoped assumptions and RV stall checking. It includes the important case where shallow BMC passes a broken design and deeper replay finds the defect.

```
zlang design.zhl --verify
zlang design.zhl --verification-bundle build/verify
zlang-verify build/verify
```

--verification-report PATH plus --verification-format text|json publishes a structured result. --verify-require checked|proven selects the requested safety level. --formal-jobs N controls independent safety/cover bundle jobs and independent selected-candidate sites. Dependencies inside one candidate site remain ordered and report ordering remains deterministic. --verification-work-dir DIR and replay's --work-dir DIR retain generated SBY inputs, logs, and VCDs outside the immutable bundle. A bundle contains a hash-validated manifest, structured verification IR, implementation/formal artifact, source map, separate safety/cover harnesses, and exact ROM companions when needed. Engine, solver, depth, timeout, tool versions, logs, and results belong to replay execution rather than the immutable source bundle identity; the replay tool regenerates execution-specific SBY configuration.

The immutable inputs currently use bundle schema v4 and verification-IR snapshot v3. safety verification/source execution uses run-report schema v7, which adds a deterministic run identity, strict route provenance, staged BMC/prove evidence, and per-job work/tool attribution. Joint compiler execution wraps that raw report and candidate semantic-reference equivalence evidence in zlang-compiler-verification-report-v1. Retained VCD frames are mapped through the bundle bindings to semantic signal IDs for source-facing witness and counterexample values. Work paths and raw logs remain reproducibility data, not semantic or run identity.

A proven request is never a direct shortcut to prove mode. BMC executes first at the requested depth; every safety job must be bounded_pass before those safety jobs enter prove mode. Covers execute once and are not rerun. An unrelated cover miss/skip does not block proof, while a feasibility-cover miss first makes its dependent safety job unknown and therefore blocks proof.

Safety statuses remain failed, bounded_pass depth=N, proven, unknown, and skipped. bounded_pass is never proof. Cover has a distinct vocabulary: witnessed cycle=N, bounded_unreached depth=N, unknown, and skipped. bounded_unreached is neither proven nor unreachable, and an ordinary cover miss does not make the command fail.

Exit status 0 means the requested safety level was satisfied. An safety verification/source counterexample or an executed semantic-reference equivalence counterexample returns 1. safety verification unknown/skipped/vacuous execution, tool/configuration failure, or a requested proof with only bounded evidence returns 2. A cover miss alone is not a failure, and unavailable advisory candidate evidence does not alter formal-aware selection eligibility.

0.15.4 Formal layers

Variable-latency elastic ready/valid transforms are deliberately outside the semantic-reference equivalence fixed-latency relation. They never enter that route by treating their minimum uninstalled latency as wall-clock latency.

Decisive formal-aware selection results are route-bound data, not trusted callback booleans. The property, harness, assumptions, backend route, semantic-reference artifact, implementation artifact, engine, mode, and depth must all match the cache identity before a candidate can become eligible. Exact reuse additionally matches stage policy, timeout, tool snapshot, dependencies, and compiler schema. Failed results require typed counterexample metadata; non-failed results reject it. Decisive semantic-reference equivalence evidence requires a positive depth. Missing `yosys-smtbmc` is reported like any other genuinely unavailable formal tool and never becomes false success. An unknown result or timeout in a required mode terminates the selection: the compiler never lets solver runtime become an implicit architecture objective.

`bounded_pass` means no counterexample was found through the stated BMC depth; it is not an unbounded proof. Only proven satisfies `required_proven`. `failed`, `unknown`, and `skipped` do not satisfy required policies.

Semantic analysis creates candidate spaces but runs no backend or solver. A compiler-owned candidate-site ledger carries stable site identity and exact rank into the selection phase, where `--formal-policy` executes the formal-aware selection route. Bundle-only publication records one strict compiler-owned linking plan over the exact verification goal plan, candidate-site ledger, and retained formal-aware selection records. Joint `--verify` with a non-off policy enriches that immutable plan with the selected-candidate semantic-reference equivalence plan before execution; candidate results are emitted afterward in the combined report/evidence. Bundle publication may additionally freeze the exact selected-candidate semantic-reference equivalence inputs as hash-validated, path-free companions; `zlang-verify` then executes those inputs without source compilation or formal-aware selection reselection. Base bundles contain no candidate replay inputs. The common evidence report validates those links without merging result types. Repeated candidate implementations are associated by semantic site and rank, not by candidate identity alone. With policy off, the ledger remains visible but there are no formal-aware selection attempt/evidence records. Candidate execution uses deterministic recipe-addressed work roots below the external verification work directory. An exact in-session formal-aware selection reuse retains its recorded work root; persistent formal-aware selection cache data deliberately excludes physical paths, so a cache hit never claims that an old workspace still exists. These paths and the discovered candidate tool snapshot are operational report data, not proof, cache, or compiler-verification-report identity. Parallel sites with an identical proof recipe share the same provider-owned workspace and retain the same complete attribution. `--formal-harness` and `--formal-sby` remain separate safety verification artifact-generation options; writing either file alone is not proof execution. An incomplete or mixed-route compatibility view is rejected with guidance to use a verification bundle rather than silently choosing one backend.

The later bounded applicability closure also transports observations already required by existing properties: parent request/response outstanding and directional-buffer counts, receiver-credit adapter occupancy, and direct same-domain internal ready/valid guarantees. These are formal-only typed ABI ports or root-monolithic assertions, never inferred RTL names or substituted environment assumptions. Automatic root assumptions receive a separate feasibility cover, so dependent safety evidence is vacuity-checked.

Range-proven runtime vector selection is available to the existing same-cycle predicate IR. One separate compiler-owned helper can derive whole-root same-cycle semantic-reference equivalence evidence for exactly one pure scalar child by following typed hierarchy bindings

and producing formal-only Yosys namespaces. It does not flatten production RTL and does not authorize state, protocols, storage, arrays, nesting, or aggregate boundaries. Protocol-valued and aggregate-protocol top boundaries fail closed in the scalar semantic-reference equivalence entry points.

See Current language status and [Known limitations](#) for the accepted matrix and remaining semantic boundaries.

0.15.5 Reports

Useful current outputs include high-level and selected optimization IR, saturation, implementation, cost, pipeline, architecture, exploration, synthesis, artifact manifests, and structured formal results. See Backends, CLI, and tooling for CLI paths and feature-specific design records for the exact schema.

0.16 E-graph and optimization responsibilities

Status: implemented.

The compiler keeps four distinct responsibilities:

```
canonical typed value IR
-> exact typed egglog alternatives
-> deterministic scalar DAG scheduling
-> target resource matching
-> ScheduledValueGraph -> formal-aware selection/semantic-reference
↪ equivalence/direct SystemVerilog
```

Egglog changes only pure zero-latency values. It does not insert registers or name FPGA primitives. The scheduler assigns exact cycles and alignment delays, but does not invent algebraic equalities. Resource matchers bind already typed operations or subgraphs to source-described resources. ScheduledValueGraph is the authoritative physical bridge consumed by verification and RTL emission.

The production rewrite path has one engine: pinned egglog==13.2.0. The old recursive Python saturation engine has been removed. Stable terms/results and rendering live in `opt/rewrite_model.py`; rule identity/provenance lives in `opt/rewrite_spec.py`; guard evaluation lives in `opt/rewrite_guards.py`; the canonical adapter remains in `opt/egraph.py`; egglog execution and bounded extraction remain in `opt/saturation.py`.

The optimizer is fail-closed. An operation needs an explicit capability for e-graph admission or scalar scheduling. Width, truncation, bit reinterpretation, fixed rescale, rounding, saturation, signedness changes, state and effect nodes are semantic barriers unless one specifically registered exact rule proves the requested transformation. Target resource interest is annotation only and does not change value identity.

Current resource matching supports the accepted Xilinx 7-Series DSP48E1 subset. Future resource families implement the same matcher contract; they do not add vendor tests to the general scheduler or algebraic rules to egglog.

Target-independent architecture-interest labels describe shapes such as multiply-add and preadder-multiply. They neither choose a primitive nor affect semantic identity. `OperationCostModel` estimates an already chosen operation implementation; `ResourceMatcher` decides whether a typed operation fits one source-described resource. Missing timing evidence never becomes zero delay.

Current intentional separations are retained:

- canonical `ExpressionOp` capability and typed-expression class dispatch are connected by one closed mapping, but the two IR layers are not merged;
- formal observability remains binding- and ownership-dependent, so it is not inferred from pure-value capability alone;

- target planner subgraph covering remains separate from scalar operation matching because DSP cascade legality is a graph property, not a node cost.

0.17 Implementation profiles

Implementation profiles keep physical policy outside portable .zhl source. They are named tables in zlang.toml and are selected explicitly:

```
[profiles.release]
backend = "systemverilog"
backend-mode = "required"
target = "xc7z030ffg676-1"
allowed-transforms = ["pipeline", "dsp", "reduction"]
avoided-transforms = ["reassociate"]
objective = "maximize fmax"
architecture = "Xilinx7SymmetricDSPCascade"
architecture-mode = "preferred"
evidence-policy = "measured_required"
formal-policy = "required_bmc"

[profiles.release.constraints]
latency = { maximum = 8 }
ii = { exact = 1 }
fmax = { minimum = 100 }
dsp = { maximum = 8 }
```

Schematic use inside a project containing the shown src/fir.zhl and profile:

```
zlang src/fir.zhl --profile release --systemverilog build/Fir.sv
```

A profile may select pinned scalar external-module implementations with external-mappings = ["vendor-add"]. Mapping declarations live in the top-level external-mappings tables of zlang.toml; their source files and hashes are fixed by zlang.lock. They affect direct-SV artifact text, never the backend-independent model or implementation-policy identity.

Only the selected profile is parsed strictly. This permits a project to carry profiles for newer compilers without making unrelated builds fail. Selecting an unknown profile, selecting a profile without a project, or using an unknown key is an error. Profile data is excluded from dependency resolution and lock identity, but the normalized selected request participates in implementation and later whole-build identities.

0.17.1 Semantic regions

The compiler reports one stable identity for each public scalar wire-output region. A profile can address an exact subset with regions = ["DIGEST", ...]. Generate --implementation-policy-report once to obtain the 64-character digests.

Region identity is derived from the logical module specialization, typed public output binding, canonical expression identity, and exact result type. Source paths, spans, physical instances, and generated RTL names are excluded. Stale and duplicate identities fail explicitly. The first slice is root-module only and scalar-only; recursive/profile-selected protocol regions are deferred.

0.17.2 Normalization and conflicts

choice(auto) remains accepted for user-supplied alternatives. Scalar architecture(auto), pipeline(auto), and explore are retired and produce migration diagnostics. Canonical implement source policy is represented through the same ImplementationRequest model as the selected profile and explicit compiler options. Equal normalized contributions are harmless.

Different values for the same target, transform set, objective, constraint, evidence policy, formal policy, or architecture are rejected with both origins in the diagnostic.

For an ordinary typed scalar output, profile transforms/constraints/objectives run through the existing bounded exploration explorer. Canonical implement regions have already run during semantic analysis, so their retained candidate table is compared but never run a second time. Retained legacy records are handled the same way for replay only; no new transform or equivalence rule is introduced.

An exact module timing block is immutable public behavior. Profile bounds may equal or contain that exact latency/II, but cannot weaken or contradict it.

0.17.3 Backend plans

--backend-implementation-report contains one stable systemverilog slot. It is selected, generic_fallback, unsupported, or not_requested. A preferred unsupported physical route may fall back to a technology-independent graph. A required route fails compilation.

Current boundaries are deliberate: one backend is selected per named profile, II is limited to existing semantics, and profiles cannot introduce protocol, CDC, memory, retiming, or formal capabilities that the typed compiler does not already support.

0.18 Target platform descriptions

This original four-DSP slice has now been generalized by the [low-level target/resource library](#). The historical measurements below remain valid for the unregistered profile; the current library uses generic pipeline-site names and implementation manifest version 7. The later [target-aware planner](#) adds bounded automatic selection; the manual flow below remains a reproducible explicit-selection witness rather than the complete current planner surface.

ZLang keeps functional behavior, implementation architecture, and physical target data separate. The first bounded implementation maps the ordinary functional [symmetric FIR example](#) to four DSP48E1 resources on xc7z030ffg676-1. Without an explicit selection, the same source continues through the generic direct-SV path.

0.18.1 Compiler-shipped source descriptions

Target data is ordinary compiler-shipped ZLang source:

- std.target.generic defines the resource-free generic target;
- std.target.xilinx.series7 defines the bounded DSP48E1 capability;
- std.target.xilinx.xc7z030 defines the device part, inventory, and cascade capacity;
- std.arch.xilinx7_fir defines the one manual symmetric-FIR template;
- std.target.toy_asic and std.arch.toy prove that the core records are not FPGA- or Xilinx-specific.

The core parser and IR understand generic resources, typed ports, operation and width limits, register sites, dedicated links, inventories, targets, and architecture requirements. The names DSP48E1, PCIN, and PCOUT, and the physical SystemVerilog binding all originate in the library definitions - not in functional ZLang or semantic branches.

An exact source-level timing { latency N ii 1 } block is public module behavior, not target-selection policy. Generic implementation graphs publish their derived timeless/known/unknown timing class and are explicitly backend-independent. A selected physical graph carries its realization backend so a direct-SystemVerilog resource plan cannot be attributed to another physical implementation. Target selection must preserve any exact public module latency.

The bounded Series-7 profile describes a signed 25-bit pre-adder, signed 25x18 multiply, 43-bit product, 48-bit P/PCIN/PCOUT path, optional A/B/D/AD/M/C/P register sites, and an adjacent/same-group 48-bit dedicated cascade. The XC7Z030 instance records 400 DSP slices and four locally available cascade positions; this is deliberately not a complete floorplan model.

0.18.2 Manual selection

```
.venv/bin/zlang examples/symmetric_fixed_fir.zhl \  
--target xc7z030ffg676-1 \  
--target-architecture Xilinx7SymmetricDSPCascade \  
--target-architecture-mode required \  
--systemverilog build/SymmetricFixedFIR.sv \  
--implementation-manifest build/SymmetricFixedFIR.manifest.json
```

required turns every target, shape, width, inventory, dedicated-link, or backend failure into a diagnostic. preferred returns the generic graph on a mapping failure. generic and omission of target options preserve the existing generic implementation. This original command performs explicit selection; bounded automatic target-aware selection is documented separately in the [high-level planner guide](#).

0.18.3 The selected graph

The matcher covers typed semantic structure only. It requires eight products, four coefficient expression identities reused at mirrored sample indices, and one final nearest_even/saturate conversion to fixed<16,14>. It does not use module names, source spelling, runtime coefficient equality, or test vectors.

For SF2.10 samples and coefficients the legality evidence is:

Quantity	Required	DSP48E1 profile
pair pre-add	13 signed bits	25
coefficient/B	12 signed bits	18
exact product	25 signed bits	43
exact four-pair accumulation	27 signed bits	48

The resulting ImplementationGraph has four resource instances and three DedicatedPhysicalEdge records:

```
dsp0.PCOUT -> dsp1.PCIN -> dsp2.PCIN -> dsp3.PCIN
```

Each node maps the left/right sample expressions to A/D, the shared coefficient to B, and its predecessor/result identities to PCIN/P/PCOUT. Every internal DSP register site is explicitly zero in this first profile. The ordinary semantic output register provides latency 1; II is 1. The complete 48-bit cascade result then crosses the single original quantization boundary. No intermediate is narrowed.

0.18.4 Backend and manifest

The direct-SV emitter consumes the selected graph; it does not rediscover a FIR. Its source-selected physical binding instantiates four Series-7 DSP48E1 primitives with INMODE=00100, OP-MODE=0010101, USE_DPORT=TRUE, direct A/B, and all selected internal register stages disabled. Actual PCOUT ports drive the next primitives' actual PCIN ports. A distinct behavioral resource model is used only for Verilator simulation.

BackendArtifact manifest version 5 retains the v4 semantic bindings and adds target/family/template identities and hashes, dependency hashes, selection policy, resource configuration and semantic mappings, dedicated edges, latency/II, intended counts, and the emitted artifact hash. Intended resource use is never presented as a Vivado measurement.

0.18.5 Boundaries

The generic direct-SystemVerilog implementation remains available when no primitive graph is selected. Existing semantic-reference equivalence can validate the semantic fixed-point region, but its reference emitter does not model vendor primitives. Physical evidence therefore

consists of the exact semantic oracle, Verilator execution of the separate resource behavior model, and real Vivado synthesis/place/route of the primitive artifact. No primitive-level formal infrastructure was added.

Automatic target exploration was outside this original manual slice. The later planner covers only its documented symmetric-FIR and signed-product regions; general placement/graph covering, DSP48E2, Intel physical emission, automatic storage/clock-resource mapping, and new formal machinery remain outside the current bounded support.

0.19 Target resources

This document records the implemented unnumbered low-level substrate. This low-level layer describes legal resources and physical bindings; it does not itself select a design. The separate accepted [high-level target-aware planner](#) automatically selects the bounded symmetric-FIR and signed-product candidates documented there. Bounded ported-memory planning can match an exact advertised memory shape, replicate 1R1W resources for 1W+nR, or use a bounded register/mux fallback. Automatic banking and clock-resource planning remain outside the supported slice.

0.19.1 Implemented model

Compiler-shipped ZLang source now defines generic, AMD 7-series, Intel Cyclone V, and ASIC-compatible resources. Resource definitions carry generic class, operation, capabilities, typed ports/limits, semantic pipeline sites, legal pipeline configurations, dedicated edges, and an opaque backend binding.

The loader validates duplicate/unknown pipeline sites, configuration latency, II, memory port/width/capacity, clock input/output/output-count requirements, dedicated edges, and target inventory. The same parser accepts project-local resource declarations; resolving project packages is deliberately deferred.

The generic library contains ordinary-RTL descriptions for logic, registers, multiplier/add/MAC, FIFO storage, RAM/ROM, clock/control abstractions, and carry. Selecting generic, or compiling without a target, leaves typed semantic IR and direct-SV semantics unchanged.

0.19.2 DSP48E1 manual pipeline validation

The existing four-DSP symmetric FIR is now mapped through source-defined DSP48E1 data. Its semantic sites are:

```
input_preadd -> multiply -> accumulate_output
```

The physical binding maps these to A/B/D registers, MREG, and terminal PREG; those physical names do not occur in an architecture template or functional module. Four templates manually select four legal configurations. Separate ZLang sources provide matching total latency contracts, and the behavioral DSP model passes the same bit-exact vectors for all four at II=1.

Vivado 2024.2 routed results on xc7z030ffg676-1, 10 ns constraint:

Configuration	Active sites	Latency	DSP config A/B/D/M/P
unregistered	none	1	all 0/0/0/0/0
multiply registered	multiply	2	all 0/0/0/1/0
multiply + output	multiply, accumulate_output	3	MREG all, PREG terminal
fully pipelined	input_preadd, multiply, accumulate_output	4	A/B/D/M all, P terminal

All four cascades occupy four adjacent DSP48 sites. The two configurations with terminal PREG cross 100 MHz; merely enabling MREG does not. Fully pipelined and multiply+output have identical routed timing in this design, showing that the terminal accumulation boundary, not blindly adding every input register, is the decisive cut for this constraint.

These rows were rerouted after the LSB-first packing migration. The `tools/dsp48e1_pipeline_qor.py` runner checks the selected graph latency, emits explicit primitives, queries actual A/B/D/M/P settings and locations, and records routed QoR. These are manual measurements, not planner costs.

0.19.3 Signed-product cascade validation

The same source-defined DSP48E1 binding now also covers the ordered SignedProductReduction graph used by the FFT scalar real and imaginary components. The direct-SV emitter consumes the per-resource `accumulator_plus_product/accumulator_minus_product` configuration and emits ALUMODE controls without rewriting the finite-width expression. The final fixed-point conversion remains one typed boundary after the cascade.

Eight real/imag variants were rerouted on the same target and constraint after the LSB-first indexed-aggregate ABI change invalidated their physical graph identities. Each uses two DSP48E1, 227 LUT, 18 FF and zero BRAM. Unregistered real/imag forms reach 79.183/83.612 MHz; multiply-registered forms both reach 105.585 MHz; multiply-output and fully-pipelined forms both reach 106.157 MHz. Their latencies are respectively 1/2/3/4 and II is 1. Full rows, DSP register properties, locations and graph identities are in `zlang/data/xc7z030_signed_product_qor.json`; rerun them with `tools/signed_product_pipeline_qor.py`. Its explicit `--evidence-output` option writes planner-ready evidence from the graph that was actually routed; old measurements are never re-keyed onto a changed graph.

0.19.4 RAMB36 validation

`examples/target_bram_memory.zhl` is an ordinary 1024x36, one-cycle, read-first synchronous memory with independent read/write addresses. Generic direct-SV emits ordinary RAM RTL. Manual `Xilinx7BRAM36SimpleDualPort` selection consumes one RAMB36 capability and emits the same semantic template with a block-memory physical binding.

Both variants pass Verilator write/read behavior. Vivado reports:

Implementation	RAMB36E1	RAMB18E1
generic RTL inference	1	0
selected RAMB36 binding	1	0

An initial write-first cross-port fixture measured zero BRAM and 768 distributed RAM LUTs. Vivado reported the block style infeasible because the ZLang write-first bypass across independent addresses is not the selected primitive's simple-dual-port collision contract. The validation fixture therefore uses the already-defined read-first semantics; the compiler did not weaken or silently reinterpret the original mode.

Named true-dual selection is a distinct RTL shape. Generic same-clock multiport storage retains one deterministic process, but the selected Xilinx 2RW route requires contents preserve and emits one physical process per port. A 1024x9 fixture with uniform init 0x12 was synthesized by Vivado 2024.2 for `xc7z030ffg676-1`; Vivado explicitly recognized a true-dual RAM template and produced one RAMB18E1 (17 LUT / 20 FF around the RAM for reset, enable, and same-address priority logic). The corresponding generic independent-clock 1W1R structural witness also produced one RAMB18E1. That inference result does not upgrade its cross-clock collision model to an exact vendor guarantee.

The manually selected FIFO-only architectures `Xilinx7AsyncFifoRAMB18` and `Xilinx7AsyncFifoRAMB36` require the compiler-owned registered-read `async_fifo` decomposition, an independent-clock 1W1R port shape, exactly one read cycle and `D0_REG=0`. They do not select a public `async_mem`. Its physical plan owns ordered, width-aware pointer, Gray, full, ready/valid and prefetch equations. The direct-SV emitter renders those equations and the digital simulator evaluates the same equations; neither keeps an independent combinational FIFO-controller recipe. Vivado 2024.2 synthesis of a 1024x9 FIFO on `xc7z030ffg676-1`, with asynchronous 10/7-ns clock groups, measured:

FIFO RTL shape	LUT	FF	RAMB18E1	Read-clock WNS	Write-clock WNS
prior combinational array read	275	100	0	3.937 ns	6.830 ns
typed async_mem registered read + prefetch	38	90	1	2.533 ns	6.934 ns

These are post-synthesis, unplaced numbers from the prior emitted RTL shape and the new selected RTL, not post-route Fmax or silicon behavior. The new binding substantially reduces LUT usage and infers block RAM; it does not improve the read-domain critical path in this witness. Physical clock/reset and metastability requirements remain implementation responsibilities.

The live resource capability schema now distinguishes `simple_dual`, same-clock `true_dual`, and independent-clock `1W1R`; it also separates same-clock from cross-clock collision guarantees. A legacy `true_dual` flag is not sufficient evidence for an asynchronous collision contract. The current 7-Series data intentionally advertises no exact cross-clock old/new guarantee, so strict target-required `async_mem` publication fails closed while generic direct-SV remains an explicitly labelled structural digital model.

0.19.5 Intel and ASIC status

Cyclone V source data describes variable-precision multiplier modes, 64-bit accumulation, chain connectivity, generic pipeline sites/configurations, M10K port/width modes, ALM/FF distinctions, and a fractional PLL resource. The same generic legality checks used for RAMB/MMCM validate M10K/PLL requests.

Quartus is not installed. The Intel physical binding is recorded but direct-SV fails closed with unsupported; no primitive, synthesis, or QoR claim is made. ASIC multiplier/SRAM/PLL/standard-cell fixtures prove that no FPGA family enum is required by the IR. Their physical macros likewise remain project/backend work.

0.19.6 Clock-resource blocker

The target libraries can describe clock input/output ranges, output counts, phase capability, and lock/reset metadata. Current functional ZLang clock domains do not express a frequency/phase relationship from which a truthful PLL/MMCM configuration could be derived. Physical clock emission therefore remains unsupported. A later review must add a generic clock requirement model before any primitive is emitted; raw PLL generics will not be exposed in normal modules.

0.19.7 BackendArtifact implementation manifest v7

Implementation manifests now retain selected pipeline configuration, active semantic sites, physical-binding identities, and separate intended, emitted, and measured resource-count slots plus timing provenance. Existing semantic bindings remain independent. Current compiler-produced artifacts populate intended/emitted counts after successful physical emission; external vendor tools own measured counts and routed timing.

0.19.8 Reproduction

```
.venv/bin/python -m pytest -q \
  tests/test_low_level_resources.py \
  tests/test_target_architecture.py \
  tests/integration/test_xilinx_dsp_pipeline_configs.py \
  tests/integration/test_target_bram.py

.venv/bin/python tools/dsp48e1_pipeline_qor.py \
  --output /tmp/zlang-dsp-pipelines --vivado /path/to/vivado
```

```
.venv/bin/python tools/target_bram_vendor_qor.py \
  --output /tmp/zlang-bram --vivado /path/to/vivado
```

Automatic target-aware planning is enabled only for the reviewed symmetric-FIR and ordered signed-product reduction regions documented in the [high-level planner guide](#). General explore, BRAM/clock selection, and arbitrary resource ranking remain disabled. The accepted boundary is documented in the [high-level planner guide](#).

0.20 Target-aware architecture and pipeline planning

The bounded planner is implemented for two exact fixed-point region families on xc7z030ffg676-1: the symmetric FIR cascade and ordered signed-product reductions used by complex multiply (p0 - p1 and p0 + p1). It extends the existing architecture alternatives/exact reduction planning/pipeline scheduling/timing alignment/deterministic cost selection/bounded exploration path; it is not a second exploration engine.

0.20.1 User contract

```
result = implement {
  quantize<fixed<16,14>>(acc) {
    round nearest_even
    overflow saturate
  }
  intent { latency <= 8 ii == 1 fmax >= 100 }
}
```

ii and the compatibility spelling throughput normalize to one canonical II constraint. Fmax values are MHz. latency<=N is a bound. latency==N is an exact observable sample latency.

The target is build configuration, for example:

```
zlang examples/symmetric_fixed_fir_auto.zhl \
  --top SymmetricFixedFIRAuto \
  --target xc7z030ffg676-1 \
  --target-evidence-policy measured_required \
  --systemverilog build/SymmetricFixedFIRAuto.sv \
  --implementation-manifest build/SymmetricFixedFIRAuto.json \
  --pipeline-report build/SymmetricFixedFIRAuto.report
```

Functional source never names DSP48E1, MREG or PREG. With no target, or with --target generic, the ordinary generic candidate and backends remain active.

0.20.2 Candidate generation and legality

The symmetric-FIR region is exactly an eight-tap signed fixed reduction where four coefficient semantic values are reused at mirrored sample indices. Runtime coefficient equality is not symmetry. Eight independent coefficients therefore remain generic. The signed-product region is derived from the already typed SignedProductReduction: ordered product terms and each add/subtract join are preserved, and the resource must advertise the required accumulator modes. Arbitrary subtraction trees or reassociation are not inferred.

The candidate set is:

1. generic implementation;
2. source-described symmetric cascade with no resource-local site;
3. multiply site selected;
4. multiply and terminal output sites selected;
5. input/pre-add, multiply and terminal output sites selected.

These are the four configurations published by the resource library. Core code does not enumerate primitive register bits. The signed-product family applies the same configuration names to its exact two-resource chain. Before cost extraction the planner validates the typed pattern, exact pre-add/product/accumulator widths, required add/sub capability, inventory, dedicated edges, II, and latency.

The final FixedConvert stays after the full 27-bit/F20 accumulation. A mapping requiring hidden narrowing is rejected and the generic candidate remains.

0.20.3 Timing DAG

Every selected target graph carries a backend-independent timing DAG with stable semantic/implementation identities. It records resource combinational segments, selected resource-local cuts, the three dedicated cascade edges, fabric boundaries, final fixed quantization and output boundary.

timing alignment alignment produces explicit alignment delay objects. Exact external latency produces separate compensation objects. Both record cycles, width and fabric FF cost in the graph and manifest. They are never reconstructed from RTL names.

For the selected useful latency-three implementation:

- latency<=8 adds no delay;
- latency==8 adds one explicit five-cycle output compensation delay;
- resource-local useful sites remain unchanged.

The direct-SV emitter consumes this graph. The base output boundary and five compensation cycles form the required output register chain; source pipeline(N) latency is not added again.

0.20.4 Evidence and extraction

Evidence distinguishes:

- structural_estimate;
- synthesis_measurement;
- routed_measurement.

measured_required accepts only compatible routed evidence for an Fmax constraint. Structural latency/II remain authoritative and are not erased by that policy. Compatibility includes target/part, architecture, complete graph hash, pipeline configuration, backend, clock constraint and tool/version.

The shipped Vivado 2024.2 records are data in zlang/data/xc7z030_dsp_pipeline_qor.json and zlang/data/xc7z030_signed_product_qor.json; ranking contains no configuration-name special case. deterministic cost selection applies hard constraints and the existing minimize lut default. Its deterministic latency tie-break selects the lower-latency candidate when measured costs tie. With measured-required evidence and the frozen 100 MHz constraint, the signed real/imag witnesses select the two-cycle multiply_registered configuration.

The selected bounded report is equivalent to:

```
target: xc7z030ffg676-1
requirements: latency <= 8, ii == 1, fmax >= 100
rejected unregistered: routed 73.432 MHz < 100
rejected multiply-only: routed 81.294 MHz < 100
selected symmetric cascade / multiply+terminal-output
resources: DSP=4 LUT=239 FF=16
latency=3 II=1 routed Fmax=103.178 MHz
```

The packaged records were regenerated by routing the current emitted graphs after the LSB-first packing migration; old graph identities are not relabelled as current measurements.

0.20.5 BackendArtifact implementation manifest v7

The implementation manifest retains normalized user constraints, objective and metric sources, selected template/target/graph/configuration, generic pipeline sites, resources, dedicated edges, complete timing DAG, alignment and compensation objects, latency/II, evidence identity and implementation artifact hash. JSON round-trip uses implementation manifest version 7; older optional fields retain validated compatibility defaults.

0.20.6 Current boundary

Automatic target planning is intentionally limited to the symmetric-FIR and signed-product direct-SV regions above. BRAM, PLL/MMCM, Intel physical planning, arbitrary graph covering, II-changing sharing, and automatic fixed transformations are not enabled. Generic direct SystemVerilog remains the fallback implementation. Existing formal infrastructure is unchanged and no primitive-level proof claim is made.

Reproduce physical validation with:

```
.venv/bin/python tools/target_auto_fir_qor.py \  
  --output /tmp/zlang-target-auto-fir \  
  --vivado /path/to/Vivado/2024.2/bin/vivado
```

0.21 Platform constraints

Status: implemented. This work does not change ZLang source semantics.

0.21.1 Decision

The current synchronous Memory is already a one-read/one-write simple dual-port resource: one read and one write may be accepted on the same edge. A genuinely distinct same-domain true-dual-port memory would require two symmetric read/write ports and a frozen same-address dual-write contract. No current real-design validation requires more than one read or one write per cycle, so that slice is rescheduled until a concrete design supplies evidence. Byte masks, initialized writable memory, independent memory clocks and automatic BRAM mapping remain separate concerns.

Physical clock publication is justified now because the existing QoR helpers otherwise duplicate handwritten `create_clock` commands. A selected project profile may therefore add exactly one explicitly named clock period:

```
[profiles.release.platform.clocks.clk]  
period-ns = 10.0
```

The clock name must match the one typed `ClockDomain` on the selected top. The period is physical build configuration: it is not semantic IR, is not inferred from `fmax`, and is not merged into `ImplementationRequest`.

The CLI publishes a constraint only together with exactly one backend artifact. The following commands are schematic and assume a project-local `top.zhl` plus the release profile shown above:

```
zlang top.zhl --profile release --systemverilog top.sv \  
  --constraints-xdc top.xdc  
  
zlang top.zhl --profile release -o Top.hs \  
  --constraints-sdc top.sdc
```

The compiler resolves the RTL port through the artifact's typed `CLOCK` binding, never through generated-name guessing. XDC and SDC initially contain only:

```
create_clock -name clk -period 10 [get_ports {clk}]
```

Each version-2 constraint artifact retains its backend hash, selected-IR identity, clock edge, and complete reset mode/polarity/release-cycle/power-up metadata. For a non-default contract, publication also requires an exact version-10 physical-domain record in the BackendArtifact; stale or mismatched reset semantics are rejected. Whole-build manifests publish the file as a backend companion and include the platform profile and constraint identities. XDC/SDC output is deterministic and atomically published without following symlinks.

No reset false path is emitted: asynchronous-reset recovery/removal timing must not be hidden. Generated clocks, multiple clock domains, pin/package/IO properties, input/output delays, CDC constraints and formal properties are outside this bounded slice.

0.22 Direct SystemVerilog

The backend consumes typed semantic IR. It never dispatches on AXI, APB, or RegBus module names: source-authored standard-bus components use the same aggregate endpoint, hierarchy, register, rule, and connection lowering as user modules.

Ordinary scalar register/rule components share the standalone/composed dispatch and register contributor. Independent rules do not require global scheduler enumeration merely because a module is instantiated as a child. Hierarchy validation is cached only within one emission; protocol/storage effects and conflicting multi-effect rules keep their existing exact paths. ZL-017's composed AHB/queued Q16 witness now emits in about 16.4 seconds on the recorded host. Generated private names now use a shared hierarchy-local allocation plan: `cfg_ready`, `lane_0`, `lane_0_value`, `result_pipe_s1`, and short specialized definitions such as `Counter_s1a2b3c4d`. Source names win over generated helpers; actual collisions receive a deterministic suffix. Public top/port ABI and source register names are unchanged, including existing public aggregate-leaf separators. BackendArtifact records the naming schema and complete semantic identities separately from regenerated RTL/VPI locators. Naming does not change circuit semantics or imply QoR gains.

Formal-only `rule.fire` now uses the same effective reset and polarity as production state, including the two-edge synchronized release and conditioned child reset. Real RTL covers both polarities, both active edges and nested hierarchy. Its separate global-guard enumeration scalability limitation remains: large independent-rule formal projections still require a future bounded fix.

Fixed-point ports and expressions use the canonical scaled-integer types behind `fixed`/`ufixed`, concise `SF/UF`, and `_Sat` formats. Same-scale target narrowing and explicit rescaling are both emitted from `FixedConvert`; the backend never infers wrap, saturation, or rounding from source spelling.

0.22.1 Supported composition subset

- scalar and packed struct/vector/tuple datapaths, `char/string<N>` aliases, immutable locals, muxes, field/projection access, compile-time and proven runtime packed-bit indexing with LSB-zero semantics, exact-width bitcast, homogeneous vector concat, compile-time reshape, reductions, fixed-point arithmetic/conversion, and selected or nested fixed-latency scalar pipelines with `II=1`;
- registers, next-state assignments, atomic rules, FSM lowering, reset, and priority in one or more explicitly owned domains, including one independent two-register asynchronous-assert/synchronous-release conditioner per applicable domain;
- reusable parameter specializations, distinct scalar physical child instances, and compile-time indexed combinational or single-domain sequential instance arrays, including aggregate scalar outputs and scheduled FIFO state combined with ordinary child registers/rules;
- mixed scalar/state/ready-valid/request-response children;
- mixed scalar plus ready/valid instance-array children, bounded nested same-domain scalar/direct-ready-valid array hierarchy, and first-level indexed in-order request/response requester/responder arrays;
- read-only runtime projection of one exact bit-packable scalar/aggregate wire output from an instance array; every physical child remains independently instantiated and active;

- the bounded single-input/single-output ready/valid transform pipeline(auto) with one pure pipeline scheduling product-reduction kernel and a compiler-owned global stall;
- ready/valid connections and finite connection FIFOs, including simultaneous push/pop and backpressure;
- scalar ready/valid `async_fifo(N)` clock crossings and aggregate crossings whose schema has exactly one forward ready/valid member; aggregate payloads cross as one packed atomic value;
- vendor-neutral scalar `sync_level`, `pulse_toggle`, and one-entry ready/valid handshake crossings, using the same coordinated-reset and latency semantics as the simulator;
- synchronous memories with the currently typed collision/read-latency model;
- fixed-priority and round-robin packet arbiters with beat- or packet-scoped grants;
- in-order hierarchical request/response channels with independent directional buffers as represented in typed IR;
- one mandatory public top ABI derived from `TopPhysicalABI`: structs are recursively exposed as named field leaves, tuples as deterministic `itemN` leaves, while every `vec<N,T>` leaf is a multidimensional packed SystemVerilog array (`logic [N-1:0][W-1:0] name` for a W-bit element); flat packed aggregate representations exist only as deterministic aliases inside the selected top or inside compact child components;
- source-authored AXI4-Lite, APB, AXI-Stream, Wishbone, RegBus, and CSR hierarchy used by the current standard-library and real-design examples;
- hardware-connected CSR `ro`, `pulse`, and sticky-W1C behavior with the frozen software/hardware priority policy;
- ready/valid-to-credit, credit-to-ready/valid, and per-VC credit source state machines from typed protocol/capacity metadata;
- BackendArtifact v4 recursive instance/state locators and version-10-or-newer physical domain contracts for non-default reset modes. Specialization identity is not used as physical instance identity.

SystemVerilog reserved words are deterministically prefixed with `zlang_`. The collision check runs after that physical-name mapping, so two distinct semantic leaves can never silently become one RTL port. Inline-boundary helper signals are allocated outside the public namespace and remain deterministic. Packed dimensions use conventional descending ranges. ZLang element zero maps directly to physical packed index zero and the least-significant private slice. The generated artifact has one unconditional top definition and is accepted by both Yosys and Verilator without backend preprocessor branches. Unresolved locals are eliminated before backend lowering. Unsupported IR shapes raise `SystemVerilogEmissionError`; no artifact is published after a failed emission.

Ordered comparisons preserve typed signedness explicitly: both operands of `<`, `<=`, `>`, and `>=` are rendered through `$signed` or `$unsigned` according to typed IR, independent of whether an operand is a port, local, projection, or register. Equality and inequality remain raw bit comparisons.

Use the stable CLI option:

```
.venv/bin/zlang examples/simple_dma.zhl --top SimpleDMA \
  --systemverilog build/SimpleDMA.sv
verilator --lint-only --top-module SimpleDMA build/SimpleDMA.sv
```

`--experimental-systemverilog` remains an exact compatibility alias. Both options are explicit artifact sinks: they write only the requested SV file and leave stdout empty. A bare `zlang SOURCE` invocation emits the production direct SystemVerilog artifact to stdout. Diagnostics remain on stderr.

Use `--verbose` when an explicit success confirmation is useful:

```
.venv/bin/zlang design.zhl --systemverilog design.sv --verbose
```

This keeps stdout artifact-safe and reports the selected top and written paths on stderr. To validate parsing, top selection, and semantic analysis without publishing any backend artifact, use:

```
.venv/bin/zlang design.zhl --check
```

--check prints a one-line success result and returns zero. Without --top it checks every module declared in the source file, preventing an invalid dormant module from being hidden by default-top selection. With --top, it checks only that selected elaboration root. Syntax, semantic, and top-selection failures retain their normal nonzero status and diagnostic. As a check-only mode, it cannot be combined with artifact output options.

0.22.2 Simulation-only architectural state access

A direct-SV build may publish a separate Verilator VPI companion without adding ports or changing the production RTL:

```
.venv/bin/zlang design.zhl \  
--systemverilog build/design.sv \  
--simulation-state-bundle build/state-access
```

The companion manifest covers the selected typed hierarchy and is bound to the exact emitted artifact hash, build identity, state shapes, and emitter-owned physical locators. Publication re-hashes the .sv file, so a stale or modified RTL file cannot receive an access manifest. The generated C++ header requires Verilator --vpi --public-flat-rw and validates its complete state allow-list before access.

The bounded surface includes bit-packable user registers (including vector registers), writable-memory cells, and the persistent read-result latch of a one-cycle memory. Values up to 64 bits have convenience methods; arbitrary-width scalars and elements use exact 32-bit least-significant-word-first arrays. Vector element zero retains the canonical least-significant packed position. The persistent semantic simulator consumes the same catalog and keeps one state object per physical child instance.

0.22.3 Formal boundary

Real Z3/SymbiYosys regression targets exercise emitted direct RTL for register transitions and rule priority, ready/valid stability and FIFO accounting, CSR W1C behavior, and request/response acceptance. Arithmetic, state-transition, FIFO-accounting, response-accounting, W1C, and priority mutations all fail with counterexample metadata.

The first-class verification-bundle path also accepts direct-SV designs with initialized ROM. Exact memory images are published below implementation/companions/ and listed as hash-validated inputs for every SBY job that consumes them. Generated solver configuration, logs, and VCDs are retained outside the immutable bundle; run-report v7 maps sampled physical VCD signals back to semantic binding IDs for witnesses and counterexamples.

Direct SV is the executable bundle route. If its formal emission cannot bind a required observation, the goal is explicitly skipped or rejected according to policy. Unsupported aggregate/protocol shapes report a non-executable reason; no generated-name reconstruction or alternate backend substitution is used.

Transaction-level RTL simulation found and fixed one source-library issue: RegBusCSRTarget previously asserted its response only in the request-transfer cycle, before the AXI-Lite/APB frontend entered its response phase. The ordinary .zhl target now stores response data and holds response.valid until response.transfer. Both source-authored AXI-Lite and APB paths complete real Verilator write transactions through RegBus after this fix.

The v4 manifest publishes recursive physical locators only for signals actually present in emitted RTL. Current direct-SV formal emission publishes the typed accepted-request, directional-buffer occupancy, response-consumption, and parent-owned outstanding-ledger observations used by the supported recursive request/response properties. Register, FIFO, CSR, and rule-fire observations are likewise executable where their complete typed binding sets exist. A formal_observation_token remains absent for hidden or unsupported state, and the affected property reports skipped rather than fabricating a proof.

0.22.4 Explicitly unsupported

Legacy globally controlled storage combined with user state, out-of-order or nested request/response arrays, additional protocols on a request/response array child, arbitrary nested storage/CSR/aggregate protocol hierarchy, CDC arrays, and runtime-selected inputs, protocols, or actions remain fail-closed. The backend never silently emits only one element or reconstructs an indexed connection from an RTL name.

Sequential ready/valid modules and role-qualified standalone in-order request_response requester/responder modules use the same typed clock/reset, ownership, and accounting semantics as their hierarchical forms. A standalone endpoint owns a local unbuffered ledger: request transfer increments it, response transfer decrements it, and reset starts a new empty epoch. Stateful generic child templates that still require parent specialization remain validated through their concrete parents.

0.22.5 Exhaustive example matrix

The direct-SV regression recursively discovers every .zhl file and every declared module root under examples/. There are no emission-error skips. Each root is classified as standalone-supported, child/template-only, or explicitly unsupported; an unclassified new root is tested as standalone-supported.

The local snapshot including the arithmetic/exploration tutorial contains **87 .zhl files / 181 module roots / 164 standalone roots / 17 child or template roots / 0 unsupported roots**. The registry test remains authoritative when examples change; these numbers are an evidence snapshot rather than a hard-coded allow-list.

The intentionally incorrect RareOverflowBug is valid synthesizable hardware: it must emit/lint successfully, while its separate verification test requires a counterexample. Emission support is not a claim that user assertions hold.

The executable registry reports the current source/root totals during test collection. Every discovered standalone-supported root emits a BackendArtifact and passes strict Verilator lint; child/template-only roots are exercised through a concrete parent or specialization, and no current root requires an explicit unsupported classification. This avoids turning a documentation count into a second registry whenever project source units are consolidated.

The child/template registry retains only generic stateful/DMA/FFT children that still require a concrete specialization or parent ABI, plus canonical Wi-Fi helpers whose standalone top would expose a nominal enum through an external raw ABI. Each has one named raw/concrete parent witness. The executable registry in tests/systemverilog/test_example_coverage.py is authoritative; adding a new root without an explicit child reason makes it standalone-supported by default.

Every currently discovered non-child root is standalone-supported; new roots enter that class automatically and must emit and lint rather than being silently skipped. This closes the current example corpus, not every possible IR shape: unsupported future constructs still fail closed at capability checking. Publication additionally requires the shared exact-once ModuleFeatureInventory check described in backend tooling; a renderer cannot silently omit or double-own a selected IR entity and still return an artifact.

The additional streaming roots include the staged FFT4SDFReference through FFT512SDFReference hierarchy. Direct SV emits one distinct specialization per stage and deterministic ROM companions at the corresponding depths; FFT512 publishes all nine companions and passes complete oracle-backed RTL simulation. The persistent backend-independent simulator also runs the same 1,033-cycle replay by default in about 11 seconds and roughly 84 MiB RSS. Its 512 outputs match direct-SV RTL against the frozen oracle. This validates the functional hierarchy, not automatic DSP mapping or physical QoR.

examples/projects/80211a_transmitter is the first complete converted-IP project in the corpus. Its executable source is consolidated into the canonical data_types, controller, scrambler, conv_encoder, interleaver, mapper, ifft_library, cyclic_extender, ifft, and transmitter units. Ieee80211aTransmitter is the stable top; temporary compatibility and implementation-prefixed roots have been retired from the source tree.

The earlier conversion slices exposed reusable direct-SV fixes: typed FIFO read-side projections, consistent port-name mangling in RTL and manifests, exact packed slicing, keyword-safe helper names, recursive closed ready/valid children, and deterministic materialization of shared expressions. Those findings remain recorded in the Wi-Fi validation report, but the old roots are not alternate executable profiles.

The canonical hierarchy exercises packet framing, a stateful scrambler, K=7 encoding, corrected IEEE R1/R2/R4 interleaving, BPSK/QPSK/16-QAM mapping, pilot state, exact widened DIF-SDF arithmetic, natural-order reorder, and an 80-sample cyclic prefix. It uses only generic typed hierarchy, ready/valid, rules, vectors, ROM companions, fixed-point operations, and source-level helpers. No Wi-Fi module-name dispatch or backend-only permutation/IFFT logic exists.

The compact whole-vector IFFT64 reference is deliberately not added as a full N=64 RTL corpus root. Its N=64 path is semantic/canonical/simulator evidence; N=8 and N=16 use the same typed FunctionalRegion and exact reduction plan as physical direct-SV/Verilator witnesses. The backend does not contain an IFFT, Complex, or Wi-Fi-specific lowering rule.

The canonical hierarchy is a streaming inverse DIF-SDF design rather than that whole-vector reference. It composes IEEE-authoritative framing, scrambling, convolutional coding, corrected R1/R2/R4 interleaving, mapping, D32/D16/D8/D4/D2/D1, natural-order reorder, and an 80-sample cyclic prefix. Ieee80211aTransmitter passes a complete 903-cycle direct-SV/Verilator packet replay against the independent oracle. The implementation uses generic typed hierarchy rather than Wi-Fi-specific backend behavior.

Strict lint keeps only non-correctness waivers for declaration filenames and unused/undriven test-fixture signals. Width, latch, driver, and structural warnings remain fatal. In particular, all fixed-point conversion constants are emitted at the exact conversion work width. Writable memories lower their typed zero/one-cycle read, collision, byte-mask, cell-reset and read-result-reset profile directly; the omitted profile retains the legacy one-cycle clear/clear text. Named same-clock generic ports emit one deterministic cell-owning process; an exact selected Xilinx true-dual binding emits one process per physical port and requires reset-preserved cells so BRAM inference remains truthful. Optional uniform init VALUE drives generic clear-on-reset contents or preserved FPGA power-up contents according to the source reset policy. Bounded 1W+nR fallback emits coherent replicated arrays. async_mem emits distinct writer/read-result processes, with exactly one cell writer and exact domain-local resets. Generic async RTL is labelled structural rather than a vendor collision guarantee.

0.22.6 Internal combinational-driver style

Compiler-generated internal combinational values use a declare-first form:

```
logic zlang_push, zlang_pop;
assign zlang_push = input_valid && input_ready;
assign zlang_pop = output_valid && output_ready;
```

The production emitter does not combine declaration and drive as `wire name = expression`. Exact packed widths and signedness remain on the logic declaration. A simple single-driver equation uses continuous assign; `always_comb` is reserved for grouped logic that requires defaults, branching, or multiple related procedural assignments. ANSI input/output net declarations, parameters, formal initial-state variables, testbenches, and user-supplied external SystemVerilog are not rewritten by this backend style rule.

The example registry checks this invariant across every emitted standalone root. Additional focused witnesses cover optional FIFO observations, masked memory writes, packet arbitration, hierarchical FIFO helpers, CDC, and the simulation-only DSP48E1 helper.

0.22.7 Validation record

The current acceptance tool versions and zero-skip release minimum are recorded in [release/status.json](#). The FFT512 backend-independent replay is now a routine bounded test rather than an opt-in skip. Historical per-slice counts remain in their validation records;

they are not the current baseline. The representative examples/all_syntax.zhl language-tour backend audit checks every declared top separately; exhaustive direct-SV root coverage remains the separate registry described above:

- direct SystemVerilog emits and passes strict Verilator lint for all 29 tops;
- CdcSyntax and the single-channel aggregate AXIStream crossing use the same typed Gray-pointer async-FIFO semantics;
- nested rule expressions containing delay/pipeline, fixed saturation, packet arbitration, and clocked contracts have dedicated regressions;
- fixed-priority and round-robin packet arbitration, plus nested state staging, execute in real Verilator simulations.

The wider streaming, fixed-point, DMA, and Wishbone tops remain lint-clean in direct SV. Python compileall and git diff --check also pass.

0.23 Compiler tooling API

ZLang HDL exposes a small, read-only Python integration surface in zlang.tooling. It is intended for editors, build coordinators and other compiler-aware tools that must not depend on parser, workspace or semantic IR implementation modules.

Consumers must check TOOLING_API_SCHEMA; the package version alone is not a compatibility guarantee. The version-1 API publishes immutable records for:

- compiler, source-suffix and capability identity;
- source declarations and direct-import resolution;
- the immutable document-symbol projection for the current source text;
- the immutable semantic-hover projection for one source position;
- the immutable compiler-resolved definition projection for one source position;
- the immutable compiler-resolved reference projection for one source position;
- the immutable semantic rename-edit projection for one source position;
- the immutable compiler-visible semantic completion projection for one source position;
- the immutable compiler-resolved signature-help projection for one source position;
- the immutable compiler-classified semantic-token projection for one source;
- compiler-owned machine-applicable diagnostic fixes for semantic checks;
- read-only project/workspace indexing and dependency closure;
- one exact semantic-only source-snapshot check.

These calls do not emit RTL, run formal tools, synthesize a design or mutate a project lock. A failed semantic check is returned as a structured record. An environment or malformed-project failure that prevents a trustworthy record raises ToolingError.

0.23.1 Demand-driven observational analysis

The semantic checker separates language correctness from optional editor observations. check_file_snapshot() accepts the compiler-owned zlang.analysis_needs.AnalysisNeeds bitmask; the default is NONE, so a normal compiler check does not construct editor records. The tooling projections request only what they consume:

query	demanded records
definition_at, references_at, rename_at, semantic_tokens	DEFINITIONS
completion_at	DEFINITIONS + COMPLETION
signature_help_at	SIGNATURE_HELP
hover_at, check_snapshot	none

DEFINITIONS covers the shared compiler identity/occurrence records used by definition, references, rename and semantic-token projections. Completion scope/candidate/detail collection is therefore not entered by a definition-only request. The needs mask controls observational sinks only; typed semantic checking, canonical IR and all backend products remain unchanged.

There is no process-global semantic cache or incremental analysis layer; the normalized persistent symbol cache is described below.

The audit found no separate eager record for hover: hover projects the already required AST/typed IR product. Likewise, references, rename and semantic tokens do not need independent collectors; they project the definition identity/occurrence records. The previously eager records were therefore `definition_resolutions/definition_declarations`, `completion_scopes` (and its candidate/detail builders), and `signature_help_calls`. All are now allocated only when their corresponding need is present.

The API is intentionally generic. It does not expose private product features, session state, autonomous behavior or a plugin-specific command surface.

0.23.2 Diagnostic edits

`TOOLING_DIAGNOSTIC_EDIT_SCHEMA` is currently 1. A failed `check_snapshot()` record retains the existing prose-only `ToolingDiagnostic.fixes` and may additionally contain immutable `ToolingDiagnosticFix` records. Each machine fix preserves its compiler-owned title and one atomic tuple of `ToolingDiagnosticEdit` records containing the absolute current-source path, exact compiler origin and replacement text.

Only explicit `DiagnosticError.machine_fixes` metadata is projected. Tooling does not parse diagnostic messages, codes, notes or legacy fix prose. The projection requires every edit to match the exact snapshot digest and a valid half-open span; otherwise the entire fix is omitted. The first and currently only producer deletes the later of two imports with identical logical path and alias. Cross-file machine edits are not projected in this schema.

The compiler/tooling records remain protocol neutral. They are not `LSP.TextEdit`, `WorkspaceEdit`, `CodeAction` or `Command` values. The LSP layer leaves this schema unchanged and mechanically maps current-source machine fixes to edit-only LSP quick fixes after rechecking the current editor snapshot. The full audit and safety rationale are recorded in Compiler-owned diagnostic edit projection.

0.23.3 Generated RTL navigation audit

The generated-RTL audit adds no tooling navigation projection. The existing `Generated-SourceMap v1` is authoritative for hash-verified generated-line to source-origin attribution, but its bounded builder currently maps only one unique top-level output assignment. It has no generated artifact path or artifact-discovery contract, and no query currently validates a map against the current editor source digest. Recursive `BackendArtifact` bindings describe semantic/physical signals and hierarchy, not generated line locations.

Consequently `zlang.tooling` does not expose raw `BackendArtifact` or source-map objects and does not generate RTL on a tooling request. The exact capability and prerequisite are recorded in [Generated source maps](#).

`generated-navigation` bundle adds the protocol-neutral `zlang.generated_navigation_bundle.load_generated_navigation` boundary. It validates one explicit relocatable publication directory, exact generated/backend-manifest/source-map hashes, lineage, and complete producing source snapshot identities. The returned immutable record can classify current source text or digest as `match`, `stale`, or `unknown_source`. This is artifact infrastructure only: `zlang.tooling` exposes no generated-location query yet, and loading never invokes compilation.

0.23.4 Document symbols

`TOOLING_DOCUMENT_SYMBOL_SCHEMA` is currently 1. The `document_symbols(source_text)` function returns a tuple of immutable `ToolingSymbol` records. Each record contains a declaration name, a stable compiler-owned category, an authoritative `ToolingOrigin` where one is available, an authoritative selection range (currently the same origin when the parser does not retain a narrower name span), and recursively projected children where the parser exposes containment.

This is deliberately a narrow document-structure projection. It does not export AST nodes, typed IR, references, definitions, widths, protocols, or implementation plans. It uses the existing parser through the tooling module; the LSP must not parse or scan source text independently. If parsing fails for an incomplete editor buffer, `document_symbols` returns an empty tuple rather than guessing declarations. The existing `TOOLING_API_SCHEMA` remains 1 because this is an additive, separately versioned projection. Parser records that carry no stable declaration identity are omitted rather than assigned a synthetic symbol name.

0.23.5 Semantic hover

`TOOLING_HOVER_SCHEMA` is currently 1. The `hover_at(source, source_text, line, character)` function accepts a stable source path and a zero-based editor position, then returns either an immutable `ToolingHover` record or `None`. The record contains only narrow compiler-owned facts: selected name and kind, canonical type text, width, signedness, fixed-point type text, port direction, an available callable signature, and its authoritative `ToolingOrigin`.

The function invokes the semantic-only compiler snapshot path. It does not invoke optimization, implementation selection, RTL generation, synthesis, or formal execution, and it never returns AST or typed-IR objects. Positions with no semantic entity and malformed/incomplete source return `None`; workspace, resolver, and other environment failures raise `ToolingError` so callers cannot mistake an unavailable project for a valid empty hover.

0.23.6 Definitions

`TOOLING_DEFINITION_SCHEMA` is currently 1. The `definition_at(source, source_text, line, character)` function asks the semantic compiler snapshot for its resolved source-definition records and returns either an immutable `ToolingDefinition` or `None`. A definition contains only the resolved name/kind, the locked physical target path, and the authoritative target `ToolingOrigin`.

The projection currently covers compiler-resolved value/port references and ordinary or generic function calls, named types, enum members, registers, immutable locals, and module-instance targets when their declaration origin is retained. Function calls and declarations use parser-owned exact name spans. Imported project and `stdlib` definitions use the existing workspace lock and physical-input closure to map their logical source unit to the physical `.zhl` path. Unsupported declaration categories return `None` rather than being reconstructed from names or source text. Resolver and workspace failures remain `ToolingError`; the projection never exports AST, resolver, or typed-IR objects.

0.23.7 References

`TOOLING_REFERENCE_SCHEMA` is currently 1. The `references_at(source, source_text, line, character, include_declaration)` function reuses the compiler's occurrence-to-target resolution records and returns immutable `ToolingReference` records containing only a locked physical source path and authoritative occurrence origin. Results are grouped by the compiler-owned declaration origin, never by identifier spelling, and are sorted deterministically with exact duplicate locations removed.

When `include_declaration` is true, the authoritative target declaration is included. When false, only resolved usages are returned. Malformed or unresolved source returns an empty tuple; workspace and source-path failures remain `ToolingError`. For a saved declaration in a locked project, the tooling layer considers only project roots whose dependency closure can contain that declaration. A parser-only name prefilter bounds the expensive work, then each candidate root is independently checked and only its compiler-owned occurrence-to-target records may become results. Reported spelling is validated against the exact source span to reject malformed inherited provenance. The prefilter is not a reference search and cannot create a result. Unsaved declaration snapshots remain local so in-memory and disk identities are not mixed. The persistent normalized shard described below only replays these compiler-owned records; no spelling-based result fallback, resolver object, AST, or typed-IR object is exposed.

0.23.8 Rename

TOOLING_RENAME_SCHEMA is currently 1. The `rename_at(source, source_text, line, character, new_name)` function resolves the target through the compiler-owned definition/reference identity and returns an immutable tuple of `ToolingRenameEdit` records, or `None` when the category is not rename-safe. Each edit contains a locked local source path, an exact parser-owned identifier `ToolingOrigin`, and the replacement text.

New names are validated with the parser's ordinary binding-name rule. Before returning edits, the tooling layer applies them to the current root snapshot and performs a semantic-only recheck; invalid names, collisions, retargeted references, missing exact spans, and cross-file edits fail closed with `ToolingRenameError`. The initial supported categories are local ports, immutable values, functions, and function parameters. Registers, instances, types, protocol members, and cross-file rename are intentionally unsupported. The LSP converts these records to the standard `WorkspaceEdit.changes` form; the tooling API does not expose AST, IR, resolver objects, or LSP classes.

0.23.9 Completion

TOOLING_COMPLETION_SCHEMA is currently 1. The `completion_at(source, source_text, line, character)` function consumes compiler-recorded semantic scope snapshots and returns immutable `ToolingCompletion` records. The projection currently covers visible ports, immutable values, function parameters, ordinary/generic functions, and functions imported through the locked workspace. It does not reconstruct scopes, scan source text, add imports, or provide keyword/snippet completion.

Completion uses only the semantic check product. Malformed or incomplete source and positions outside an analyzed expression return an empty tuple; workspace and resolver failures remain `ToolingError`. The API does not expose the semantic scope, AST, resolver, or typed-IR objects themselves.

0.23.10 Signature help

TOOLING_SIGNATURE_HELP_SCHEMA is currently 1. The `signature_help_at(source, source_text, line, character)` function returns either an immutable `ToolingSignatureHelp` record or `None`. The record contains one compiler-resolved callable label, its parameter labels, the active parameter index, and the authoritative call origin.

The semantic analyzer records a call only after ordinary, generic, or locked imported function resolution succeeds. Argument origins are retained by the compiler and are used to select the active parameter; the tooling and LSP layers do not parse commas, parentheses, or identifier text. Nested calls are resolved by choosing the most-specific compiler call span. Malformed or incomplete source and positions outside a resolved call return `None`, while workspace/environment failures raise `ToolingError`. Signature help demands only the semantic snapshot and does not run optimization, implementation selection, RTL generation, synthesis, formal tools, or external processes.

The projection deliberately exposes no AST, typed IR, resolver state, generic substitution machinery, or implementation metadata. Trigger characters are not advertised by the initial LSP slice because requests are handled identically regardless of how they are triggered.

0.23.11 Semantic tokens

TOOLING_SEMANTIC_TOKEN_SCHEMA is currently 1. The `semantic_tokens(source, source_text)` function returns immutable `ToolingSemanticToken` records for exact compiler-owned declaration and resolved-occurrence spans in the current root document. Tooling categories are protocol independent: `function`, `parameter`, `property` for ports, and `variable` for immutable values. Declarations carry the declaration modifier; usages do not.

The projection consumes the same semantic-only snapshot and exact identifier origins used by definition, references, and rename. It rejects broad or multiline spans, filters imported declarations out of the root document, orders records deterministically, removes exact duplicates,

and fails closed on overlap. It does not classify source text, expose a lexer/AST/IR object, or assign numeric LSP legend indices. Malformed or semantically invalid source returns an empty tuple; project/environment failures remain ToolingError.

0.23.12 Reusable tooling and symbol sessions

ToolingSession is the bounded, request-driven cache used by the LSP for repeated tooling queries. It stores immutable SemanticCheckResult products for at most eight root-document contexts; standalone tooling calls remain unchanged when no session is supplied. A context key contains the resolved root path, the SHA-256 digest of the exact in-memory source text (plus any non-matching caller assertion), project/profile/top selection, the tooling API and compiler versions, and the requested AnalysisNeeds tracked on the cached entry.

The semantic cache reuses an entry only when its recorded needs are a superset of the request. A weaker request is a hit; a stronger request rechecks with the safe union of needs and replaces the entry. The compiler's PhysicalCompilationInputs.all_paths provide the authoritative locked root, dependency, manifest, lock, standard-library and external-source closure. Session-local file signatures are checked on each request and content hashes are recomputed only after a signature change, so changed dependencies cannot reuse a stale result without introducing directory polling or a workspace index. The session only memoizes the existing locked workspace projection; it does not create a new workspace-wide semantic index.

Definition and References have a second, normalized cache whose entries retain only deduplicated DefinitionTarget/DefinitionResolution origins and stable declaration identities. Each loaded shard builds a source-line interval index for cursor lookup and a declaration-to-occurrences index for References. It does not retain source text, AST, typed IR or generated artifacts. The in-memory limit is 64 shards or 64 MiB and remains useful after the eight-entry semantic LRU evicts a root.

Because a shard is published only after a successful definition-aware compiler analysis, an exact content/recipe hit may also serve semantic tokens and prove that the identical root snapshot has no diagnostics. The LSP can reuse a parent root shard after module-definition navigation only for the exact selected module, logical source unit and source digest recorded by the compiler. It does not use this path for arbitrary manually opened files.

For saved locked-project roots, the same normalized payload is published atomically below \$XDG_CACHE_HOME/zlang-hdl/lsp/symbol-v1/ (or ~/.cache/zlang-hdl/lsp/symbol-v1/). A new ToolingSession, including one in a restarted LSP process, may reuse it only after validating the schema, compiler/capability identity, root/profile/top recipe, manifest and lock, and the exact content hashes of its logical project/dependency/stdlib units. Physical paths are reconstructed through the current resolver and never stored in JSON. Unsaved and standalone documents remain memory-only. Corrupt, oversized or symlink shards are discarded or ignored and the compiler path is used normally.

ZLANG_LSP_SYMBOL_CACHE selects persistent (default), memory, or off. TTL is never validity evidence: access time is used only for daily-throttled usage updates and 30-day/count/size garbage collection (512 shards/256 MiB). Timestamp-only changes preserve a hit when bytes match, while a changed used dependency, manifest, lock, schema or compiler identity misses. An unrelated project file does not participate in the shard's physical input set. didChange and replacement didOpen explicitly invalidate the affected in-memory root. didClose drops the editor buffer but retains bounded content-addressed semantic and symbol entries; all later reuse still validates the current bytes and environment. No background work, source-text/regex result fallback, incremental compiler, optimizer, backend, synthesis or formal phase is involved.

0.24 Language Server Protocol and VS Code

zlang-lsp is the single Community ZLang HDL language server. Its protocol surface provides deterministic diagnostics, document symbols, semantic hover, compiler-resolved definition locations, semantic references, safe semantic rename, deterministic semantic completion, and

compiler-resolved signature help, full-document semantic tokens, and compiler-owned diagnostic quick fixes. It keeps open document text in memory and queries the compiler-owned tooling projections after full-document opens and changes.

Start it as a standard LSP process:

```
.venv/bin/zlang-lsp
```

The process reads and writes standard Content-Length framed JSON-RPC messages. It supports local `file://` URIs for existing `.zhl` files. The server does not write editor buffers to temporary source files; project-backed snapshots must therefore remain compatible with the existing compiler/tooling workspace identity rules. Unsupported remote, virtual, and non-local document URIs are reported explicitly.

The project has no existing JSON-RPC/LSP dependency. This slice therefore uses the Python standard library for the small Content-Length framing and dispatch surface instead of adding a general RPC framework or a large LSP dependency.

0.24.1 Supported now

- `initialize / initialized`;
- `shutdown / exit`;
- `textDocument/didOpen`;
- `textDocument/didChange` using full-text synchronization;
- `textDocument/didClose`;
- `textDocument/publishDiagnostics`;
- `textDocument/documentSymbol` for an open document;
- `textDocument/hover` for an open document;
- `textDocument/definition` for an open document;
- `textDocument/references` for an open document;
- `textDocument/rename` for the conservative rename-safe subset of an open document.
- `textDocument/completion` for compiler-visible expression-scope candidates.
- `textDocument/signatureHelp` for one compiler-resolved callable at the requested position.
- `textDocument/semanticTokens/full` for exact compiler-classified identifiers.
- `textDocument/codeAction` for compiler-owned machine-applicable quick fixes.

Diagnostics use the `Community zlang.tooling.check_snapshot()` API, which uses the normal parser, resolver, and semantic checker. They keep the compiler code, message, source origin, and one-based-to-zero-based range conversion. Document symbols use the narrow parser-owned `zlang.tooling.document_symbols()` projection over the current unsaved editor text. Hover uses the narrow semantic `zlang.tooling.hover_at()` projection over the same current text and source path. The LSP does not contain a second parser, type checker, workspace model, backend, formal runner, or optimizer.

Editor observations are demand-driven through one compiler-owned `AnalysisNeeds` mask. Definition, references, rename, and semantic-token requests collect only shared definition records; completion additionally requests scope candidates, and signature help requests resolved-call records. A definition request therefore does not build completion scopes or callable detail strings, while semantic checking and the resulting IR remain unchanged.

Document symbols are structural declarations, not a semantic database. Their names, categories, containment, and available source spans come from the compiler's parser representation. Incomplete or malformed text returns an empty symbol list while diagnostics continue to report the parse error; there is no regex or source-text fallback. A declaration whose AST node has no dedicated source origin uses the enclosing authoritative declaration span.

Hover reports only compiler-owned facts that are already available from the semantic IR: the selected name/kind, canonical type, width, signedness, fixed-point representation, and (for ports) direction. Function declarations may include their compiler-owned signature. It does not run optimization, implementation selection, RTL generation, synthesis, or formal tools. A malformed/incomplete buffer or a position without a semantic entity returns null; workspace/environment failures remain explicit protocol errors.

Definitions use `zlang.tooling.definition_at()` and the compiler's actual name/import resolution. The server does not search source text, rebuild scopes, or choose same-named declarations. Project imports are mapped through the locked workspace to the target source URI; unresolved or unsupported categories return `null`.

For a file declaring several modules, Definition and References share one bounded navigation-context selector. A missing default-top occurrence is retried under the module preceding the cursor according to parser-owned module declaration spans. Only that selected module is then semantically analyzed; the compiler's exact occurrence-to-declaration record still decides whether F12 returns a location. A bounded session-local, exact-text selector avoids rechecking an unrelated generic last module on repeated F12; no source AST or physical path is added to persistent symbol shards.

Protocol connection endpoints retain exact parser-owned name spans. Each name is resolved by semantic elaboration, so a connection such as `command -> packet_mapper.command` can navigate independently to the parent port declaration, the instance declaration, and the selected child port. The cache stores only those compiler-produced relations.

VS Code may issue F12 at the exclusive right edge of its selected identifier. Tooling performs the exact half-open-span lookup first, then retries the immediately preceding code point only when the cursor is at an identifier boundary. It does not walk across whitespace or punctuation. Declaration paths outside the root project, including `stdlib` targets, are returned only when they are members of the compiler-owned locked physical input closure.

Definition coverage includes compiler-resolved module instance targets, named user types (including nested generic components, structs and aliases), nominal enum types, enum members, and local registers. Targets retain their locked source identity, digest, and parser-owned declaration span, so a dependency file need not be open in the editor. Builtin constructors such as `rv` and `bits` have no fabricated source definition. Source-local target/resource declarations also retain exact lexer-token name spans: `provides ResourceName` and `require_resource ResourceName` navigate to one unambiguous resource `ResourceName` declaration and participate in semantic References. Unknown or duplicate source-local names return no location. This does not yet implement general cross-file target-catalog navigation; physical target legality remains with the separate target planner. The server converts VS Code's incoming UTF-16 character offsets to compiler code-point columns before semantic span containment; outbound locations use the inverse conversion.

The VS Code client awaits complete `LanguageClient.start()` registration in its extension activation promise. This guarantees that an immediate first F12 request is not dispatched before the server's definition provider exists; it does not add any extension-side symbol lookup or project semantics.

Generic declarations are semantically checked for their concrete specializations. When a generic-only library file is opened directly, the compiler's dedicated `ZL-GENERIC-SPECIALIZATION-REQUIRED` condition is not published as an editor error. A parameter constraint referencing a declared value parameter without a default is likewise deferred only while directly viewing its unspecialized template; concrete false constraints and unrelated runtime references remain editor errors. The production compiler still rejects an unspecialized top, and parse/concrete-specialization errors remain ordinary diagnostics.

A saved project child opened directly is checked using the semantic analyzer's existing child-boundary mode. This avoids treating an enum-bearing internal port as an illegal public top ABI merely because its parent is not the active editor document. The production compiler's default top-level boundary remains fail-closed; all other child semantics and concrete imported types are checked.

References use `zlang.tooling.references_at()` and the same compiler-owned occurrence-to-target relation. Results are grouped by resolved declaration identity, not by spelling, and may include the declaration when the LSP `includeDeclaration` flag is true. For a saved locked-project snapshot, the tooling layer builds an on-demand bounded view of dependency-compatible project roots and accepts only compiler-resolved occurrences with an exact source span. The project sweep reloads the current manifest/lock and reuses each exact root text for parser filtering and semantic checking. It verifies disk bytes before publication; a concurrent

edit or more than 128 eligible roots/top pairs reports an error instead of a stale or silently truncated result. A declaration above several modules in one source also checks bounded sibling tops that may use it; this includes encoded-enum uses inside a non-default module. A parser prefilter limits semantic checks but never produces a reference result. Qualified enum owners and members retain separate identifier spans, and incoming LSP UTF-16 cursor columns are converted before compiler lookup. The normalized symbol cache described below reuses compiler-produced shards; it does not create results. There is no text/regular-expression fallback, and an unsaved declaration snapshot is never mixed with disk roots.

Rename uses `zlang.tooling.rename_at()` and the same compiler-owned identity and occurrence records. It edits only exact parser-owned identifier spans, always including the declaration, and rechecks the edited in-memory root source with the semantic checker to reject collisions or retargeted references. The first slice supports local ports, immutable values, functions, and function parameters. Cross-file edits and declarations without exact editable spans are rejected; there is no textual or same-spelling fallback.

Completion uses `zlang.tooling.completion_at()` and semantic scope snapshots recorded by the compiler while checking the current source. It offers only visible ports, immutable values, parameters, ordinary/generic functions, and locked imported functions. Candidates are deterministic, insert the plain identifier, and carry optional type/signature detail. The server does not reconstruct scopes, scan source text, synthesize imports, or provide keyword or snippet completion. Positions outside a compiler-analyzed expression and malformed/incomplete buffers return an empty list.

Signature help uses `zlang.tooling.signature_help_at()` and call records captured while the compiler resolves ordinary, generic, and locked imported function calls. The callable label, parameter labels, return type, call span, and argument spans are compiler-owned. The server selects the most-specific resolved call containing the cursor and determines activeParameter from those spans; it never counts commas or parses call text itself. A cursor in malformed/incomplete source, or outside a resolved call, returns `null`. No trigger characters are advertised until parser behavior makes a trigger contract useful.

Semantic tokens use `zlang.tooling.semantic_tokens()` and only the exact identifier spans already retained by compiler definition/reference records. The initial categories are functions, parameters, ports, and immutable values; declarations carry the standard declaration modifier and resolved usages do not. The server publishes a fixed standard-token legend, sorts tokens by source position, converts compiler code-point columns to the default LSP UTF-16 code units, and emits standard relative full-document encoding. It does not lex, scan, classify keywords, infer token roles from spelling, or expose hardware resource information. Malformed source produces an empty token data array.

Code actions recheck the exact current in-memory source through `zlang.tooling.check_snapshot()` and map only `ToolingDiagnostic.machine_fixes`. The current action is the compiler-owned deletion of a later completely identical duplicate import. Actions are quickfix edit-only `CodeAction` values, filtered by the request range, `context.diagnostics`, and `context.only`; stale diagnostics and fixes are not returned. Compiler-native spans are converted to LSP UTF-16 positions without changing replacement text. Prose-only diagnostic suggestions never become executable actions.

The server owns one bounded `zlang.tooling.ToolingSession` for the lifetime of its open-document manager. Its heavy semantic LRU retains at most eight typed snapshots. Definition and References additionally use a normalized symbol-only cache: up to 64 shards/64 MiB in memory and, for exact saved project snapshots, up to 512 shards/256 MiB on disk. A shard contains only deduplicated declaration and occurrence origins, stable declaration IDs and content identities; loading it builds line-interval and declaration-to-occurrences indexes. A validated successful shard may also supply semantic-token records and prove that diagnostics were already checked for the identical root snapshot. It contains no source body, AST, typed IR, generated artifact or absolute physical path.

Persistent shards live below `$XDG_CACHE_HOME/zlang-hdl/lsp/symbol-v1/`, falling back to `~/.cache/zlang-hdl/lsp/symbol-v1/`. Set `ZLANG_LSP_SYMBOL_CACHE=memory` to disable disk writes, or `off` to use only the eight-entry semantic LRU; persistent is the default. Publication

uses a private temporary file and atomic rename. Cache corruption, unsafe symlinks and read-only filesystems fall back to ordinary semantic analysis rather than breaking navigation.

Correctness never depends on age. Reuse requires the exact compiler/tooling schema and version, root text digest, selected profile/top, nearest project manifest and lock identities, and the content digests of the transitive project and stdlib sources used by the symbol records. A timestamp-only change is accepted after hashing; an unrelated project-source edit is irrelevant. `didChange` and a replacement `didOpen` immediately invalidate the old in-memory root snapshot. `didClose` removes the editor buffer but retains its bounded content-addressed LRU entries: reopening an unchanged VS Code preview revalidates source/dependency metadata and reuses them, while changed bytes or dependencies miss safely. Unsaved and standalone buffers are memory-only. Disk access time is updated at most daily; entries older than 30 days and then least-recently-used entries beyond the count/byte limits are garbage-collected. The session performs no background refresh, project-global source scan, incremental compilation, backend or formal work.

For module-definition navigation, VS Code normally opens the destination file and immediately requests diagnostics and semantic tokens. The server carries the selected module name across that one navigation. It may reuse the parent shard for the destination only when compiler records declare that exact module in the exact logical source unit with the current on-disk digest. This avoids a second project analysis without turning an arbitrary parent shard into proof for a manually opened file. A changed destination, an unsaved buffer or a shard that did not analyze the selected module falls back to normal semantic analysis.

The generated-RTL provenance audit added no LSP method or capability. Existing source maps are hash-bound and exact for their few mapped generated lines, but they do not yet provide complete artifact discovery, current-editor-source staleness validation, or broad RTL coverage. The LSP does not load raw backend manifests, infer mappings from generated names, or generate RTL during navigation. See [Generated source maps](#).

generated-navigation bundle adds a protocol-neutral [validated generated-navigation bundle](#) for explicit published artifact discovery, integrity, lineage, and source-snapshot freshness. No LSP method consumes the bundle yet, and advertised server capabilities are unchanged.

0.24.2 Not implemented

`codeAction/resolve`, `fix-all/source/refactor` actions, semantic-token `range/delta` requests, workspace symbols, generated-RTL navigation, formal/synthesis commands, AI-assisted workflows, CUDA, and `zinfer` are outside the current public scope.

0.25 Structured diagnostics

Every compiler error retains its historical human-readable message and may also carry a stable diagnostic code, one primary `SourceOrigin`, notes, and suggested fixes. A complete origin contains the logical source unit, the source SHA-256, the half-open source span, and the construct being diagnosed. Compiler-shipped declarations use logical units such as `std.math.complex`; ordinary CLI inputs use the path supplied to `zlang`.

Text remains the default and is compatible with existing scripts:

```
zlang design.zhl --check
```

The `fixes` values in the version-1 diagnostic are human-readable suggestions, not source edits. Machine-applicable edits have a separate compiler-owned metadata and tooling projection described in `Compiler-owned diagnostic edit projection`; consumers must never derive edits from these strings.

Machine consumers select one deterministic JSON object:

```
zlang design.zhl --check --diagnostic-format json
```

The version-1 object has `schema`, `severity`, `code`, `message`, `primary`, `notes`, and `fixes`. Older exception-string users continue to receive the same `str(error)`. Categories initially carrying

specific codes include parsing, imports, width assignment, timing alignment, domain crossing, protocol ownership/type, top selection, I/O, and backend binding failures. Unmigrated errors use a stable generic category rather than inventing meaning from text.

Backend output can additionally publish a hash-bound [generated source map](#). External-tool attribution is accepted only when the generated text hash matches the sidecar and exactly one entry covers the reported line. Otherwise the original Verilator/Yosys/vendor diagnostic is left unchanged.

0.26 Generated source maps

ZLang backends can publish a deterministic JSON sidecar alongside an immutable BackendArtifact. The sidecar is backend-independent: each entry connects an inclusive generated line range and semantic identity to the complete typed SourceOrigin (source_unit, digest, span, and construct). It also records the backend, module, selected-IR identity, and generated artifact SHA-256, so a map cannot silently be applied to different generated text.

The schema is version 1 and is implemented by `zlang.backend.source_map.GeneratedSourceMap`. Direct SystemVerilog offers `emit_artifact_with_source_map`; this returns the unchanged production artifact plus its sidecar model. `write_sidecar` writes canonical, sorted JSON. The CLI exposes the same model for one explicit production output:

```
zlang design.zhl --systemverilog Design.sv \  
  --source-map Design.sv.zmap.json
```

The sidecar artifact hash must match the generated file before a consumer uses any line attribution.

For published consumers, the versioned [validated generated-navigation bundle](#) now provides the missing explicit file/source-snapshot integrity boundary. It does not expand this map's bounded line coverage and does not add an LSP navigation method.

The external-tool helper applies the same rule to Verilator messages: it adds a ZLang origin: line only for one exact mapped generated line after hash validation. Changed files, malformed locations, ambiguous entries, and unmapped helper/state-machine lines retain the original tool diagnostic unchanged.

0.26.1 Exactness boundary

The first bounded implementation maps only a simple top-level output assignment when all of the following are true:

- the typed output expression retains a SourceOrigin;
- the BackendArtifact publishes the matching semantic output binding;
- the emitter's generated assignment statement is uniquely identifiable; and
- the generated text hashes to the artifact identity.

Direct SystemVerilog maps a unique assign `<published-token> = ... statement`. Ambiguous, sequential, multi-output, hierarchical, protocol, and backend-generated helper lines remain deliberately unmapped. No mapping is inferred from similar source and RTL names. Later emitter refactoring may attach exact origins while fragments are constructed; until then, absence of an entry means “unknown,” not “same as the nearest mapped line.”

0.26.2 Generated-RTL navigation audit

The Community LSP source-map audit does not add an editor navigation API. The current source-map evidence is safe for exact diagnostic attribution, but it is not yet complete enough to be presented as general bidirectional generated-RTL navigation.

The existing ownership and records are:

- `GeneratedLineRange` is a one-based inclusive generated **line** range. It contains no generated columns.

- `GeneratedSourceMapEntry` joins that range to one semantic identity and one full `SourceOrigin`. The source origin contains a one-based half-open source span, logical source unit, construct label, and optional source SHA-256.
- `GeneratedSourceMap` identifies one backend/module/selected-IR/artifact-hash tuple. Schema version 1 sorts entries canonically and preserves overlapping proven entries; `entries_for_line()` returns every entry covering a line.
- `BackendArtifact` owns the emitted text, its SHA-256, selected-IR identity, signal bindings, recursive component/instance/binding manifests, companion files, timing, dependency, signature, physical-domain, and implementation metadata. Those bindings are not generated line locations.

0.26.2.1 Proven granularity

Emitted category

One unique direct-SystemVerilog top-level output assignment in a module with exactly one assignment and no other assignments in the module.
 Pipeline result's final unique output assignment when it meets that same restriction
 Module and port declarations
 Multiple output assignments
 State/register declarations and sequential blocks
 Functions/helpers and generated temporary signals
 Protocol lowering and compiler-generated inline aggregate boundary bridges
 Child modules, instances, and recursive hierarchy
 Formal/backend scaffolding and helper code

The current builder has no construct-level or coarse navigation entries: an entry is an exact generated statement line, otherwise it is omitted. Source spans may identify an expression rather than an identifier token, and must not be described as exact identifier navigation.

The recursive manifest schemas have optional `source_origin` fields, but the current direct-SystemVerilog hierarchy publication does not populate them for ordinary component instances or recursive signal bindings. Even when populated, their physical signal paths would still not prove generated text line ranges.

0.26.2.2 Directional capability

Generated-to-source lookup is bounded but authoritative after a consumer has already obtained the matching map and generated text: verify the generated text SHA-256 against `artifact_hash`, call `entries_for_line()`, and preserve all returned origins. Zero entries means unmapped. Multiple entries are an explicit ambiguity; existing external-diagnostic attribution fails closed unless they reduce to one complete semantic origin. `source_unit` and digest participate in that decision; equal rendered spans from distinct source snapshots are not merged.

Source-to-generated lookup has no supported query API. A consumer can observe source origins in entries, but the schema has no source index, physical source path, generated artifact path, or artifact-discovery contract. One source construct may eventually map to multiple generated ranges, so a future API must preserve a collection rather than select a first match.

0.26.2.3 Artifact identity and staleness

The generated side is strongly bound: `artifact_hash` is the SHA-256 of the exact generated text, and the map also repeats backend, module, and selected-IR identity. A changed `.sv` file is rejected by existing consumers.

Each mapped `SourceOrigin` normally carries the digest of the source snapshot that produced it, so a future query can reject changed editor text for that entry. The generated-navigation bundle loader now validates caller-supplied current source text or digest against complete bundle-level snapshots, including the root when a map has zero entries. There is still no source-to-generated location query or LSP method.

The sidecar itself contains no physical .sv path. The CLI writes generated RTL and a sidecar only when explicitly requested; BackendArtifact and GeneratedSourceMap can otherwise exist only in memory. A whole-build manifest can bind published products by logical path and content hash. The separate generated-navigation bundle now gives future tooling one explicit relocatable publication root and a fail-closed loader; navigation must still never generate RTL implicitly.

The serialized BackendArtifact manifest intentionally does not embed the RTL text: restoration retains the hash and binding metadata with an empty text field. A consumer must therefore obtain and hash the separately published RTL file. BackendBuildRecord can identify the RTL and source-map publications by content hash and relocatable logical path inside a validated whole-build file map, but no tooling API currently owns that physical-path resolution.

Generated coordinates make no character-encoding promise because version 1 contains no generated columns or lengths. Source coordinates remain compiler native one-based code-point spans. Artifact hashes are computed from the in-memory generated text encoded as UTF-8 by Python's default `str.encode()`; future LSP UTF-16 conversion remains a protocol-layer concern.

0.26.2.4 Published provenance prerequisite

The versioned, hash-validated [generated-navigation bundle](#) now binds a relocatable generated file, this exact sidecar, the canonical backend manifest, and complete source snapshot identities, including the root when this map has zero entries. A later reviewed slice may project protocol-neutral source to generated locations over a validated loaded bundle. Generated line coverage remains independent and can be expanded only at emitter-owned fragment construction points; names, comments, or proximity are never substitutes for provenance.

0.27 Generated navigation bundles

ZLang can publish a small, relocatable Community artifact bundle that binds one already-generated direct-SystemVerilog file to its exact generated source map, backend manifest, and producing source snapshots. The bundle is an integrity and provenance boundary for future tooling. **It does not provide an LSP navigation method.**

Publish it during the normal compiler invocation:

```
zlang design.zhl --top Design \  
  --systemverilog build/Design.sv \  
  --source-map build/Design.source-map.json \  
  --build-manifest build/Design.build.json \  
  --generated-navigation-bundle build/Design.navigation
```

The source-map and whole-build outputs remain independently optional. The bundle always contains its own exact generated file, generated source map, and serialized BackendArtifact; it never invokes a second backend render.

0.27.1 Why this is a separate v1 contract

Before this contract, BackendArtifact, BackendBuildRecord, and WholeBuildManifest already carried backend/module/selected-IR identities, artifact hashes, dependency identities, and relocatable logical product paths. GeneratedSourceMap carried the same artifact lineage and exact mapped source origins. Those records did not provide a single persisted path from which a consumer could locate the arbitrarily placed physical RTL and sidecar, and the whole-build root publication did not retain the compiler logical source unit.

Changing the established whole-build v1 schema would disrupt unrelated build consumers. zlang-generated-navigation-bundle-v1 is therefore a narrow publication contract. It reuses the canonical serialized BackendArtifact as the lineage owner instead of duplicating its hierarchy, implementation, timing, module-signature, and dependency structures.

0.27.2 Layout and schema

All persisted paths are normalized relative paths below the bundle root:

```
manifest.json
generated/design.sv
generated/source-map.json
manifest/backend-artifact.json
```

`manifest.json` has schema `zlang-generated-navigation-bundle-v1` and schema version 1. It contains:

- `bundle_identity`: SHA-256 of the canonical identity payload;
- `generated_artifact`: a `PublishedFile` logical path, SHA-256, kind, and size;
- `source_map`: the same record for canonical `GeneratedSourceMap` JSON;
- `backend_manifest`: the same record for canonical `BackendArtifact` JSON;
- `sources`: an ordered list of `{role, source_unit, digest}` records;
- `schema` and `schema_version`.

Exactly one source has role `root`. Every compiler-owned dependency from the backend artifact's locked dependency closure and resolved library dependency set is recorded with role `dependency`. Absolute checkout/build paths are not serialized. Package/revision identities remain in the hashed backend manifest; source snapshot matching uses the exact logical source unit plus SHA-256.

The root record is mandatory even when `GeneratedSourceMap.entries` is empty. No fake source-map entry is created. Consequently an empty map can still report the root source as matching or stale.

0.27.3 Publication and validation

`publish_generated_navigation_bundle()` accepts an already-emitted `BackendArtifact`, its `GeneratedSourceMap`, and the already-written generated file. It verifies the physical generated bytes against `artifact_hash`, checks `backend/module/selected-IR/map` lineage, derives source snapshots from existing compiler dependency metadata, and publishes the four relative files with the existing no-follow atomic publication utility.

`load_generated_navigation_bundle(path)` starts from one explicit bundle directory. It does not scan for `.sv` or JSON files and does not infer filenames from a module. Loading validates:

- bundle schema and canonical identity;
- safe relative paths and no-follow containment;
- presence, regular-file status, exact sizes, and SHA-256 of all child files;
- canonical backend-manifest and source-map serialization;
- generated bytes against the backend artifact hash;
- direct-SystemVerilog backend, module, selected-IR, and source-map lineage;
- exact source snapshot agreement with backend dependency provenance;
- complete `source_unit` and `digest` identity for every mapped source origin.

Any mismatch is an error. Missing files, stale/tampered contents, sidecars from another artifact, unsupported schemas, path traversal, and symlinked bundle components fail closed. Loading performs only metadata parsing, file reads, and SHA-256 checks; it never parses ZLang, compiles, emits RTL, runs formal tools, or starts an external process.

0.27.4 Source freshness

The immutable loaded record provides two protocol-neutral comparisons:

- `source_status(source_unit, current_text)` hashes current UTF-8 text;
- `source_digest_status(source_unit, current_digest)` compares a supplied SHA-256 directly.

Both return `exactly match`, `stale`, or `unknown_source`. Unknown sources are never treated as matching. Bundle facts are validated at load time; current editor text is checked separately because it can change after loading.

0.27.5 Relocatability and limitations

The complete directory can be moved or copied and loaded at its new location. No original absolute path is required. Current bundles are direct-SystemVerilog only and do not embed producing source contents. They validate caller-supplied source text/digests but do not locate workspaces or manage unsaved overlays.

Source-map coverage remains the bounded line-only coverage documented in [Generated source maps](#). generated-navigation bundle adds no generated columns, recursive line mappings, virtual documents, artifact index, implicit compilation, or source-to-generated query. **There is no LSP generated-RTL navigation yet.**

0.28 Whole-build manifests and evidence

ZLang can describe one reproducible build as a deterministic, versioned record. The whole-build manifest joins the compiler stages, selected implementation policy, backend products, companion files, actual tool executions, generated reports, and typed evidence without making any of those records the source of language semantics.

The first schema is `zlang-whole-build-manifest-v1`. It is complementary to, not a replacement for, the per-backend `BackendArtifact` manifest.

0.28.1 Compiler and implementation identities

A build records two distinct canonical compiler identities:

- `high-level:<sha256>` identifies the fully typed, backend-independent high-level canonical IR;
- `selected:<sha256>` identifies the selected canonical architecture IR.

The identities use the versioned canonical-identity schema and exclude source spans and other attribution-only metadata. An optional canonical content hash may accompany either reference. The high-level and selected identities are not backend artifacts, RTL hashes, or synthesis-plan identities.

The production direct-SystemVerilog backend is planned from the selected-IR identity. Its record keeps these identities separate:

- the normalized backend plan identity;
- the backend `build_identity`;
- the exact emitted artifact hash and `BackendArtifact` version;
- an optional physical implementation-graph identity;
- an optional source-map hash.

This distinction prevents a physical direct-SystemVerilog resource plan from being mistaken for the selected semantic design. Backend states are explicit: `selected`, `generic_fallback`, `unsupported`, `failed`, or `not_requested`. A selected or fallback build must publish an artifact, its manifest version, and at least one content-addressed output. Unsupported, failed, and unrequested plans cannot silently publish successful products.

0.28.2 Published files and companions

The manifest records the exact compiled root-source bytes, the complete locked project and compiler-shipped `std.*` dependency closure, backend outputs, and backend companion bundles as `PublishedFile` values. Every value contains:

- a normalized relative POSIX path;
- a SHA-256 content hash;

- a file kind;
- the exact byte size for build products;
- optional ZLang source attribution.

Absolute paths, . . . , non-normal paths, and duplicate publication paths are rejected. Directory-root validation additionally rejects symlink escapes. The CLI's explicit logical-path-to-physical-Path map checks every build product's type, size, and content hash before publishing the manifest. Locked dependency records are the exception: the project workspace has already validated their content hashes before semantic analysis, so their physical cache/check-out paths are intentionally absent from the public manifest validation map.

Before any product is written, the CLI also checks a private, non-semantic map of every physical compiler input: the root snapshot, project manifest, lock, root and dependency modules, dependency manifests, and every consulted stdlib candidate. Explicit file sinks, generated companions, and compiler-owned output or cache directories may not alias or contain any of those inputs. File sinks may not alias one another, and owned directories may not overlap. The sole compatibility exception is `--systemverilog` plus `--experimental-systemverilog` naming the same file, because both flags request the same bytes. Physical paths protect the workspace from overwrite; they never enter semantic, artifact, cache, or whole-build identity.

Companions remain associated with the backend product that needs them. For example, an initialized ROM image is not hidden inside the RTL identity: the image is a separate content-addressed companion validated beside direct-SV `$readmemb` output.

The CLI acquires the root source once as raw UTF-8 bytes. Semantic compilation and manifest hashing use that same snapshot; CRLF is preserved, and a physical source change before final publication rejects the manifest. Generated RTL and ROM companions are published through one relative-path publisher: every directory and leaf is opened without following symlinks, the payload is fsynced in a same-directory exclusive temporary, renamed atomically, and revalidated by content. Symlinked or non-regular destinations fail without writing through them. Every published companion retains one semantic identity and is hash-validated independently.

Generated source maps and rendered reports are content-validated in the same way. A report's stable semantic identity is derived from its report ID, kind, and ordered evidence IDs. Its rendering format, content hash, and optional publication path remain serialized and tamper-checked, but intentionally do not alter the whole-build identity. A report cannot refer to unknown evidence, and a published report path cannot carry different bytes.

0.28.3 Exact evidence meanings

Evidence is adapted only from typed compiler/formal result objects. Log strings and ad-hoc result dictionaries are not evidence inputs. The stable statuses mean:

Status	Exact meaning
<code>typed_legal</code>	Semantic analysis produced a well-typed module. This is not a timing or proof result.
<code>timing_validated</code>	Every public scalar output was checked against the exact typed module timing constraints.
<code>bounded_pass</code>	BMC found no counterexample through the recorded positive depth. It requires model checking.
<code>proven</code>	An unbounded prove execution succeeded. Only this status denotes an unbounded proof.
<code>failed</code>	The executed check found a failure; typed counterexample attribution may be attached.
<code>unknown</code>	Execution completed without a pass, proof, or counterexample classification.
<code>skipped</code>	The route was explicitly unavailable or inapplicable. It is not success.
<code>not_run</code>	No proof execution occurred. It is not success.

`bounded_pass` must include BMC mode and depth. `proven` must include prove mode. Semantic and timing validation cannot carry proof mode/depth. An unexecuted record is rejected if its claim says that something was proved.

The typed adapters preserve the applicable property ID, candidate identity, backend and artifact hash, reference hash, engine, solver, relation, proof route, mode, and depth:

Positive formal-aware selection evidence requires a connected backend and artifact. The report layer does not infer execution from cache metadata, registered rewrite rules, generated properties, an SBY file, or a solver executable being installed.

0.28.4 Harness generation is not proof execution

`--formal-harness` and `--formal-sby` generate formal inputs. They do not run a solver and therefore cannot produce `bounded_pass` or `proven`. When no typed execution result exists, the corresponding property is reported as `not_run` and may explain why execution was not performed, but it must not imply success. Artifact generation itself belongs in the backend/publication records, not in a second evidence status.

The first-class verification UX adds an immutable bundle boundary rather than changing that rule. `--verification-bundle` publishes hash-validated structured verification IR, implementation/source-map inputs, and separate safety/cover jobs. Exact ROM images are immutable companion inputs to every job that uses them. `zlang-verify` or `zlang --verify` creates a run report only after real execution. Solver, engine, depth, timeout, logs, tool versions, witnesses, and counterexamples are run data and are not folded into the bundle's source identity. A bounded cover miss is `bounded_unreached`, never proof of unreachability.

Bundle schema v4 and verification-IR snapshot v3 describe the immutable input. Raw run-report schema v7 separately records `run_identity`, exact execution configuration, retained bounded-stage results, tool versions, and a work directory for each safety/cover job. Generated SBY configuration, `stdout/stderr`, timeout diagnostics, and VCDs live outside the bundle below `--work-dir/--verification-work-dir`. A retained VCD may be decoded through the immutable binding table into semantic signal/value pairs; paths and raw logs remain outside `run_identity`.

A joint `--verify` plus non-off formal-policy run publishes `zlang-compiler-verification-report-v1`. That wrapper links the raw v7 report to the exact compiler execution plan and separately typed selected-candidate semantic-reference equivalence reports. Candidate reports retain deterministic per-route work roots and the discovered tool snapshot when execution needed tool discovery; exact in-session formal-aware selection reuse also carries its recorded work root. Physical paths remain operational metadata outside every semantic, run, evidence, and cache identity. Persistent formal-aware selection cache payloads omit them rather than claiming that an old workspace is still available.

Each safety/cover job is tied to one exact clock/reset pair. Multiple supported synchronous domains may therefore appear as independent jobs in one bundle; an unsupported domain skips only goals that name it. This is not a cross-domain equivalence or temporal proof relation.

A requested prove run is staged behind BMC. Proof starts only when every safety job is `bounded_pass`. Covers run once during BMC and are not rerun; an unrelated cover result does not block safety proof, while an unwitnessed feasibility cover first makes its dependent safety result vacuous/unknown and therefore blocks proof. The merged report retains both the bounded cover evidence and any proved safety results. This sequencing is part of execution, not bundle identity.

A safety counterexample or an executed joint semantic-reference equivalence counterexample is a verification failure. Missing/unknown/vacuous safety verification/source evidence or an unsatisfied requested proof is incomplete. A bounded cover miss is non-failing, and unavailable advisory candidate evidence neither changes formal-aware selection eligibility nor makes an otherwise complete joint run incomplete.

Likewise, merely detecting Verilator, Yosys, SymbiYosys, or Z3 does not create a tool-execution record. A tool record represents an actual normalized invocation and includes its role, exact reported version, path-free command shape, result status and exit code, logical outputs, and proof mode/depth when applicable. Tool output paths must resolve to files already published by the build.

0.28.5 Counterexample and source attribution

Source origins remain attribution, not semantics: they include the logical source unit, source digest, span, and construct, survive manifest JSON round-trips, and are excluded from deterministic evidence and build identities. Moving an unchanged locked project therefore does not change its build identity.

0.28.6 CLI publication

The intended publication forms are:

```
zlang design.zhl --systemverilog build/design.sv \  
  --evidence-report build/evidence.json \  
  --evidence-format json \  
  --build-manifest build/zlang-build.json
```

--evidence-format text|json selects deterministic human-readable or JSON evidence. --evidence-report publishes that report. --build-manifest publishes the whole-build join after requested outputs have been written and their hashes validated. The manifest is fsynced to a same-directory temporary, renamed atomically, its physical publications are validated again, and the parent directory is fsynced; a detected intervening output mutation removes the manifest. A whole-build manifest requires a real backend product; report-only or check-only commands do not fabricate a successful build.

The build identity includes locked source/dependency hashes, both canonical IR identities, normalized implementation request/policy and optional profile, independent backend records, actual tool executions, reports, evidence, and stable metadata. Ordering is canonical. Host paths, timestamps, wall time, cache hit order, Python insertion order, and other volatile run-time state are not part of it.

0.28.7 Current limitations

These boundaries preserve the existing formal-infrastructure freeze while making build and evidence claims reproducible, attributable, and mechanically auditable.

0.29 Storage-owning instance arrays

This bounded composition slice extends one-dimensional compile-time instance arrays to same-domain scalar-wire children that own one storage resource. It does not add source syntax: the existing `inst lane[N]`, indexed bindings, and indexed child-output references elaborate into the existing typed hierarchy.

0.29.1 Supported boundary

A child specialization may contain ordinary registers/rules without storage, or own at most one of:

- a FIFO;
- a synchronous memory; or
- an initialized ROM.

The legacy globally controlled storage profile remains storage-only: it does not combine that resource with user registers, next-state assignments, or rules. The separately validated scheduled-FIFO profile does permit ordinary register/rule state. FIFO actions and register writes are selected atomically by the same existing `ResolvedTransition`; the array backend does not create a second scheduler. Unsupported ownership combinations fail during semantic analysis rather than reaching a backend that could emit only part of the child.

The child must retain the existing storage-array contract: scalar wire ports, one inherited clock/reset domain, and no nested instances. Multiple scalar outputs are allowed. Each array element has a distinct physical instance identity and storage state; all elements share the one

deterministic specialization identity. The direct-SystemVerilog backend consumes Elaborate-`dInstance` bindings directly and emits one reusable component plus one application/instance per physical element.

CSR, other protocol/storage mixtures, multiple storage resources, arbitrary nested storage hierarchy, multiple clock domains, CDC, runtime-selected inputs or protocol endpoints, and formal observation extensions remain rejected. Runtime selection of a bit-packable scalar-wire output is supported as a read-only projection: `lane[select].value` lowers to a typed runtime index over all statically elaborated `lane[i].value` references. Every child continues to execute and retain independent state; the selector is only an output mux and never gates a child or denotes a dynamic physical instance.

The one bounded protocol/storage exception is a storage-only child whose external ports are exclusively primitive ready/valid and which owns exactly one globally controlled FIFO. It uses the same typed `HierarchicalConnection`, closed component ABI, and FIFO state as a non-array child. Ready/valid arrays with synchronous memory or initialized ROM remain rejected because they do not yet have a frozen protocol/storage contract.

The two-lane synchronous-memory witness checks independent cells and addresses, write-first same-address collision behavior, registered read output, and reset clearing both cells and read state. It passes strict Verilator behavior through both backends.

The `ZtpuBankedMemory` witness elaborates two four-element arrays into eight independently identified physical memory children with one shared specialization. Runtime output projection selects the addressed bank separately for each read port; decoded writes are broadcast to the matching bank in both replicas. The semantic simulator and both RTL backends agree on masked writes, independent reads, `read_first` collisions, reset suppression/preservation, and post-reset contents. BackendArtifact v4 records every leaf path and no fictitious dynamic instance. Hidden cells gain no new formal observation family.

0.30 Source identity migration

The public product name is **ZLang HDL**. Its canonical filesystem and tooling identity is:

Surface	Identity
Distribution and repository	<code>zlang-hdl</code>
Compiler command	<code>zlang</code>
Source suffix	<code>.zhl</code>
VS Code language id	<code>zlang-hdl</code>
MIME type	<code>text/x-zlang-hdl</code>

The former `.zl` suffix is not a compatibility alias. Physical compiler inputs using it fail with diagnostic `ZL-SOURCE-EXTENSION` and must be renamed. This strict boundary avoids collision with the unrelated `zlangdevs/zlang` project, which already uses `.zl`.

Logical imports do not contain a source suffix. For example, `import std.math.fixed` resolves to `stdlib/math/fixed.zhl`, while project and locked-package imports use their logical module identities.

The dependency-lock schema is version 2 after this migration. Older locks are rejected and must be regenerated with `zlang-lock update`; this prevents a lock that names the former physical suffix from being accepted under a new source identity. Source, build, and proof caches miss safely because their dependency and source-unit identities include the migrated paths.

The short prose name **ZLang** remains valid after the product has been introduced. The Python package `zlang`, `zlang.toml`, `zlang.lock`, the compiler-owned `.zlang/` state directory, environment variables prefixed `ZLANG_`, generated HDL identifiers, and the TextMate scope `source.zlang` are intentional internal identities and were not renamed.

0.31 Language support matrix

Canonical implementation-selection markers: `implement`, `choice`.

Implementation selection uses the canonical `implement` form for compiler- discovered candidates and `choice` for user-supplied alternatives. The retired `scalar pipeline(auto)`, `architecture(auto)`, and `explore` spellings are migration diagnostics; only `protocol transform pipeline(auto, ...)` remains source syntax.

`zlang.public_capabilities.CAPABILITY_REGISTRY` is the machine-readable source for public capability context, semantic status, backend-independent IR, simulator/direct-SV/formal coverage, executable witness, and current limitations. Registry tests compile every advertised witness. `examples/all_syntax.zhl` is a representative language tour, not a substitute for that phase-specific capability record.

0.32 Known limitations

ZLang 0.1.0a8 is an experimental alpha release. The compiler deliberately fails closed when a design falls outside a validated language/backend intersection: it must not publish RTL after silently dropping an IR entity.

0.32.1 Supported platform

0.32.2 Language and backend boundaries

- ZLang has no runtime procedural `if`, mutable local variables, implicit numeric casts, implicit fixed-point rescaling, or general HLS scheduler.
- Runtime-selected instance inputs/protocols, general cross-module atomic scheduling, full AXI4, automatic CDC insertion, and arbitrary stateful elastic pipelines are outside the alpha contract.
- Stateful objects inside one module may belong to independent explicit clock domains. A bounded `async_mem` is the sole storage exception: its one writer and one registered reader have distinct owners and form an explicit semantic boundary. Asynchronous 2RW memory, mixed widths, automatic banking, cross-clock atomic rules, derived/gated clocks, and target-aware scheduling across a CDC boundary are not implemented. Ordinary global memory control is still not composable with unrelated user register/rule state in the same module; use hierarchy until that unified-state slice is implemented.
- The direct-SV production intersection is authoritative. Unsupported combinations must produce a structured diagnostic rather than partial RTL.
- The Python API is provisional. The command-line interface and versioned artifact/lock/bundle schemas are the intended integration surfaces.
- Simulation-only architectural state access is currently a generic direct-SV/ Verilator facility for one exact clock/reset domain. It does not expose backend-created FIFO, CSR, protocol, CDC, or target-mapped state and must not be confused with synthesizable memory initialization.

0.32.3 Verification boundaries

The machine-readable capability registry and [syntax support matrix](#) are the detailed authorities for individual constructs. Report any accepted design that emits invalid RTL as a correctness defect.

\clearpage

Chapter 1

Quick reference

Use this page as the first context document when writing or reviewing ZLang HDL with a coding assistant such as Qwen. It describes current executable source, not historical proposals. The compiler's typed IR defines semantics; generated SystemVerilog is not a second language specification. In a repository checkout, Qwen should use the tracked project skill at [../qwen/skills/zlang-hdl/SKILL.md](#); this page remains the concise language authority shared by humans and assistants.

For an unfamiliar construct, consult the [syntax support matrix](#). For exact width tables and backend limits, follow the linked topic guide rather than guessing syntax.

1.1 Non-negotiable rules

- Source files use .zhl. The old .zl suffix is rejected.
- Run `zlang SOURCE --check`; highlighting is lexical and is not validation.
- Hardware assignments are concurrent. `=` drives the current cycle and `<=` schedules next state at the active clock edge.
- Assignment types are exact. There is no implicit resize, signedness change, fixed-point rescale, protocol adapter, or clock-domain crossing.
- Do not invent `let`, `const`, `var`, `return`, semicolons, C-style input/output, or runtime procedural `if`.
- `if` is compile-time elaboration only. Use `?:`, `mux`, or `switch` for pure runtime values; use `when/else` `when/else`, `priority`, or `fsm` for state actions.
- `Scalar pipeline(auto)`, `architecture(auto)`, and `explore` are retired. Compiler-selected scalar implementation uses `implement`.
- `pipeline(N) { expression }` is exact N-cycle hardware, not an optimization request. Protocol transform `pipeline(auto, ...)` is a separate bounded ready/valid construct and remains supported.
- Unsupported combinations must fail closed. Never work around a diagnostic by guessing backend signal names or duplicating compiler semantics in source.

1.2 Smallest valid modules

Combinational logic:

```
module Add {
  in a, b : u8
  out y : u9 = a + b
}
```

Sequential logic:

```
module Accumulator {
  clock clk reset rst
```

```

in enable : bit
in value : u8
out total : u9

reg state : u9 = 0
update: when enable {
    state <- truncate<9>(state + extend<9>(value))
}
total = state
}

```

All operands are read from one pre-edge snapshot. An accepted action group commits atomically; reset has priority. Multiple conflicting actions require an explicit priority relation or are rejected.

Multiple domains use the same declarations with one @clock owner:

```

module DualClock {
    clock a reset ra @a
    clock b reset rb @b
    reg left : u32 @a = 0
    reg right : u32 @b = 0
    rule TickLeft @a when 1 { left <- truncate<32>(left + 1) }
    rule TickRight @b when 1 { right <- truncate<32>(right + 2) }
}

```

An omitted owner is accepted only when exactly one domain can be inferred. Dynamic provenance follows through local expressions; an explicit `sync_level`, `pulse_toggle`, `handshake`, or `async_fifo(N)` is the only way to cross domains.

1.3 Types, literals, and exact conversions

Common scalar types are `bit`, `u8`, `s16`, `uint<N>`, `sint<N>`, and `bits<N>`. `char` is canonical `u8`; `string<N>` is canonical `vec<N, u8>`. Fixed point uses `fixed<W, F>`, `ufixed<W, F>`, or concise forms such as `SF8.8` and `SF_Sat8.8`.

- Unsuffixed integer literals use minimum exact width unless they occur directly at a concrete typed boundary.
- `a + b` and `a - b` follow the documented exact result-width rules; multiplication returns the full product width. Shifts preserve left width.
- Use `extend<N>` and `truncate<N>` for width changes.
- Use `quantize<T>` for explicit fixed-point rounding/overflow. Do not move a quantization boundary into products or reductions.
- Use `bitcast<T>` only for equal-width representation changes. `pack/unpack` are supported low-level compatibility forms.
- `concat(a, b, ...)` places the first operand at the MSB. Destination context never changes operand widths.
- Packed bit index zero is the LSB. `x[MSB:LSB]` uses an inclusive static slice; vector ranges `values[first..past_last]` are half-open.
- Indexed aggregates are packed LSB-first: `vec/string` element zero and tuple `item0` occupy the least-significant component recursively. First-declared struct fields and tagged-union tags remain at the MSB.

See [types and numerics](#) before changing a width or a fixed-point type.

1.4 Aggregates and functions

```

struct Pair<type T> { left : T right : T }

```

```
fn duplicate_sum<type T>(a : T, b : T) {
  exact = a + b
  Pair { left = exact right = exact }
}
```

Function bodies are pure and combinational. Bare body bindings are immutable, inferred, declaration-ordered locals; the final expression is the result. Return types may be explicit or inferred. Functions cannot capture module ports or contain state, protocols, delays, or pipelines.

Supported aggregates include `vec<N,T>`, nominal struct, nominal enum, tagged union, and structural tuples `(T,U)`. Prefer inferred locals when the type is exact and obvious. Keep explicit types at public ports, state, raw/enum boundaries, narrowing, and fixed-point quantization.

Generics are monomorphized. Type/value parameters and exact compile-time constraints are source declarations, not runtime hardware:

```
module Queue<type T,D=4> where D >= 2 && is_power_of_two(D) {
  // ...
}
```

Imports are logical. For example `import std.bus.reg` resolves compiler-shipped `stdlib/bus/reg.zhl`; `import std.math.complex as cx` adds a source-local qualifier but does not create a runtime namespace.

1.5 State, hierarchy, and protocols

- Declare one default synchronous domain with clock `clk` reset `rst`.
- `async reset arst @clk` means asynchronous assertion and fixed two-edge synchronized release. Do not emulate reset modes in user logic.
- `reg`, `fifo`, `memory`, and `rom` retain explicit typed state/storage semantics. Memory latency, collision, mask, and reset policies are not inferred.
- A concise child declaration is `child : ChildModule`; `inst child : ChildModule` remains accepted. Bind only typed ports/endpoints.
- `rv<T>`, `credit<T,N>`, and `request_response` properties such as `.transfer` are typed observations, not ordinary struct fields.
- Use explicit connect/source `-> sink`, adapters, and CDC crossings. The compiler never inserts these silently.
- Top-level structs and tuples become recursively named leaf ports; vectors use multidimensional packed arrays in the production direct-SystemVerilog ABI.

Read [sequential state/storage](#) and [hierarchy/protocols](#) before composing stateful children.

1.6 Functional datapath and implementation intent

`generate`, `map`, `reduce`, `sum`, and `dot` are statically bounded functional hardware expressions. They are not runtime loops.

Use exactly one `implement` region when the value is fixed and the compiler may choose among legal implementations:

```
y = implement {
  dot(samples, coefficients)
  intent {
    latency <= 4
    ii == 1
    dsp <= 8
    fmax >= 100
    minimize lut
  }
```

```
}  
}
```

The expression is the hardware meaning. `intent` contains hard constraints and one supported objective; it does not name optimization passes. Positive-latency candidates require a valid clock/reset context. `choice` is reserved for user-authored equivalent alternatives. Egglog supplies only frozen pure scalar value rewrites; it does not schedule pipelines or state.

See [optimization and formal](#) before adding or changing an implementation policy.

1.7 Verification

```
contract arithmetic @ clk {  
  require legal_inputs { (a < 8) & (b < 8) }  
  ensure exact_output { y == a + b }  
  cover maximum { y == 14 }  
}
```

Named assert/ensure are same-cycle safety goals. `require` is an environment-owned precondition scoped to its contract. `cover` is bounded reachability; a missed cover is not an unreachability proof. BMC produces `bounded_pass`, never proven. Verification syntax does not legalize invalid hardware or feed optimizer range inference.

Do not add liveness, arbitrary SVA/SMT, temporal sequences, new observation families or source-level semantic-reference equivalence controls. Use the existing [formal examples](#) and compiler-owned routes.

1.8 Commands and completion check

```
zlang source.zhl --check  
zlang source.zhl --top Top --systemverilog build/Top.sv  
zlang source.zhl --top Top --verify
```

Before calling a source change complete:

1. compile the exact top with `--check`;
2. run focused parser/semantic/canonical/simulator tests;
3. exercise production direct-SV with strict Verilator;
4. run applicable existing formal tests without inventing new claims;
5. run the repository regression and `git diff --check` required by the active task.

If a requested form is absent from this page, check the [syntax matrix](#) and [known limitations](#). Do not infer support from dated design-freeze examples.